2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Accounting

Future Business Leaders of America

Accounting challenges competitors to demonstrate their understanding of fundamental accounting principles through an objective test. This event introduces members to key concepts such as financial statements, journal entries, and the accounting cycle, encouraging exploration of careers in accounting and finance.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

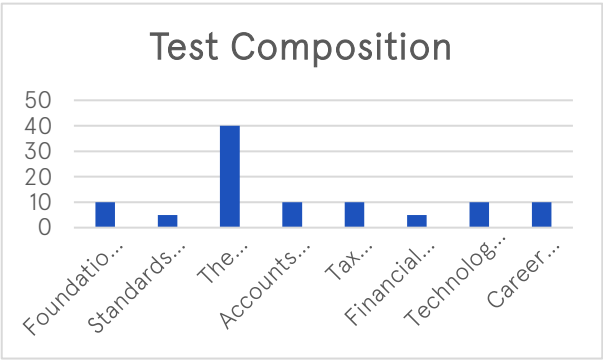
Event Information:	
National Leadership Conference: **Timing Structure:** **Test Duration: 50 Minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	**State/District:** Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

This event is designed for students who are in the early stages of learning accounting. To be eligible, members must have completed no more than two traditional semesters of high school accounting instruction, or the equivalent of one full year under a block schedule, by May 1, 2027.

Knowledge Areas

- Foundations of Accounting
- Standards and Compliance
- The Accounting Cycle
- Accounts Payable and Receivable
- Tax Accounting
- Financial Reports
- Technology and Accounting
- Career Opportunities



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Accounting

Future Business Leaders of America

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Accounting I at a previous National Leadership Conference are not eligible to compete in this event.**
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.

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- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available exclusively to teacher advisers. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are not required to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.

Note for members and parents: All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.

Foundations of Accounting (10 test items)

1. Describe the need for financial information (FI:579, LAP-FI-579) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of accounting (FI:085, LAP-FI-085) (CS)
3. Discuss the role of ethics in accounting (FI:351, LAP-FI-351) (SP)
4. Explain legal considerations for accounting (FI:353) (SP)

Standards and Compliance (5 test items)

1. Explain the nature of accounting standards (PD:158) (CS)
2. Explain financial disclosure regulations and policies (BL:153) (SP)

The Accounting Cycle (40 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of the accounting cycle (FI:342) (CS)
2. Distinguish among types of business transactions (FI:673) (CS)
3. Distinguish among types of business documentation (FI:674) (CS)
4. Demonstrate the effects of transactions on the accounting equation (FI:378) (CS)
5. Prepare a chart of accounts (FI:379) (CS)
6. Explain the nature of special journals (FI:407) (CS)
7. Journalize business transactions (FI:381) (CS)
8. Post journal entries to general ledger accounts (FI:382) (CS)
9. Prepare a trial balance (FI:383) (CS)
10. Journalize and post adjusting entries (FI:384) (CS)
11. Journalize and post closing entries (FI:385) (CS)
12. Prepare a post-closing trial balance (FI:386) (CS)
13. Prepare worksheets (FI:387) (SP)

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Accounts Payable and Receivable (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of accounts payable (FI:409) (CS)
2. Account for purchases (e.g., purchase requisitions, purchase orders, invoices, vouchers) (FI:679) (CS)
3. Explain the nature of accounts receivable (FI:424) (CS)
4. Account for sales (e.g., invoices, sales receipts, etc.) (FI:682) (CS)

Tax Accounting (10 test items)

1. Explain record keeping procedures for tax accounting (FI:484) (SP)
2. Account for taxes (FI:697) (SP)
3. Identify tax issues for clients (FI:485) (SP)

Financial Reports (5 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of annual reports (FI:388) (SP)
2. Analyze transactions and accounts (e.g., purchase, sales, sales returns and allowances, uncollectible accounts, depreciation, debt) (FI:449) (SP)

Technology and Accounting (10 test items)

1. Explain the use of technology in accounting (FI:352) (SP)
2. Use accounting applications and systems (NF:225) (CS)
3. Preserve automated accounting records (NF:227) (SP)

Career Opportunities (10 test items)

1. Identify career opportunities in accounting (PD:337) (SP)
2. Explain the roles and responsibilities of accounting professionals (PD:338) (SP)
3. Discuss professional designations for accountants (e.g., CPA, CMA, CIA, CFE, etc.) (PD:168) (SP)
4. Describe the services of professional organizations in accounting (PD:339) (SP)

References

Bichachi, R. *Accounts payable vs accounts receivable: What's the difference.* https://www.netsuite.com/portal/resource/articles/accounting/accounts-payable-accounts-receivable.shtml

Hayes, A. *Complete guide to the accounting cycle: Steps, timing, and utility.* https://www.investopedia.com/terms/a/accounting-cycle.asp

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

University of the Potomac. *What is financial accounting? Key principles, careers & more.* https://potomac.edu/what-is-financial-accounting/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Advanced Accounting

Future Business Leaders of America

Advanced Accounting allows members to demonstrate their knowledge of higher-level accounting concepts through an objective test. This event covers topics such as corporate accounting, managerial accounting, and financial analysis, preparing members for advanced study and careers in the accounting field.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

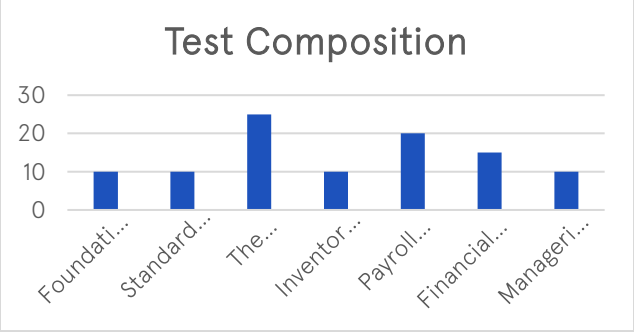
Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:	State/District:
Timing Structure: **Test Duration: 50 Minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Foundations of Accounting
- Standards and Compliance
- The Accounting Cycle
- Inventory
- Payroll
- Financial Statements
- Managerial Accounting



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Advanced Accounting

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Accounting II at a previous National Leadership Conference are not eligible to compete in this event.**
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

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Important FBLA Documents

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

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Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Foundations of Accounting (10 test items)

1. Explain the concept of accounting (FI:085, LAP-FI-085) (CS)
2. Discuss the role of ethics in accounting (FI:351, LAP-FI-351) (SP)
3. Explain legal considerations for accounting (FI:353) (SP)
4. Explain the use of technology in accounting (FI:352) (SP)

Standards and Compliance (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of accounting standards (PD:158) (CS)
2. Explain financial disclosure regulations and policies (BL:153) (SP)
3. Explain the purpose of internal accounting controls (FI:343, LAP-FI-343) (SP)
4. Determine the components of internal accounting control procedures for a business (FI:479) (SP)
5. Explain the nature of audits and assurance engagements (FI:344) (SP)

The Accounting Cycle (25 test items)

1. Demonstrate the effects of transactions on the accounting equation (FI:378) (CS)
2. Prepare a chart of accounts (FI:379) (CS)
3. Journalize business transactions (FI:381) (CS)
4. Post journal entries to general ledger accounts (FI:382) (CS)
5. Prepare a trial balance (FI:383) (CS)
6. Journalize and post adjusting entries (FI:384) (CS)
7. Journalize and post closing entries (FI:385) (CS)
8. Prepare a post-closing trial balance (FI:386) (CS)
9. Identify and correct accounting errors (FI:675) (SP)
10. Prepare worksheets (FI:387) (SP)

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Inventory (10 test items)

1. Record inventory transactions (FI:432) (CS)
2. Process inventory adjustments (e.g., shrinkage, obsolescence, returns, etc.) (FI:435) (CS)
3. Explain methods used to value inventory (e.g., FIFO, LIFO, average cost, etc.) (FI:586) (CS)
4. Determine the cost/value of inventory (FI:436) (SP)

Payroll (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature of payroll expenses (e.g., Social Security tax, Medicare tax, FUTA, SUTA, workers' compensation) (FI:638) (CS)
2. Maintain employee earnings records (e.g., timecards, time sheets, etc.) (FI:134) (CS)
3. Calculate employee earnings (FI:438) (SP)
4. Calculate employee deductions (FI:439) (SP)
5. Calculate payroll taxes (FI:442) (SP)
6. Account for payroll transactions (e.g., earnings, taxes, benefits, other deductions) (FI:686) (SP)
7. Process payroll payments and remittances (e.g., employees, benefits, taxes) (FI:687) (SP)
8. Prepare federal, state, and local payroll tax returns and reports (FI:443) (SP)

Financial Statements (15 test items)

1. Describe the nature of cash flow statements (FI:091, LAP-FI-091) (SP)
2. Explain the nature of balance sheets (FI:093, LAP-FI-093) (SP)
3. Describe the nature of income statements (FI:094, LAP-FI-094) (SP)
4. Prepare income statements (FI:149) (MN)
5. Calculate financial ratios (FI:097) (MN)
6. Interpret financial statements (FI:102) (MN)

Managerial Accounting (10 test items)

1. Describe marginal analysis techniques and applications (FI:659) (SP)
2. Explain the nature of managerial accounting (FI:660) (SP)
3. Discuss the use of variance analysis in managerial accounting (FI:661) (SP)

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References

Bichachi, R. *Accounts payable vs accounts receivable: What's the difference?* https://www.netsuite.com/portal/resource/articles/accounting/accounts-payable-accounts-receivable.shtml

Hayes, A. *Complete guide to the accounting cycle: Steps, timing, and utility.* https://www.investopedia.com/terms/a/accounting-cycle.asp

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Salesforce. *Managerial accounting – definition, objective, techniques & limitations.* https://www.salesforce.com/au/blog/managerial-accounting-guide/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Advertising

Advertising challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of advertising principles and strategies through an objective test. This event explores topics such as media planning, branding, consumer behavior, and promotional techniques used to effectively reach target audiences.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

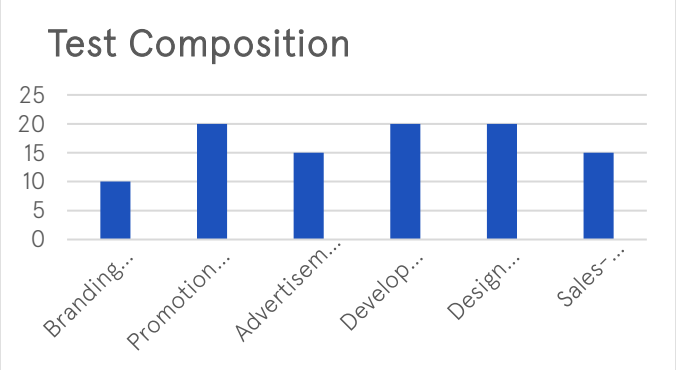
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Branding
- Promotion
- Advertisement
- Develop Marketing Content
- Design Principles
- Sales-Promotion Activities

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Advertising

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
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Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
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Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

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Important FBLA Documents

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Advertising

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Branding (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of corporate branding (PM:206, LAP-PM-206) (SP)
2. Describe factors used by businesses to position corporate brands (PM:207) (SP)
3. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services (PM:042, LAP-PM-042) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of product/service branding (PM:021, LAP-PM-021) (SP)

Promotion (20 test items)

1. Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function (PR:001, LAP-PR-901) (CS)
2. Explain the types of promotion (i.e., institutional, product) (PR:002, LAP-PR-902) (CS)
3. Identify the elements of the promotional mix (PR:003, LAP-PR-903) (SP)
4. Describe the use of business ethics in promotion (PR:099, LAP-PR-099) (SP)
5. Describe the use of technology in the promotion function (PR:100) (SP)
6. Describe the regulation of promotion (PR:101) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of a promotional plan (PR:073) (SP)
8. Coordinate activities in the promotional mix (PR:076) (SP)

Advertisement (15 test items)

1. Explain types of advertising media (PR:007, LAP-PR-007) (SP)
2. Explain the components of advertisements (PR:014) (SP)
3. Explain the importance of coordinating elements in advertisements (PR:251) (SP)
4. Determine advertising reach of media (PR:225) (SP)
5. Read media schedule (PR:348) (SP)
6. Calculate media costs (PR:009) (SP)

Develop Marketing Content (20 test items)

1. Identify effective advertising headlines (PR:330) (SP)
2. Explain the use of storytelling in marketing (PR:388) (SP)
3. Describe the nature of copy strategies (PR:126) (SP)
4. Write copy for advertisements (PR:368) (SP)

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5. Write email marketing copy (PR:362) (SP)
6. Write content for use in social media (PR:371) (SP)
7. Maintain a consistent brand voice in social content (PR:389) (SP)
8. Repurpose content for use in multiple platforms (PR:373) (SP)

Design Principles (20 test items)

1. Describe the use of color in advertisements (PR:123) (SP)
2. Describe the elements of design (PR:222) (SP)
3. Explain the use of illustrations in advertisements (PR:322) (SP)
4. Discuss the nature of typography (PR:295) (SP)
5. Explain type styles used in advertisements (PR:326) (SP)
6. Describe effective advertising layouts (PR:275) (SP)
7. Identify types of drawing media (PR:334) (SP)
8. Explain the impact of color harmonies on composition (PR:314) (SP)
9. Describe digital color concepts (PR:274) (SP)

Sales-Promotion Activities (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature of direct marketing channels (PR:089) (SP)
2. Identify communications channels used in sales promotion (PR:249) (SP)
3. Create promotional signage (PR:391) (SP)
4. Collaborate in the design of slogans/taglines (PR:266) (SP)
5. Collaborate in the design of collateral materials to promote frequency/loyalty marketing program (PR:233) (SP)
6. Participate in the design of collateral materials to promote special events (PR:234) (SP)
7. Set up cross-promotions (PR:235) (SP)

References

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Agribusiness

Agribusiness allows members to demonstrate their understanding of business principles as they apply to the agriculture industry through an objective test. This event covers topics such as agricultural marketing, economics, finance, and supply chain management, encouraging members to explore careers in agribusiness.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

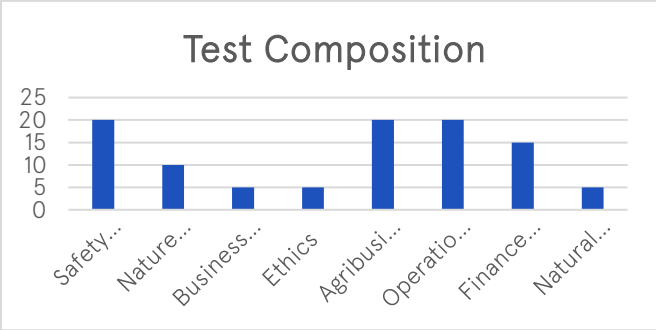
Important Notes:
- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Safety Procedures and Regulations
- Nature of Agribusiness
- Business Law
- Ethics
- Agribusiness Economics
- Operations and Management
- Finance and Marketing
- Natural Resources and Systems



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Agribusiness

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Agribusiness

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Safety Procedures and Regulations (20 test items)

1. Follow instructions for use of equipment, tools, and machinery related to Agriculture, Food, and Natural Resources (AFNR)
2. Handle and report emergency situations (OP:010) (CS)
3. Maintain a safe work environment (OP:008) (CS)
4. Follow safety precautions (OP:007) (PQ)
5. Explain procedures for handling accidents (OP:009) (CS)
6. Describe health and safety regulations in agribusiness
7. Report noncompliance with agribusiness health and safety regulations
8. Describe the concept of insurance for agricultural businesses

Nature of Agribusiness (10 test items)

1. Explain the role of agribusiness in society
2. Describe types of agribusiness activities
3. Identify ways that technology impacts agribusiness

Business Law (5 test items)

1. Describe legal issues affecting businesses (BL:001) (SP)
2. Discuss the nature of environmental law (BL:073) (SP)

Ethics (5 test items)

1. Recognize and respond to ethical dilemmas in agribusiness
2. Take responsibility for decisions and actions (EI:075, LAP-EI-075) (PQ)
3. Explain the nature of business ethics (EC:106, LAP-EC-106) (SP)

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Agribusiness Economics (20 test items)

1. Explain types of business ownership (BL:003, LAP-BL-003) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of private enterprise (EC:009, LAP-EC-909) (CS)
3. Determine the relationship between government and agribusiness
4. Identify factors affecting profits in agribusiness
5. Determine factors affecting risk in agribusiness
6. Explain the principles of supply and demand with regard to AFNR
7. Describe the functions of prices in markets (EC:006, LAP-EC-906) (CS)
8. Explain the nature of global trade (EC:016, LAP-EC-916) (SP)
9. Discuss the impact of globalization on agribusiness

Operations and Management (20 test items)

1. Explain the concept of agribusiness management
2. Maintain inventory of supplies (OP:031) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of supply chain for agribusiness
4. Explain the concept of production in agribusiness
5. Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs (OP:024, LAP-OP-024) (SP)
6. Explain the nature of risk management (SM:075, LAP-SM-075) (SP)
7. Describe the use of technology in agribusiness operations

Finance and Marketing (15 test items)

1. Explain the role of finance in agribusiness
2. Describe the need for financial information (FI:579, LAP-FI-579) (CS)
3. Explain marketing and its importance in a global economy (MK:001, LAP-MK-901) (CS)
4. Describe marketing functions and related activities for agribusiness
5. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior (MK:014, LAP-MK-014) (SP)
6. Develop marketing strategies for agricultural commodities, products, and services

Natural Resources and Systems (5 test items)

1. Identify natural systems and cycles involved in production, processing, and management of food and natural resources
2. Discuss how AFNR activities impact the environment and natural resources
3. Discuss the impact of natural systems and cycles on agribusiness

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Banking & Financial Systems

Future Business Leaders of America

Banking & Financial Systems challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of how financial institutions function and their impact on both business and personal finance. This event includes an objective test and a role play scenario, allowing members to apply knowledge in areas such as banking services, regulatory compliance, and financial decision-making.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

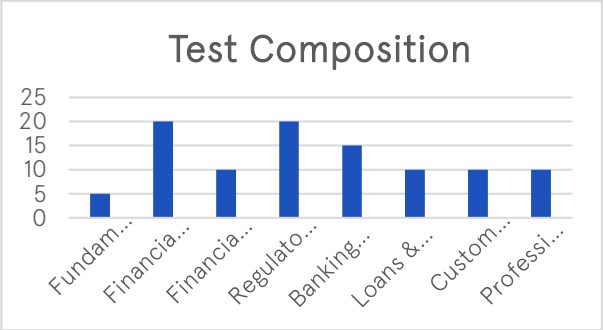
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Fundamental Principles of Money
- Financial Institutions & Markets
- Financial Analysis & Decision-Making
- Regulatory Compliance in Finance
- Banking Services & Daily Operations
- Loans & Credit
- Customer Relations in Banking
- Professional Development in Banking



Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Banking & Financial Systems

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a banking and financial systems–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)
- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fundamental Principles of Money (5 test items)

1. Describe functions of money (medium of exchange, unit of measure, store of value) (FI:060) (PQ)
2. Explain the time value of money (FI:062) (CS)

Financial Institutions & Markets (20 test items)

1. Describe the role of financial institutions (FI:336) (CS)
2. Explain types of financial markets (e.g., money market, capital market, insurance market, commodities markets) (FI:337) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of convergence/consolidation in the finance industry (FI:573) (SP)
4. Describe types of banking institutions (e.g., central banks, retail banks, universal banks) (PD:288) (SP)
5. Describe the nature of the national banking system (PD:195) (SP)
6. Discuss the role of credit unions (PD:200) (SP)
7. Explain the evolution of commercial banking (PD:191) (SP)

Financial Analysis & Decision-Making (10 test items)

1. Explain key ratios/terms in banking (FI:543) (SP)
2. Compute key banking calculations (e.g., interest, annual percentage rate, exchange rates) (FI:544) (SP)
3. Calculate the time value of money (FI:238) (SP)

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Regulatory Compliance in Finance (20 test items)

1. Explain legal responsibilities associated with consumer financial products and services (FI:063) (CS)
2. Discuss the nature and scope of compliance in the finance industry (BL:148) (SP)
3. Discuss the responsibilities of regulatory agencies that oversee the banking industry (BL:094) (SP)
4. Discuss federal regulation of lending functions (BL:092) (SP)
5. Discuss federal regulation of operations functions in banking services (BL:093) (SP)
6. Discuss e-compliance issues in banking services (BL:091) (SP)
7. Discuss legal considerations in the finance industry (BL:133) (SP)
8. Discuss the role of the Federal Reserve system in banking operations (OP:276) (SP)

Banking Services & Daily Operations (15 test items)

1. Describe types of personal banking products and services (PD:154) (CS)
2. Describe types of banking products and services provided exclusively to businesses (PD:423) (CS)
3. Discuss procedures for the secure handling of cash (OP:217) (CS)
4. Discuss the secure handling of checks (OP:218) (CS)
5. Describe crimes to which a bank could fall victim (e.g., fraud, robbery, phishing) (OP:220) (CS)
6. Discuss the elements and role of a bank security program (OP:221) (SP)

Loans & Credit (10 test items)

1. Explain the purposes and importance of credit (FI:002, LAP-FI-002) (CS)
2. Discuss the nature of loan products (PD:155) (SP)
3. Describe the loan application generating process (OP:277) (SP)
4. Explain the process of credit analysis (OP:278) (SP)
5. Describe factors affecting loan pricing and loan structuring (OP:279) (SP)

Customer Relations in Banking (10 test items)

1. Explain the responsibilities of finance professionals in providing client services (CR:012) (CS)
2. Discuss the importance of meeting and exceeding customer expectations (CR:015) (CS)
3. Describe the relationships that institutions providing banking services have with their communities (CR:020) (SP)
4. Describe basic teller performance standards (PD:207) (CS)
5. Describe the importance of selling in the banking industry (PD:298) (CS)

Professional Development in Banking (10 test items)

1. Discuss considerations in selecting a financial-services provider (FI:076) (CS)
2. Explain career opportunities in banking services (PD:285) (SP)
3. Discuss employment opportunities in the finance industry (PD:152, LAP-PD-152) (CS)
4. Discuss professional designations for banking professionals (PD:286) (SP)
5. Describe the services of professional organizations in banking services (PD:287) (SP)
6. Discuss ethical issues in the banking industry (PD:192) (SP)

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Rocket Money. *The complete beginner's guide to the financial services industry*. https://www.rocketmoney.com/learn/personal-finance/financial-services

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Banking & Financial Systems

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Banking & Financial Systems Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Fundamental Principles of Money/ Financial Institutions & Markets/ Financial Analysis & Decision-Making/ Regulatory Compliance in Finance/ Banking Services & Daily Operations/ Loans & Credit/ Customer Relations in Banking/ Professional Development in Banking*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Broadcast Journalism

Broadcast Journalism challenges members to showcase their communication, storytelling, and production skills by creating and delivering a professional news broadcast. Competitors will research, script, and produce a cohesive news segment, culminating in a live presentation evaluated by a panel of judges.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access**: Provided
  - *Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.*
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Spotlight on Success: How Local Businesses Strengthen Communities

Create a broadcast news story highlighting how a local business is making a positive impact in your community through innovation, workforce development, or community involvement. Plan your coverage like a real journalist by researching the business, interviewing an owner, employee, or community member, capturing video footage, and presenting a compelling story that informs and engages your audience.

How does this business contribute to the local economy and improve the community it serves? Use your reporting to showcase the business's impact and inspire viewers to recognize the important role local businesses play in building strong communities.

The pre-recorded story must be no longer than two minutes.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Broadcast Journalism

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Broadcast News Segment
  - Present a pre-recorded news segment that meets the topic requirements
  - Pre-recorded content must not exceed 2 minutes in total
  - Segment should be played during the live presentation
- Presentation: The rest of the presentation time should include the following information:
  - **Research, Accuracy & Ethical Reporting:** Explain how news stories were researched and verified, emphasizing credible sources, factual accuracy, and ethical journalistic standards.
  - **Production Techniques & Tools:** Describe the technologies, tools, and editing methods used to create the segment, highlighting key creative and technical decisions.
  - **Visual & Editorial Design:** Showcase how visuals, graphics, transitions, and overall story flow were used to enhance clarity, engagement, and professionalism in the segment.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Broadcast News Segment
  - Present a pre-recorded news segment that meets the topic requirements
  - Pre-recorded content must not exceed 2 minutes in total
  - Segment should be played during the live presentation
- Presentation: The rest of the presentation time should include the following information:
  - **Research, Accuracy & Ethical Reporting:** Explain how news stories were researched and verified, emphasizing credible sources, factual accuracy, and ethical journalistic standards.
  - **Production Techniques & Tools:** Describe the technologies, tools, and editing methods used to create the segment, highlighting key creative and technical decisions.
  - **Visual & Editorial Design:** Showcase how visuals, graphics, transitions, and overall story flow were used to enhance clarity, engagement, and professionalism in the segment.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

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Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Broadcast Journalism

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Broadcast Journalism Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Broadcast News Segment					
Broadcast News Segment *Present a pre-recorded news segment that meets the topic requirements and does not exceed 2 minutes.*	*No segment shown or content does not relate to the assigned topic.*	*Segment submitted but lacks clear connection to the topic, exceeds time limit, or contains major content or quality issues.*	*Segment clearly addresses the topic, meets time limit, and demonstrates a basic level of production quality and organization.*	*Segment is concise, highly relevant to the topic, professionally presented, within the time limit, and demonstrates excellent storytelling and production quality.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Visual & Editorial Design *Showcase how visuals, graphics, transitions, and overall story flow were used to enhance clarity, engagement, and professionalism in the segment.*	*No use of visuals, graphics, or editorial elements to support or enhance the segment.*	*Basic visuals or transitions used inconsistently; design choices may distract from clarity or appear unpolished.*	*Visual and editorial elements are appropriate and enhance clarity and engagement; story flows logically with professional appearance.*	*Visuals, graphics, and transitions are cohesive, polished, and strategically used to elevate clarity, engagement, and storytelling; story is seamless and professionally executed.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presentation					
Visual & Editorial Design *Demonstrates thoughtful reflection by discussing how specific visual and editorial design choices (e.g., graphics, transitions, pacing, and flow) enhanced clarity, engagement, and professionalism in the broadcast segment.*	*Does not discuss visual or editorial design choices, or discussion is irrelevant to the segment.*	*Mentions visuals or editorial elements in a general way but provides little to no explanation of how they contributed to clarity, engagement, or professionalism.*	*Clearly explains several visual and editorial design choices (e.g., graphics, transitions, pacing, flow) and connects them to how they supported clarity, engagement, and professionalism.*	*Provides a thorough, thoughtful reflection with specific examples of visual and editorial design choices; clearly articulates the rationale behind design decisions and insightfully connects them to enhancing clarity, audience engagement, and professionalism.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Production Techniques & Tools *Describe the technologies, tools, and editing methods used to create the segment, highlighting key creative and technical decisions.*	*No description of production tools or techniques; no evidence of editing or creative decisions.*	*Minimal explanation of tools or editing methods used; lacks clarity on how techniques contributed to the final product.*	*Identifies tools and editing methods with clear explanation; describes how techniques supported the production and storytelling.*	*Provides a detailed, thoughtful explanation of technologies, tools, and editing decisions; highlights how each choice enhanced the segment's technical quality and creative impact.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Research, Accuracy & Ethical Reporting *Explain how news stories were researched and verified, emphasizing credible sources, factual accuracy, and ethical journalistic standards.*	*No explanation of research process or sources; factual accuracy and ethical standards are not addressed.*	*Minimal or unclear explanation of research; sources lack credibility or are not cited; limited attention to accuracy or journalistic ethics.*	*Research process is explained with credible sources cited; facts are mostly accurate; ethical standards are acknowledged and generally followed.*	*Thorough explanation of how stories were researched and verified; multiple credible sources cited; all facts are accurate; clear demonstration of high ethical standards in reporting.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Broadcast Journalism

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Pre-recorded segment is no longer than 2 minutes* ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Communication (High School)

Business Communication challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of effective communication practices in the workplace through an objective test. This event covers topics such as written and verbal communication, digital correspondence, and professional etiquette essential to business success.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

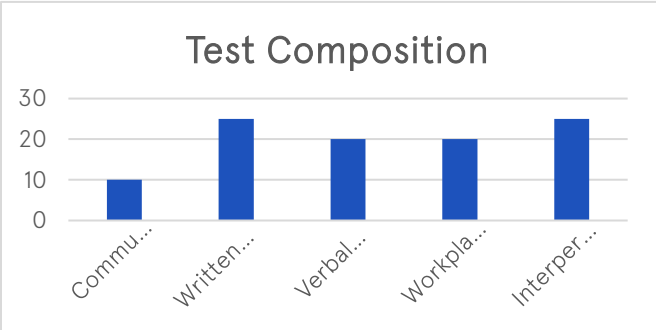
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Communication Basics
- Written Communication
- Verbal Communication
- Workplace Communication
- Interpersonal Relationships



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Communication (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Communication Basics (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of effective communications (EI:007, LAP-EI-140) (PQ)
2. Explain ethical considerations in providing information (EI:038, LAP-EI-038) (SP)
3. Foster open, honest communication (EI:129, LAP-EI-129) (SP)

Written Communication (25 test items)

1. Explain the nature of effective written communications (CO:016) (CS)
2. Select and utilize appropriate formats for professional writing (CO:088) (CS)
3. Edit and revise written work consistent with professional standards (CO:089) (CS)
4. Write professional emails (CO:090) (CS)
5. Write business letters (CO:133) (CS)
6. Write informational messages (CO:039) (CS)
7. Write inquiries (CO:040) (CS)
8. Write persuasive messages (CO:031) (SP)
9. Write executive summaries (CO:091) (SP)
10. Prepare simple written reports (CO:094) (SP)
11. Adapt written correspondence to targeted audiences (CO:203) (SP)

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Verbal Communication (20 test items)

1. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience (CO:084) (CS)
2. Handle phone calls in a businesslike manner (CO:114) (CS)
3. Participate in group discussions (CO:053) (CS)
4. Facilitate (lead) group discussions (CO:201) (SP)
5. Make oral presentations (CO:025, LAP-CO-025) (SP)

Workplace Communication (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature of staff communication (CO:014) (CS)
2. Choose and use appropriate channel for workplace communication (CO:092) (CS)
3. Participate in a staff meeting (CO:063) (CS)
4. Participate in problem-solving groups (CO:067) (CS)
5. Provide directions for completing job tasks (CO:139) (SU)

Interpersonal Relationships (25 test items)

1. *Exhibit cultural sensitivity (EI:033, LAP-EI-033 (CS)*
2. *Leverage personality types in business situations (EI:104) (SP)*
3. *"Sell" ideas to others (EI:108, LAP-EI-108) (SP)*
4. *Persuade others (EI:012, LAP-EI-912) (SP)*
5. *Demonstrate negotiation skills (EI:062, LAP-EI-062) (SP)*
6. *Use conflict-resolution skills (EI:015, LAP-EI-915) (CS)*
7. *Participate as a team member (EI:045, LAP-EI-045) (CS)*
8. *Use consensus-building skills (EI:011, LAP-EI-911) (SP)*
9. *Motivate team members (EI:059, LAP-EI-059) (SP)*
10. *Foster positive working relationships (EI:037, LAP-EI-037) (CS)*
11. *Consider conflicting viewpoints (EI:136, LAP-EI-136) (CS)*
12. *Collaborate with others (EI:130, LAP-EI-130) (SP)*

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References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. National Business Administration Standards. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Nextiva. What is business communication & how can it benefit your company? https://www.nextiva.com/blog/what-is-business-communication.html

Indeed. Guide to business communications: Types, methods, and tips. https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/guide-to-business-communications

Forbes. From excruciatingly complex to exactly what you need. https://www.forbes.com/councils/forbesbusinesscouncil/2023/11/20/a-guide-for-mastering-the-art-of-business-communication/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Ethics (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Business Ethics recognizes members who can analyze and present solutions to ethical dilemmas commonly faced in the business world. This event includes an individual objective test, a written report, and a presentation, allowing members to explore ethical decision-making, integrity, and corporate responsibility.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Objective Test, Pre-judged Asset, Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Presentation:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access ONLY Provided for Testing**
- Pre-Submission Asset Due by State declared due date
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic Synopsis for Report & Presentation

Business Ethics: Maintaining Stakeholder Trust During a Food Safety Crisis.

Food safety incidents can have significant consequences for customers, employees, suppliers, investors, regulators, and the communities organizations serve. Competitors will examine how business leaders should respond when public health, operational decisions, financial stability, and stakeholder trust are all at risk. They should analyze the ethical responsibilities involved, consider the impact on key stakeholders, and develop recommendations that demonstrate transparency, accountability, and sound decision-making during a food safety crisis.

Refer to pages 9–10 for the full Background Information and Topic.

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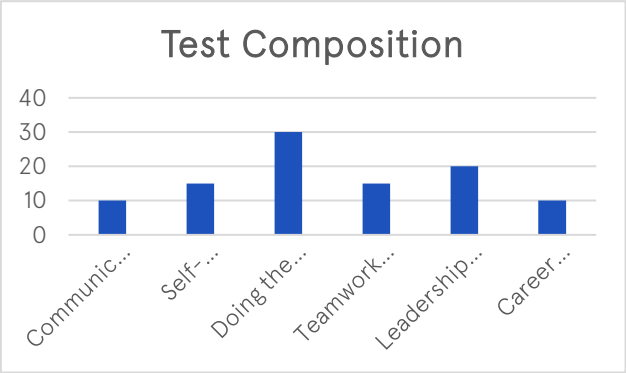
2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Ethics (High School)

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Knowledge Areas

- Communication Skills
- Self-Awareness
- Doing the Right Thing
- Teamwork Skills
- Leadership Skills
- Career Readiness

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

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Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of four phases: a pre-judged asset, an objective test, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Executive Summary

Submission Deadline

- A PDF of the executive summary must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements

- Number of Pages: The report will be no more than three (3) pages
- Assets must be formatted to fit standard 8.5" x 11" paper.
- Links and QR codes are not permitted.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the asset. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).

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- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Asset Specific Information

- Competitors must research the topic and prepare a one-page executive summary prior to the conference.
- Competitors must interview three local businesspeople as part of their research and explain how the interview findings factored into their recommendations. This information must be addressed in the report and the presentation.
- The first page of the report must include only the title (Business Ethics Summary) on the first line, names of all competitors on the second line, the name of the school on the third line, the state on the fourth line and the year (2026-2027) on the fifth line.
- The second page of the report is a one-page summary of the topic and findings, with the following headings: Why the Ethical Issue Happened, How the Ethical Issue Should be Resolved, What Could Have Prevented the Ethical Issue. The one-page summary can be single spaced.
- The third page is a works cited page.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

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- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Define the Ethical Issue:** Identify and clearly define the ethical dilemma using appropriate industry terminology.
- **Analyze Contributing Factors:** Explain at least two key reasons behind the issue. Provide thoughtful analysis to demonstrate understanding of how these factors impact the situation.

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- **Offer Ethical Recommendations:** Present two or more well-supported solutions to address the ethical dilemma, using credible evidence to justify each recommendation.
- **Recommend Safeguards:** Suggest at least two safeguards or preventative measures with strong supporting rationale to help avoid similar issues in the future.
- **Incorporate Research and Real-World Input:** Use accurate, well-sourced research and include insights from business professionals gathered through interviews or outreach to strengthen your analysis.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

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Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

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- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
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Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Define the Ethical Issue:** Identify and clearly define the ethical dilemma using appropriate industry terminology.
- **Analyze Contributing Factors:** Explain at least two key reasons behind the issue. Provide thoughtful analysis to demonstrate understanding of how these factors impact the situation.
- **Offer Ethical Recommendations:** Present two or more well-supported solutions to address the ethical dilemma, using credible evidence to justify each recommendation.
- **Recommend Safeguards:** Suggest at least two safeguards or preventative measures with strong supporting rationale to help avoid similar issues in the future.
- **Support Analysis with Research and Professional Perspectives:** Use accurate, well-sourced research and include insights from business professionals gathered through interviews or outreach to strengthen your analysis.

Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score, team-averaged objective test score, and preliminary presentation round scores will be added together to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

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Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Background Information and Topic

You've probably heard phrases like "grace under fire," "rising to the occasion," or "cool under pressure" to describe athletes, first responders, or doctors before. Being at your best when facing adversity is an excellent quality for individuals, but it's also a great quality for businesses. Just one organization can have hundreds, thousands, or even millions of stakeholders who are impacted by its actions. That means when challenges arise and the stakes are at their highest, businesses need to make sound decisions...or else risk hurting others.

One sector where businesses must constantly be at the top of their game is the food industry. There is perhaps no commodity more universal than food—people need it every day, which means that food companies must oversee incredibly complicated and diverse production, processing, and distribution systems to fulfill demand.

It also means that when something goes wrong, the consequences can be severe. In July 2026, it was revealed that some commercially sold lettuce in the United States contained the parasite Cyclospora. The resulting foodborne illnesses caused hundreds of hospitalizations and several deaths. Producer Taylor Farms was pressured to recall its lettuce in 27 states, and the company is now losing business and under intense scrutiny.

It is simply essential that businesses, especially those in industries where the safety of the public is at stake, be equipped with the tools to quickly and correctly address crises. They need a strong ethical framework to help them navigate challenging situations and make difficult decisions.

Ethics are the basic principles (such as integrity, transparency, and trust) that govern our behavior. In the business world, ethics are essential to navigating issues ranging from individual employee conflicts to corporate sustainability practices. For organizations in the food industry, demonstrating sound ethical principles ensures that no matter what comes their way—whether it be logistical failures, like product shortages and transportation breakdowns, or public health emergencies, like contaminated or diseased food—they can reduce societal harm and maintain stakeholder trust.

High School Topic

Tony is the CEO of Prime Label Meats, a beef and poultry processing company. Prime Label is one of the largest meat companies in the country and sells hundreds of millions of pounds of meat every week.

The quality assurance team brings an urgent development to Tony: Traces of a highly dangerous and infectious bacterium were found in a small batch of their beef product. Thankfully, this was an isolated incident, and the bacteria have been contained. The quality team has identified the cattle herd and processing plant that sourced the infected beef and has adjusted production and quarantine patterns accordingly. The team is continuing to run tests nationwide to find any additional traces of the bacteria.

But seeing as Prime Label distributes massive amounts of beef every day, it will be impossible to check every batch. Tony consults with the operations and legal teams, and he is considering enacting a complete recall of all their beef products. A recall is the only way to ensure that all infected beef is identified and customers aren't harmed.

However, a consultation with the financial and public relations teams makes Tony hesitate. The company's CFO warns him that a total beef recall would have grave consequences. Prime Label would experience huge losses that might take years—or even decades—to recover from.

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Furthermore, the food industry as a whole would suffer. Supermarkets, cattle ranchers, and fast food restaurants would all take serious hits.

The public relations team also reminds Tony that a recall would likely incite panic among customers. Consumer trust in Prime Label would plummet, as would trust in any restaurant or retailer that sells beef. The finance and PR teams suggest resuming most operations as normal, and perhaps not even informing the public of the contamination in the first place.

What do you think Tony should do? Should he implement the recall? Should he inform the public of the food safety issue? How should Prime Label balance consumer safety with the broader economic consequences of their decisions?

Suggested Questions

- What ethical principles (e.g., respect, transparency, integrity, trust, fairness, accountability, viability, rule of law) play a role in this dilemma? Does one play a larger role than others? Which one—and why is that the case?
- Who will be impacted by Tony's decision in this dilemma? Which stakeholders should Tony prioritize?
- Consider the different Prime Label departments mentioned in this scenario: quality assurance, operations, legal, finance, public relations. How should Tony balance the perspectives, input, and objectives of these different teams as he manages this dilemma?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Ethics (High School)

Objective Test Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Communication Skills (10 test items)

1. Demonstrate active listening skills (CO:017, LAP-CO-017) (PQ)
2. Explain the nature of effective communications (EI:007, LAP-EI-140) (PQ)
3. Foster open, honest communication (EI:129, LAP-EI-129) (SP)

Self-Awareness (15 test items)

1. Describe the nature of emotional intelligence (EI:001, LAP-EI-001) (PQ)
2. Recognize and overcome personal biases and stereotypes (EI:017, LAP-EI-917) (PQ)
3. Assess personal strengths and weaknesses (EI:002, LAP-EI-902) (PQ)
4. Assess personal behavior and values (EI:126, LAP-EI-126) (PQ)
5. Assess risks of personal decisions (EI:091, LAP-EI-091) (PQ)

Doing the Right Thing (30 test items)

1. Demonstrate honesty and integrity (EI:022, LAP-EI-138) (PQ)
2. Demonstrate responsible behavior (EI:021, LAP-EI-021) (PQ)
3. Demonstrate fairness (EI:127, LAP-EI-127) (PQ)
4. Take responsibility for decisions and actions (EI:075, LAP-EI-075) (PQ)
5. Build trust in relationships (EI:128, LAP-EI-128) (CS)
6. Describe the nature of ethics (EI:123, LAP-EI-123) (CS)
7. Explain reasons for ethical dilemmas (EI:124, LAP-EI-124) (CS)
8. Recognize and respond to ethical dilemmas (EI:125, LAP-EI-125) (CS)
9. Explain the use of feedback for personal growth (EI:003, LAP-EI-903) (PQ)
10. Show empathy for others (EI:030, LAP-EI-030) (PQ)
11. Comply with the spirit and intent of laws and regulations (BL:163, LAP-BL-163) (CS)

Teamwork Skills (15 test items)

1. Participate as a team member (EI:045, LAP-EI-045) (CS)
2. Treat others with dignity and respect (EI:036, LAP-EI-036) (PQ)
3. Foster positive working relationships (EI:037, LAP-EI-037) (CS)
4. Assess long-term value and impact of actions on others (EI:137, LAP-EI-137) (SP)

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Leadership Skills (20 test items)

1. Explain the concept of leadership (EI:009, LAP-EI-909) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of ethical leadership (EI:131, LAP-EI-131) (CS)
3. Model ethical behavior (EI:132, LAP-EI-132) (CS)
4. Determine personal vision (EI:063, LAP-EI-063) (CS)
5. Inspire others (EI:133, LAP-EI-133) (CS)
6. Develop an achievement orientation (EI:027, LAP-EI-027) (CS)
7. Enlist others in working toward a shared vision (EI:060, LAP-EI-060) (CS)

Career Readiness (10 test items)

1. Set personal goals (PD:018, LAP-PD-918) (CS)
2. Follow rules of conduct (PD:251, LAP-PD-251) (CS)
3. Make decisions (PD:017, LAP-PD-017) (CS)
4. Demonstrate problem-solving skills (PD:077, LAP-PD-077) (CS)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

Daniels Fund. *Daniels Fund Ethics Initiative*. https://www.danielsfund.org/ethics/overview

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Ethics Unwrapped. https://ethicsunwrapped.utexas.edu

Harvard Business School Online. *What are business ethics & why are they important?* https://online.hbs.edu/blog/post/business-ethics

Markkula Center for Applied Ethics. https://www.scu.edu/ethics/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Ethics (High School)

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

Business Ethics Pre-Judged Asset (Report) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Content					
Identifies and defines ethical issues presented in the topic	*No identification of ethical issues as it relates to the event guidelines*	*Identifies OR defines the ethical issues*	*Identifies and defines the ethical issues*	*Identifies and defines the ethical issues using industry terminology*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Explains why the ethical issues happened	*No reasons cited for the ethical issues*	*Reasons for the ethical issues identified but were not on target*	*Several, but not all, reasons accurately identified*	*All reasons addressed and analyzed*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Provides logical solutions as to how the ethical issues should be resolved	*No solutions are presented, or solutions are unrelated to the identified ethical issue.*	*One solution is presented, but it lacks clarity, relevance, or logical support.*	*One or two logical solutions are provided, showing understanding of the ethical issue and supported with some reasoning.*	*Two or more well-reasoned, clearly explained solutions are provided, demonstrating strong understanding of the ethical issue and supported with credible evidence or analysis.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Recommends safeguards that should have been in place to prevent the ethical issues	*No safeguards are identified or proposed.*	*One general safeguard is mentioned, but it lacks detail, relevance, or explanation of how it would prevent the issue.*	*One or two relevant safeguards are recommended, with a basic explanation of how they could have prevented the ethical issue.*	*Two or more clearly defined, realistic safeguards are recommended and thoroughly explained, showing strong understanding of how each could have proactively addressed or prevented the ethical dilemma*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Business Interviews & Integration of Insights	*No business interviews are included, or interviews are mentioned without any explanation or relevance to the recommendations.*	*Fewer than three businesspeople are interviewed, or the explanation of their input is unclear or only loosely connected to the recommendations.*	*Three interviews are completed, and findings are summarized with a basic explanation of how insights influenced the recommendations.*	*Three or more interviews are clearly summarized, and insights are thoughtfully analyzed and directly connected to the recommendations, demonstrating a strong integration of real-world perspectives.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Report Format					
Includes correct grammar, punctuation, and spelling	*5 or more grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*3-4 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No more than 2 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No more than 1 grammar, punctuation, or spelling error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Ethics (High School)

Guideline Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Executive Summary was submitted as PDF* ✓ *Links or QR codes were not used (unless in citations)* ✓ *Executive Summary was no more than 3 pages: Page 1 title, Page 2 summary, Page 3 works cited* ✓ *Executive Summary was formatted for 8 ½" x 11" paper*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Pre-Judged Asset Total (70 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Ethics (High School)

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Business Ethics Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Content					
Identifies and defines ethical issues presented in the topic	*No identification of ethical issues as it relates to the event guidelines*	*Identifies OR defines the ethical issues*	*Identifies and defines the ethical issues*	*Identifies and defines the ethical issues using industry terminology*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Explains why the ethical issues happened	*No reasons cited for the ethical issues*	*One reason for the ethical issue(s) identified but were not on target*	*One reason identified for the ethical issue(s) identified and on target*	*Two or more reasons identified, on target, and analyzed*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Provides logical recommendations as to how the ethical issues should be resolved	*No solutions are presented, or solutions are unrelated to the identified ethical issue.*	*One solution is presented, but it lacks clarity, relevance, or logical support.*	*One or two logical solutions are provided, showing understanding of the ethical issue and supported with some reasoning.*	*Two or more well-reasoned, clearly explained solutions are provided, demonstrating strong understanding of the ethical issue and supported with credible evidence or analysis.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Recommends safeguards that should have been in place to prevent the ethical issues	*No safeguards are identified or proposed.*	*One general safeguard is mentioned, but it lacks detail, relevance, or explanation of how it would prevent the issue.*	*One or two relevant safeguards are recommended, with a basic explanation of how they could have prevented the ethical issue.*	*Two or more clearly defined, realistic safeguards are recommended and thoroughly explained, showing strong understanding of how each could have proactively addressed or prevented the ethical dilemma*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Research shows quality and related information to the ethical issues and incorporates input of businesspeople interviewed	*No research done with 3 or more inaccurate statements*	*Research is unrelated to the ethical topic and 1-2 inaccurate statements*	*All research is accurate with no reference made to supporting evidence*	*Research is accurate with supporting evidence provided; incorporates input of businesspeople interviewed as part of presentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Ethics (High School)

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	*Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines*	*Execution Aligned with Guidelines:* ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Law (High School)

Business Law challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of the legal system and its impact on business operations through an objective test. This event covers topics such as contracts, ethics, employment law, and consumer protection, encouraging members to explore the legal foundations of business.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

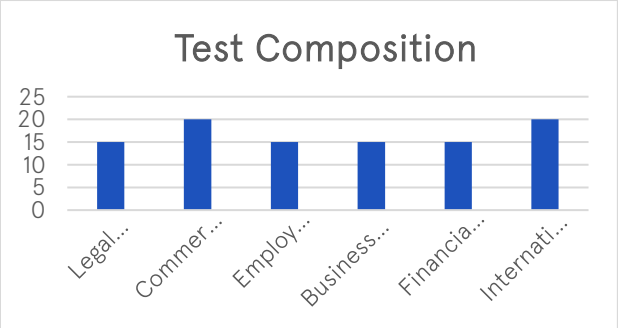
Important Notes:
- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Legal Foundations
- Commercial Law
- Employment Law
- Business Ethics
- Financial & Tax Law
- International Trade & Commerce Law



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Law (High School)

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Legal Foundations (15 test items)

1. Comply with the spirit and intent of laws and regulations (BL:163, LAP-BL-163) (CS)
2. Discuss the nature of law and sources of law in the United States (BL:067) (SP)
3. Describe the United States' judicial system (BL:068) (SP)
4. Describe the nature of legal procedure (BL:070) (SP)
5. Discuss the role of administrative law (BL:074) (SP)
6. Explain types of business ownership (BL:003, LAP-BL-003) (CS)

Commercial Law (20 test items)

1. Describe the nature of legally binding contracts (BL:002) (SP)
2. Identify the basic torts relating to business enterprises (BL:069) (SP)
3. Explain the nature of agency relationships (BL:072) (SP)
4. Discuss the nature of debtor-creditor relationships (BL:071) (SP)
5. Describe methods used to protect intellectual property (BL:051) (SP)
6. Describe legal issues affecting businesses (BL:001) (SP)
7. Discuss the nature of environmental law (BL:073) (SP)
8. Identify consumer protection provisions of appropriate agencies (PM:017, LAP-PM-917) (SP)

Employment Law (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature of human resources regulations (BL:007) (SU)
2. Explain the nature of workplace regulations (including OSHA, ADA) (BL:008) (SU)
3. Discuss employment relationships (BL:075) (SU)
4. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
5. Explain the role of ethics in human resources management (HR:411, LAP-HR-411) (SP)

Business Ethics (15 test items)

1. Describe the nature of ethics (EI:123, LAP-EI-123) (CS)
2. Explain the reasons for ethical dilemmas (EI:124, LAP-EI-124) (CS)

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3. Recognize and respond to ethical dilemmas (EI:125, LAP-EI-125) (CS)
4. Explain the nature of ethical leadership (EI:131, LAP-EI-131) (CS)
5. Model ethical behavior (EI:132, LAP-EI-132) (CS)
6. Explain the nature of business ethics (EC:106, LAP-EC-106) (SP)

Financial & Tax Law (15 test items)

1. Explain legal responsibilities associated with consumer financial products and services (FI:063) (CS)
2. Explain the purposes and importance of credit (FI:002, LAP-FI-002) (CS)
3. Explain legal considerations for accounting (FI:353) (SP)
4. Explain legal considerations for finance (FI:356) (SP)
5. Describe the nature of taxes (EC:072, LAP-EC-072) (SP)

International Trade & Commerce Law (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature of import/export law (BL:145) (SP)
2. Describe the nature of customs regulations (BL:126) (SP)
3. Explain the nature of trade regulations (BL:004) (MN)
4. Discuss the nature and sources of international law (i.e., treaties and international customs) (BL:142) (MN)
5. Explain the nature of global trade (EC:016, LAP-EC-916) (SP)
6. Describe the impact of the political environment on world trade (EC:113, LAP-EC-113) (SP)
7. Discuss the impact of bribery and foreign monetary payments on business (EC:140) (SP)
8. Explain labor issues associated with global trade (EC:101) (SU)

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

American Public Library System. *What is business law – and why is it important?* https://www.apu.apus.edu/area-of-study/security-and-global-studies/resources/what-is-business-law/

Britannica Money. *Business law*. https://www.britannica.com/money/business-law

University of Pittsburgh. *What is business law? Exploring the importance for companies*. https://online.law.pitt.edu/blog/what-is-business-law

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Business Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of core management principles through an objective test and a role play scenario. Members apply their knowledge to real-world business situations involving planning, organizing, leading, and decision-making within an organizational setting.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

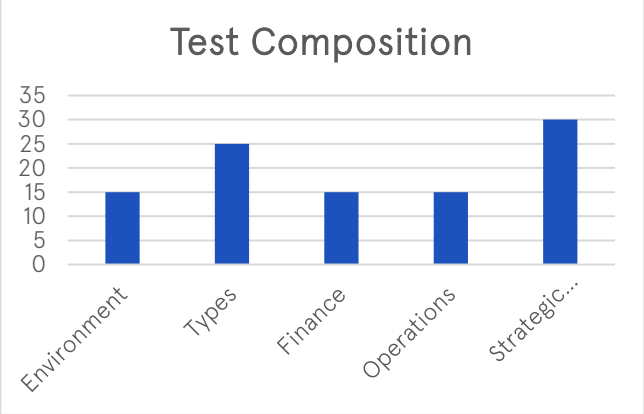
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Business Environment
- Management Types
- Business Finance
- Operations
- Strategic Management

Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Business Management

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a management-related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)
- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Business Environment (15 test items)

1. Explain the role of business in society (EC:070, LAP-EC-070) (CS)
2. Describe types of business activities (EC:071, LAP-EC-071) (CS)
3. Describe types of business models (EC:138) (SP)
4. Discuss the global environment in which businesses operate (EC:104) (SP)
5. Describe legal issues affecting businesses (BL:001) (SP)
6. Explain the organizational design of businesses (EC:103) (SP)

Management Types (25 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of project management (OP:158, LAP-OP-158) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of information management (NF:110, LAP-NF-110) (CS)
4. Discuss the nature of customer relationship management (CR:016, LAP-CR-016) (SP)
5. Discuss the nature of supply chain management (OP:303, LAP-OP-303) (SP)
6. Explain the nature of change management (SM:095) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of knowledge management (KM:001, LAP-KM-001) (SP)
8. Explain the nature of quality management (QM:001, LAP-QM-001) (SP)
9. Explain the nature of risk management (SM:075, LAP-SM-075) (SP)

Business Finance (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature of balance sheets (FI:093, LAP-FI-093) (SP)
2. Describe the nature of income statements (FI:094, LAP-FI-094) (SP)
3. Describe the nature of budgets (FI:106, LAP-FI-106) (SP)
4. Describe the nature of cash flow statements (FI:091, LAP-FI-091) (SP)
5. Develop company's/department's budget (FI:099, LAP-FI-099) (MN)
6. Interpret financial statements (FI:102) (MN)

Operations (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature of operations (OP:189, LAP-OP-189) (CS)
2. Discuss the nature of business analysis (OP:327) (SP)
3. Discuss business process thinking and its impact (OP:474) (SP)
4. Explain the concept of supply chain (OP:443, LAP-OP-443) (CS)

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5. Explain the impact of supply chains on business performance (OP:477, LAP-OP-477) (SP)

Strategic Management (30 test items)

1. Explain the concept of management (SM:001, LAP-SM-001) (CS)
2. Explain factors that affect management (SM:100) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of managerial planning (SM:063) (SP)
4. Explain managerial considerations in organizing (SM:064, LAP-SM-064) (SP)
5. Describe managerial considerations in staffing (SM:065, LAP-SM-065) (SP)
6. Discuss managerial considerations in directing (SM:066, LAP-SM-066) (SP)
7. Describe the nature of managerial control (control process, types of control, what is controlled) (SM:004, LAP-SM-004) (SP)
8. Explain the nature of managerial ethics (SM:002, LAP-SM-002) (MN)
9. Explain the nature of business plans (SM:007, LAP-SM-007) (MN)
10. Select and apply metrics for measuring organizational success (SM:074) (MN)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Asana. *How to implement a strategic management process.* https://asana.com/resources/strategic-management-stages

Business.com. *8 branches of business management.* https://www.business.com/articles/8-branches-of-business-management/

ProofHub. *What is business management? A comprehensive guide.* https://www.proofhub.com/articles/business-management

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Business Management Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: Business Environment / Management Types / Business Finance / Operations / Strategic Management	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Plan

Business Plan gives members the opportunity to develop and present a comprehensive plan for launching a new business. This event highlights the importance of business planning as a tool for evaluating, organizing, and communicating a business concept. It includes a pre-judged asset (written report) and a live presentation to a panel of judges.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **PDF Prejudge asset due by the state set deadline**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

The business must not have been in operation more than 12 months prior to the first level of competition (district/region/section or state).

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Plan

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Report

Submission Deadline

- A PDF of the report must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- QR codes and links are not allowed in the asset.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the project. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- Assets must be new, original work and may not have been submitted at any previous National Leadership Conference.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information

- **Number of Pages:** The report will be no more than seventeen (17) pages.
- Reports should follow the rating sheet sequence and be formatted to fit on 8 ½" x 11" paper.
- The first page (front cover) should include the name of school, state, name of the business, and school year (2026-2027) on the cover.
- The second page must include a table of contents and each page must be numbered.
- Divider pages and appendices are optional and must be included in the page count.
- The business must not have been in operation more than 12 months prior to the first level of competition (district/region/section or state).
- Reports will follow this sequence, mirroring the rating sheet:
  - *Executive Summary:* Provides a brief synopsis of the key points and strengths included in the plan.
  - *Company Profile:* Includes basic details of the business, including an overview, mission statement, location, legal structure and governance, organization and goals.
  - *Industry Analysis:* Provides an analysis of the larger industry in which the business will belong, analyzes key trends and strategic opportunities in the industry, demonstrates an understanding and awareness of external business decisions.
  - *Target Market:* Provides a brief overview of the nature and accessibility of the targeted audience. Analyzes the market's potential, current patterns, and sensitivities.

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- *Competitive Analysis:* Includes an honest and complete analysis of the business' competition and demonstrates an understanding of the business' relative strengths and weaknesses.
- *Marketing Plan and Sales Strategy:* Demonstrates how the business' product or service will be marketed and sold, includes both strategic and tactical elements of the marketing and sales approach.
- *Operations:* Provides an overview of business operations on a day-to-day basis, including production processes, physical facility reviews, use of technology, and processes followed to ensure delivery of products or services.
- *Management and Organization:* Describes the key participants in the new business venture and identifies human resources the business can draw upon as part of the management team, employee pool, consultants, directors, or advisers. It also portrays the role each will play in the business' development and discusses compensation and incentives.
- *Long-Term Development:* Gives a clear vision of where the business will be in three (3), five (5) or more years. It offers an honest and complete evaluation of the business' potential for success and failure and identifies priorities for directing future business activities.
- *Financials:* Indicate the accounting methodology to be used by the business. Discuss any assumptions made in projecting future financial results. Present projections honestly and conservatively.
- *Appendix:* Includes copies of key supporting documents (e.g., certifications, licenses, tax requirements, codes, letters of intent or advance contract, endorsements, etc.).

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.

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- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged asset, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in the presentation

- Business Concept and Company Profile
- Marketing Aspects
- Operations and Management Plans
- Financial Documents & Projections
- Risks & Adverse Results
- Long-Term Goals

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

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Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged asset, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in the presentation

- Business Concept and Company Profile
- Marketing Aspects
- Operations and Management Plans
- Financial Documents & Projections
- Risks & Adverse Results
- Long-Term Goals

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Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score will be added to the preliminary presentation round scores to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Plan

Future Business Leaders of America

Business Plan Pre-Judged Asset (Report) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Executive Summary *Provide brief and concise Executive Summary. Convince reader that business concept is sound and has a reasonable chance of success*	*No Executive Summary*	*Executive Summary is provided but does not show evidence of sound business concept OR reasonable chance of success*	*Executive Summary is proved AND show evidence of sound business concept and reasonable chance of success*	*Executive Summary serves as a strong introduction and transitions into the remainder of the report*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Develop Company Profile *Legal form of business* *Effective date of business* *Company mission statement/vision* *Company governance* *Company location(s)* *Immediate development goals* *Overview of company's financial status*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Present Industry Analysis *Description of industry (size, growth rates, history)* *Trends and strategic opportunities with industry*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Present Target Market *Target market defined (size, growth, potential, needs)* *Effective analysis of market's potential, current patterns, and sensitivities*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Discuss Competition *Key competitors identified* *Effective analysis of competitors' strengths and weaknesses* *Potential future competitors* *Barriers to entry for new competitors identified*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Marketing Plan & Sales Strategy *Key message to be communicated identified* *Options for message delivery identified and analyzed including Web process* *Sales procedures and methods defined*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Operations *Business facilities described* *Production plan defined and analyzed* *Workforce plan defined and analyzed* *Impact of Technology*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Plan

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Management & Organization *Key employees/principals identified and described* *Board of Directors, advisory committee, consultants, and other human resources identified and described* *Plan for identifying, recruiting, and securing key participants described* *Compensation and incentives plan*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Provide Long-term Development *Goals for three, five, or more years are identified and documented* *Risks and potential adverse results identified and analyzed* *Strategy in place to take business toward long-term goals*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Financials *Type of accounting system to be used is identified* *Financial projections are included and reasonable* • *Year 1 monthly cash flow* • *Year 1 monthly income statement* • *Yearly income statements for Years 1, 3 and 5*	*More than one of the components listed is not addressed*	*Description of one or more components is limited OR one or more components is not described*	*All components are described adequately*	*All components are described adequately with supporting documentation*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Report Format					
Format and design a business report	*Does not format document*	*Inconsistent formatting, excessive white space, and/or unrelated graphics and/or photos*	*Consistent formatting throughout the report*	*Utilizes full bleed, effective use of space, related defined graphics, and consistent formatting*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Include correct grammar, punctuation, and spelling	*5 or more grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*3-4 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No spelling errors, and not more than 2 grammar or punctuation errors*	*No spelling error, and not more than 1 grammar or punctuation error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Guideline Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Report was submitted as PDF* ✓ *Links or QR codes were not used (unless in citations)* ✓ *Report was 17 pages or under* ✓ *Report followed the sequence of the rating sheet & formatted for 8 ½" x 11" paper* ✓ *Cover Page with all criteria listed, table of contents included, all pages are numbered* ✓ *Business not in operation for longer than 12 months*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Pre-judged Asset Total (190 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Plan

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Business Plan Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Describes business concept and company profile	*No evidence of business concept or company profile*	*Business concept OR company profile described*	*Business concept AND company profile explained*	*Business concept and company profile explained including how the concept matches the profile*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Explains marketing aspects of business	*No marketing evident*	*One aspect of marketing explained*	*Two aspects of marketing explained*	*Three or more aspects of marketing to increase company presentation explained*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describes operations and management plans	*No evidence of company, operations plan, or management plan*	*Description of operations OR management plan*	*Description of operations AND management plan*	*Detailed description of operations and management with plan for future growth*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Provides information on financial documents and projections	*No evidence of financial documents or company projections*	*Provides information on at least one financial document OR one projection*	*Provides information on two financial documents and at least one projection*	*Provides information on at least three financial documents and at least three projections*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies and analyzes risks and adverse results and provides plan to avoid adverse results	*No evidence of risks or adverse results*	*One risk OR adverse result is given: no evidence of planning*	*Two risks and at least one adverse result identified; includes a plan with at least one step to avoid adverse results*	*Three risks and at least one adverse result identified; includes a plan with at least two steps to avoid adverse results*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies long-term goals	*No goals identified*	*Only one goal identified*	*Two goals identified*	*Three or more goals identified with specific plan to achieve the goals*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Business Plan

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 max)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Career Portfolio

Future Business Leaders of America

Career Portfolio gives members the opportunity to showcase their accomplishments, skills, and career goals in a professional portfolio format. Members present their portfolio to a panel of judges, demonstrating personal growth, education, training, and readiness for future career opportunities.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Career Portfolio

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Electronic Career Portfolio at a previous National Leadership Conference are not eligible to compete in this event.**
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.

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- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

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Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in their presentation

- **Resume Review with Visual Aids**
  - Clearly demonstrate how experiences, qualifications, awards, and skills align with the selected career.
  - Make direct connections between specific resume elements and career requirements or expectations.
- **Comprehensive Career Research**
  - Present a thorough overview of the chosen career, including required education or training, typical responsibilities, and long-term outlook.
  - Integrate relevant statistics, data, salary information, and potential challenges associated with the career.
- **Connection to School and Work Experience**
  - Highlight relevant school-based activities, work-based learning, coursework, leadership roles, and/or work experiences.
  - Provide analysis of how these experiences have contributed to career interest and preparation for future goals.
- **Skills, Awards, and Certifications**
  - Identify at least one special skill, award, or proficiency that directly correlates to a required or desirable skill in the chosen career.
  - Where applicable, connects the skill or recognition to a formal certification, endorsement, or credential relevant to the field.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

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Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in their presentation

- Resume Review with Visual Aids
  - Clearly demonstrate how experiences, qualifications, awards, and skills align with the selected career.
  - Make direct connections between specific resume elements and career requirements or expectations.
- Comprehensive Career Research
  - Present a thorough overview of the chosen career, including required education or training, typical responsibilities, and long-term outlook.
  - Integrate relevant statistics, data, salary information, and potential challenges associated with the career.
- Connection to School and Work Experience
  - Highlight relevant school-based activities, work-based learning, coursework, leadership roles, and/or work experiences.

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    - Provide analysis of how these experiences have contributed to career interest and preparation for future goals.
- Skills, Awards, and Certifications
    - Identify at least one special skill, award, or proficiency that directly correlates to a required or desirable skill in the chosen career.
    - Where applicable, connects the skill or recognition to a formal certification, endorsement, or credential relevant to the field.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Career Portfolio

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Career Portfolio Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Resume	*Resume not included or demonstrated*	*Provides a review of resume including experiences, qualification, and special skills*	*Provides a review of resume including experiences such as work and community service, qualifications, related awards and special skills*	*Provides a review of resume using multiple visual aids and explains how their experiences, qualifications, awards, and skills relate to the chosen career*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Career Research	*Career research not included or demonstrated*	*Shares research on desired career*	*Shares research on desired career and correlates personal qualifications to this career*	*Shares research and qualifications for career and incorporates statistics, data, salary, and obstacles*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Career Related Education	*No demonstration of career related education*	*Shares information about school activities and work experiences*	*Shares information about school activities and work experiences and how one prepared for the other*	*Shares information about school activities and work experiences and, in detail, shares about the impact on their future career*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Special Skills or Proficiencies	*No demonstration of special skills, awards, or proficiencies*	*Shares about one special skill, award, or proficiency related to desired career*	*Shares about one special skill, award, or proficiency related to desired career they have earned and how it makes them qualified for their selected career*	*Shares and correlates at least one special skill, award, or proficiency related to desired career skill that is linked to a certification or endorsement*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Use of portfolio in presentation	*Portfolio is not mentioned or used in the presentation*	*Portfolio is mentioned in the presentation*	*Portfolio is used during the presentation*	*Portfolio is used to enhance the presentation about the career and education*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Did not appear prepared*	*Was prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Career Portfolio

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Coding & Programming

Future Business Leaders of America

Coding & Programming challenges members to design and develop a standalone application that solves a specific problem or accomplishes a defined task. Members present their completed program to a panel of judges, demonstrating technical skills, logic, and creativity in software development.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access**: Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Serving the Community: Nonprofit Volunteer Management

Nonprofit organizations rely on volunteers to support programs, events, and community initiatives. Effectively managing volunteer information, service opportunities, schedules, and participation can help organizations operate more efficiently and increase their impact.

Use your programming skills to develop a program that helps nonprofit organizations recruit, organize, and manage volunteers and community service activities. Your program may be a command-line application, desktop application, or interactive interface. Choose the platform that best demonstrates your programming skills.

Your solution should help nonprofit organizations coordinate volunteers, manage service opportunities, maintain records, and monitor participation while supporting the needs of both volunteers and organization leaders.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Coding & Programming

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

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- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- The development, usability and functionality of the program must be demonstrated and explained to the judges.
- Solution must run standalone with no programming errors.
- Data must be free of viruses/malware.
- Competitors must provide comprehensive documentation including a readme file, source code, templates/libraries used, and documentation of any copyrighted or open-source material used.
- The presentation should follow the rating sheet and include the following:
  - **Language Selection:** Language choice is explained using industry terms and reflects the project's needs.
  - **Code Comments:** Comments are complete, logical, and enhance readability.
  - **Programming Knowledge:** Follows best practices and demonstrates advanced skills: modular design, clean logic, effective use of data types.
  - **User Experience (UX):** Includes clear design rationale and user flow, accessibility features are present.
  - **Program Intuitiveness:** Interface is easy to navigate and instructions are clear and well-integrated.
  - **Intelligent Feature:** Includes advanced functionality (e.g., Q&A, recommendations, smart filters).
  - **Input Validation:** Validates both format and meaning, Prevents crashes and provides helpful error messages.
  - **Functionality & Relevance:** Fully meets prompt requirements, instructions explain how the program addresses the topic.
  - **Output & Data Analysis:** Customizable reports or output allow for meaningful data analysis.
  - **Data Structures & Scope:** Uses arrays/lists appropriately and variable scope is logical and efficient.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- The development, usability and functionality of the program must be demonstrated and explained to the judges.
- Solution must run standalone with no programming errors.
- Data must be free of viruses/malware.
- Competitors must provide comprehensive documentation including a readme file, source code, templates/libraries used, and documentation of any copyrighted or open-source material used.
- The presentation should follow the rating sheet and include the following:
  - **Language Selection:** Language choice is explained using industry terms and reflects the project's needs.
  - **Code Comments:** Comments are complete, logical, and enhance readability.
  - **Programming Knowledge:** Follows best practices and demonstrates advanced skills: modular design, clean logic, effective use of data types.
  - **User Experience (UX):** Includes clear design rationale and user flow, accessibility features are present.
  - **Program Intuitiveness:** Interface is easy to navigate and instructions are clear and well-integrated.
  - **Intelligent Feature:** Includes advanced functionality (e.g., Q&A, recommendations, smart filters).
  - **Input Validation:** Validates both format and meaning, Prevents crashes and provides helpful error messages.
  - **Functionality & Relevance:** Fully meets prompt requirements, instructions explain how the program addresses the topic.
  - **Output & Data Analysis:** Customizable reports or output allow for meaningful data analysis.
  - **Data Structures & Scope:** Uses arrays/lists appropriately and variable scope is logical and efficient.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

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Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

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Important FBLA Documents

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Coding & Programming

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Coding & Programming Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Code Quality					
Coding language selection	*No language selected or presented*	*Language presented, without explanation*	*Language presented, with details missing*	*Language presented, with detailed explanation of selection process using industry terminology*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Appropriate use of comments, naming conventions, and proper formatting	*No comments provided*	*Comments provided but are not logical*	*Comments provided assist judges throughout the demonstration*	*Comments provided are logical, useful, and complete*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
The program is modular in a way that makes logical, readable sense	*Program does not make logical, readable sense*	*Program is either logical or readable, but not both*	*Program is logical and readable*	*Program exhibits an advanced knowledge of programming*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
User Experience					
UX Design: User Journey, Design Rationale, Accessibility Features	*No UX design presented*	*Some elements of UX design are presented*	*UX design presented, with details missing*	*UX design presented, with details about the design rationale, user journey, and accessibility features highlighted*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
User interface is intuitive or clear instructions are provided	*No instructions provided and is not intuitive*	*Instructions provided are not intuitive*	*Appropriate & clear instructions are provided*	*Program is intuitive and clear instructions are provided*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Users can easily navigate between pages	*No help menu or navigation system incorporated*	*Includes basic help menu and usable navigation*	*Interface contains no spelling errors, has interactive help menu, and has no navigation errors*	*Program use also includes an intelligent feature such as an interactive Q&A*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
User input is validated	*User input isn't validated*	*User input validation attempted, but does not catch important edge cases or is not done correctly*	*User input is validated*	*Input validation applied on both syntactical and semantic levels*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Functionality					
Program addresses all parts of the prompt	*Program does not address the topic/problem*	*Program addresses the topic/problem at a minimal level*	*Program fully addresses the topic/problem*	*Program fully addresses the topic/problem, and the correlation is explained in the instructions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Coding & Programming

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Program generates a presentable report	*Output reports are not accurate or not available*	*Output reports are not sufficient to analyze data*	*Output reports are error free and provide all necessary information to analyze data*	*Output reports allow user to customize and analyze information*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Data storage	*There is no storage of data*	*Variables are used inconsistently, or in a way that is unclear*	*Variable name and usage is clear. Variables store data that updates when necessary. Each variable performs only one job, and the correct data type is used*	*More complex data storage such as arrays and lists are used where appropriate and variable scope makes sense*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of three)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (110 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Community Service Project (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Community Service Project gives chapter members the opportunity to showcase a service initiative that addresses a need within their school or local community. The project must involve active chapter participation and demonstrate meaningful impact. This event includes a pre-judged asset and a live presentation. Consider submitting your Community Service Project as an activity within the Champion Chapter CTE Celebration.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Chapter
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **PDF Prejudge Asset submission due by state set date**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Community Service Project (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Report

Submission Deadline

- A PDF of the report must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- QR codes and links are not allowed in the asset.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the project. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- Assets must be new, original work and may not have been submitted at any previous National Leadership Conference.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information

- **Number of Pages:** The report will be no more than seventeen (17) pages.
- Reports should follow the rating sheet sequence and be formatted to fit on 8 ½" x 11" paper.
- The first page (front cover) should include the name of school, state, name of the project, and school year (2026-2027) on the cover.
- The second page must include a table of contents and each page must be numbered.
- Divider pages and appendices are optional and must be included in the page count.
- Reports must describe chapter activities conducted from the end of the 2026 State Leadership Conference to the end of the 2027 State Leadership Conference.
- Reports must describe one chapter project that serves the community. The project must be in the interest of the community and designed for chapter participation. Include: Description of the project, Chapter member involvement, Degree of impact on the community, Evidence of publicity received, Project evaluation
- *Note:* The report does not need to follow the FBLA Production Test Reference Guide, formerly known as the FBLA Format Guide.

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Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged asset, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in the presentation

- **Explain Project Development:** Clearly outline the planning process, using a chronological structure and clearly explained strategies.
- **Conduct and Evaluate Research:** Show how research was intentionally planned, carried out, and assessed to guide the project's development.
- **Demonstrate Chapter Involvement:** Show what percentage of chapter members participated and provide clear, measurable evidence of member engagement and contribution.
- **Show Meaningful Impact:** Demonstrate that the project created a lasting and dynamic change within the school or community, with strong potential to continue or grow.
- **Highlight Promotion and Recognition:** Share how the project was promoted or recognized through multiple channels by the school and/or community.
- **Reflect and Recommend:** Provide an evaluation of the project's outcomes along with thoughtful recommendations for future improvement if the project were to be repeated.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.

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- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged asset, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

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- **Highlight Promotion and Recognition:** Share how the project was promoted or recognized through multiple channels by the school and/or community.
- **Reflect and Recommend:** Provide an evaluation of the project's outcomes along with thoughtful recommendations for future improvement if the project were to be repeated.

Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score will be added to the preliminary presentation round scores to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Community Service Project (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Community Service Project Pre-Judged Asset (Report) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Project has specific goals and provides service to the community and its citizens	*Project is not a Community Service Project*	*Project has specific goals OR provides service to the community and its citizens but not both*	*Project has specific goals AND provides service to the community and its citizens*	*Project has quantitatively defined goals and indicates future activities or steps that could be taken to further the work started*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describe research into school and/or community needs	*No evidence of school and/or community research*	*Research was completed but not clearly outlined*	*Research clearly completed and clearly outlined*	*Research was planned, executed, and evaluated*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describe planning, development, and implementation of project	*No evidence of planning, development, or implementation of project*	*Planning, development, OR implementation explanation is missing*	*Planning, development, and implementation activities / steps are clearly described*	*Planning, development, and implementation activities/steps are described and rationale for types of activities is given*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Show evidence of publicity received	*No evidence of publicity received*	*Information about publicity was written in the report but no evidence of publicity is available*	*Project was recognized within the school and/or community*	*Project was recognized in more than one way by the school and/or community*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Report benefits to and degree of impact on the school and/or community	*School and/or community impact is not addressed*	*Project was completed and served a purpose*	*Project created tangible results that benefited the school and/or community*	*Project impacted the school and/or community to a level that something has dynamically changed, and the project should continue*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Evaluate the project	*No evidence of project evaluation is provided*	*Project was evaluated*	*Project was evaluated and the evaluation was assessed*	*Project was evaluated and recommendations for change were given*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Report Format					
Format and design a business report **(Note: does not need to follow Production Test Reference Guide)**	*Does not format document*	*Inconsistent formatting, excessive white space, and/or unrelated graphics and/or photos*	*Consistent formatting throughout the report*	*Utilizes full bleed, effective use of space, related defined graphics, and consistent formatting*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Include correct grammar, punctuation, and spelling	*5 or more grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*3-4 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No more than 2 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No more than 1 grammar, punctuation, or spelling error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Guideline Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Report was submitted as PDF* ✓ *Links or QR codes were not used (unless in citations)* ✓ *Report was 17 pages or under* ✓ *Report followed the sequence of the rating sheet & formatted for 8 ½" x 11" paper* ✓ *Cover Page with all criteria listed, table of contents included, all pages are numbered* ✓ *One community service project highlighted*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Pre-judged Asset Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Community Service Project (High School)

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

Community Service Project Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Describes project development and strategies used to implement project	*No evidence of project development or strategies presented*	*Project development is explained briefly; very limited strategies are utilized*	*Project development is clearly outlined. More than one strategy is outlined.*	*Project development is clearly outlined. Strategies are chronological and clearly explained.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Describes research into school or community needs	*No evidence of school and/or community research*	*Research was completed but not clearly outlined*	*Research clearly completed and clearly outlined*	*Research was planned, executed, and evaluated*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Appropriate level of chapter member involvement in project	*Chapter involvement is not explained*	*Participation was limited to 25% of chapter members*	*The project was clearly a chapter project and participated in by 50% of chapter members*	*Over 75% or more of chapter members participated and clear evidence is provided of the impact*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Degree of impact on the community and its citizens	*School and/or community impact is not addressed*	*Project was completed and served a purpose*	*Project created tangible results that benefitted the school and/or community*	*Project impacted the school and/or community to a level that something has dynamically changed, and the project should continue*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Evidence of publicity received	*No evidence of publicity received*	*Information about publicity was written in the report but no evidence of publicity is available*	*Project was promoted/recognized within the school and/or community*	*Project was promoted/recognized in more than one way by the school and/or community*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Evaluation of project effectiveness	*No evidence of project evaluation is provided*	*Project was evaluated*	*Project was evaluated and the evaluation was assessed*	*Project was evaluated and the team has created recommendations for change should the project be repeated*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Delivery Skills					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Community Service Project (High School)

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Computer Applications (High School)

Computer Applications challenges members to demonstrate their proficiency in using a variety of software applications to manage and communicate business information. Through a production test, members apply skills in word processing, spreadsheets, and presentation tools to complete real-world business tasks efficiently and accurately.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Production
Event Elements	Production Test

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

- **Production Test Time:** 2 hours
- The Production Test Reference Guide, available on the Competitive Events section of the FBLA website (www.fbla.org), may be used during the test.
- Internet: Provided during testing
- Event Schedule Notes:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Spreadsheet Functions and Formulas
- Creating and Formatting with Word Processing
- Developing Slides & Presentations
- Integrating Spreadsheets and Word Processing
- Integrating Presentations and Spreadsheets

Production tests are based on the knowledge areas and competencies outlined for this event. Detailed competencies can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
• Fully powered device for production test, including all needed programs installed for the production test • Printed Production Test Reference Guide • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Production test tasks • Internet access for submission

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Production Test Time:** 2 hours
- This event consists of a production test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors will complete a set of tasks aligned to the event knowledge areas and competencies.
- Production tests may be completed using no more than two personal devices, including one primary device and one external screen (laptop, tablet, or monitor)
- The Production Test Reference Guide, available on the Competitive Events section of the FBLA website (www.fbla.org), may be used during the test.

Scoring

- **The rating sheet will be provided on-site along with the production test.**
- Normalized production scores (using standard deviation, if multiple sections are used) will determine the top winners.
- If there is a tie, the rating sheet will be used to break the tie. The competitor who earns the highest score earliest in the order of the rating sheet will be ranked higher.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas & Competencies

A. Slide Deck Applications

1. Use software to create a slide deck with multiple types of slides incorporating effective use of text, graphics, fonts, animation, and transitions.
2. Design engaging slide presentations using features such as diagrams, customized visuals, animations, backgrounds, interactive elements (e.g., action buttons, hyperlinks), multimedia (e.g., audio and video), and speaker notes.
3. Insert and adjust visual aids—such as images, charts, icons, and infographics—within slide content using modern layout and formatting tools.
4. Create original visuals using digital drawing tools, clip art libraries, and imported graphics from design software or mobile apps.
5. Edit, crop, and export images in appropriate file formats (e.g., PNG, JPEG, SVG) for presentation use across platforms.
6. Design and format presentation slides with multimedia elements such as text, images, audio, and video.

B. Spreadsheet Applications

1. Create, edit, save, and print spreadsheets using functions (e.g., SUM, AVERAGE, MIN, MAX, COUNT, IF, AND, PMT, FV, VLOOKUP, XLOOKUP, TODAY, etc.), formulas, and data tools within spreadsheet software.
2. Organize and modify worksheet structure by inserting, deleting, moving, and copying rows, columns, and ranges.
3. Generate and customize charts and graphs with appropriate titles, legends, and formatting to visually represent spreadsheet data.
4. Rename, reorder, and link multiple worksheets within a workbook to create integrated, multi-sheet projects.
5. Enhance the visual design of spreadsheets by applying fonts, colors, cell styles, and alignment tools for improved readability and presentation.
6. Create and manipulate pivot tables to summarize, analyze, and present data trends using sorting, filtering, grouping, and calculated fields.

C. Word Processing Applications

1. Use the Production Test Reference Guide to create a variety of documents.
2. Use help features and reference materials to learn software and solve problems.
3. Create, save, and retrieve word processing files.
4. Demonstrate the use of character formatting features (bold, underline, italics, font styles and sizes, superscript, and subscript).
5. Demonstrate the use of paragraph formatting features (tabs, indentations, line spacing, and enumerated items).
6. Demonstrate the use of page formatting features (margins, justification, vertical placement, orientation, page breaks, headers, and footers).
7. Demonstrate document editing skills using spell/grammar check, thesaurus, search/replace, and other document properties.
8. Create documents using mail merge features.

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D. Application Integrations
1. Create integrated projects by combining content from word processing, spreadsheet, and slide deck application tools.
2. Collaborate using word processing, spreadsheet, and slide deck applications by inserting, reviewing, and responding to comments and tracked changes.
3. Embed charts or tables from a spreadsheet into a document or slide deck.
4. Link live spreadsheet data to word processing or slide deck applications.
5. Generate a report using spreadsheet data and summarize in a slide deck application.
6. Create a unified project across all three applications.

E. Formatting, Grammar, Punctuation, Spelling, and Proofreading
1. Apply consistent formatting and layout techniques to letters, reports, tables, spreadsheets, charts, and graphics.
2. Produce professional documents using correct grammar, spelling, punctuation, and style.
3. Use built-in editing tools (e.g., spelling and grammar check, editor suggestions, and comments) to review and revise content.
4. Apply rules for capitalization, punctuation, and number formatting while proofreading and editing documents for accuracy and clarity.
5. Export or save documents in appropriate formats (e.g., PDF, DOCX, CSV) for sharing, printing, or submission.

The Study Guide represents all knowledge areas that *may* be covered in the production test.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Computer Game & Simulation Programming

Future Business Leaders of America

Computer Game & Simulation Programming gives members the opportunity to design and develop an interactive game or simulation based on a specific topic. This event highlights the growing role of game-based solutions in business, education, and training, encouraging creativity, technical skill, and problem-solving in a real-world context.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Road to the Championship

Players take control of a high school athletic team with one goal: win the state championship. Throughout the season, they must recruit and develop athletes, manage practices and resources, maintain team morale, respond to unexpected challenges, and make strategic decisions that influence performance on and off the field.

Create a game or simulation that challenges players to build a successful program while balancing competition, leadership, planning, and long-term team development.

How will strategic decision-making help your team overcome obstacles and achieve championship success?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Computer Game & Simulation Programming

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.

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- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Concept & Game Design
  - Clear, engaging concept identifiable by all users
  - Game includes multiple outcomes
  - Rules are well-defined
- Innovation & Technical Implementation
  - Game shows creativity and originality
  - Tools, languages, and engines are clearly explained and used effectively
  - Implementation reflects advanced programming and thoughtful complexity
- Visual & Audio Design
  - Graphics and assets are consistent, purposeful, and enhance gameplay
  - Design elements support a polished user experience
  - Development tools are identified and appropriate for the style
- User Experience & Functionality
  - Game is intuitive and easy to navigate
  - Includes title screen and accessible UX features
  - Controls and mechanics are smooth, responsive, and player-friendly

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- Equipment Set-Up: 3 minutes
- Presentation: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- Question & Answer (Q&A): 3 minutes
- Note: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

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Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Concept & Game Design
  - Clear, engaging concept identifiable by all users
  - Game includes multiple outcomes
  - Rules are well-defined
- Innovation & Technical Implementation
  - Game shows creativity and originality
  - Tools, languages, and engines are clearly explained and used effectively
  - Implementation reflects advanced programming and thoughtful complexity
- Visual & Audio Design
  - Graphics and assets are consistent, purposeful, and enhance gameplay
  - Design elements support a polished user experience

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    - Development tools are identified and appropriate for the style
- User Experience & Functionality
    - Game is intuitive and easy to navigate
    - Includes title screen and accessible UX features
    - Controls and mechanics are smooth, responsive, and player-friendly

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Computer Game & Simulation Programming

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Computer Game & Simulation Programming Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Concept & Design					
Game/simulation addresses all parts of the concept/topic and guidelines	*Concept / topic are not addressed, and 3 or more guidelines not followed*	*Concept / topic not fully developed, and one or two guidelines not followed*	*Fully addresses the concept/ topic and followed all guidelines*	*User with no knowledge of the concept/topic can identify it based on use of project and followed all guidelines*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Game/simulation rules are well-defined and clearly explained	*Rules contain substantial errors affecting game play*	*Rules contain errors that have minimal impact on game play*	*Rules are error free as discovered through basic game play*	*Rules are well explained to the judges and exist within the game*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Game/simulation is challenging, but can be completed	*Game is overly simplistic and/or cannot be completed*	*Game can be completed but is simplistic*	*Game is challenging and can be completed*	*User can navigate the game with rules as defined and several outcomes are available for completion*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Innovation and creativity of the game/simulation	*No innovation or creativity is demonstrated*	*Very little innovation or creativity is demonstrated*	*Game is innovative or creative*	*Game is innovative and creative*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Implementation					
Describes programming language selection, graphic design tools, game engines, or other software used and evaluates the technical complexity and sophistication of the implementation	*Tools, languages, or software used are not identified or described. No explanation of implementation.*	*Technologies are mentioned (e.g., programming language or game engine), but explanation is vague or lacks clarity. Little to no discussion of complexity or implementation.*	*Tools and technologies are appropriate and clearly described. Some discussion of the implementation process and technical complexity is provided.*	*Tools and technologies (e.g., language, design tools, game engines) are thoroughly explained with clear rationale. The implementation demonstrates sophistication and complexity, with evaluation of effectiveness and possible improvements.*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Graphics & game assets are appropriate for concept and/or topic	*No graphics used, text-based game play*	*Graphics are included but distracting and take away from game play, graphic tools are mentioned but not explained*	*Graphics are appropriate for the concept/topic and development tool is explained*	*Graphics are appropriate for the concept/topic and tools for development are explained*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Graphics & game assets are consistently applied	*Graphics & assets not available*	*Graphics & assets not consistent*	*Graphics & assets consistently applied*	*Graphics & assets consistently applied and enhance the user experience*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Graphics & game assets are appropriate for the concept and/or topic, and their quality and consistency enhance the overall user experience	*No design principles applied*	*Color, contrast, background, typography, sound and design are distracting or busy*	*Color, contrast, background, typography, sound, and design are appropriate for the concept or topic*	*Color, contrast, background, typography, sound, and design enhance the user experience*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
User Experience					
Title screen functions & provides clear instructions	*No title screen provided*	*Title screen has limited instructions and/or functionality*	*Title screen functions and provides clear instructions*	*Title screen provided, but allows user to execute without instructions*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Computer Game & Simulation Programming

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
UX Design: User journey, design rationale, accessibility features	*No UX design presented*	*Some elements of UX design are presented*	*UX design presented, with details missing*	*UX design presented, with details about the design rationale, user journey, and accessibility features highlighted*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Users can easily navigate between pages, and the overall user engagement and enjoyment are considered	*Experience intended for the game is not defined*	*User can navigate the game but experience and purpose are not defined*	*User can navigate and complete the game following the rules*	*Game is enjoyable and takes user experience into account*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Game/Simulation controls & mechanics are intuitive	*Controls & mechanics aren't present*	*Controls & mechanics not fully present*	*Controls & mechanics are intuitive*	*Controls & mechanics are intuitive and enhance the user experience*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of three)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Computer Problem Solving

Future Business Leaders of America

Computer Problem Solving challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of computer systems, including operating systems, networking, and hardware, through an objective test. This event encourages members to apply troubleshooting and analytical skills to solve technical problems commonly encountered in the IT field.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

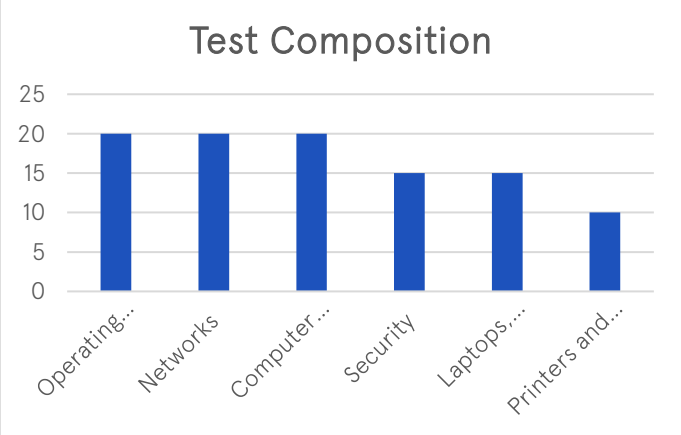
State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Operating Systems
- Networks
- Computer Hardware and Connectivity
- Security
- Laptops, Tablets, and Mobile Devices
- Printers and Peripherals

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Computer Problem Solving

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Computer Problem Solving

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Operating Systems (20 test items)

1. Explain the purpose and functions of operating systems
2. Describe primary operating system components (e.g., registry, virtual memory, file system)
3. Discuss file system characteristics and features (e.g., NTFS, FAT32, ExFAT)
4. Configure files and programs (e.g., compatibility mode, file compression, installation)
5. Discuss the characteristics of boot methods (e.g., POST, USB, Recovery)
6. Troubleshoot common operating system issues (e.g., blue screen of death, crashing, boot issues)
7. Discuss common operating system utilities (e.g., disk management, disk cleanup, system monitoring)
8. Explain considerations when upgrading an operating system
9. Use common command line tools for Windows and Linux systems (e.g., cd, mkdir, ipconfig, cat)

Networks (20 test items)

1. Explain how data is sent and received through a network (e.g., devices, protocols, IP and MAC addresses)
2. Describe different types of networks (e.g., LAN, WAN)
3. Describe the functions of common networking protocols (e.g., TCP/IP, UDP, SMTP, SSH)
4. Discuss IP addressing schemes and configurations (e.g., static, dynamic, public, private, IPv4, IPv6)
5. Describe wireless networking standards (e.g., 802.11xx) and equipment
6. Describe the characteristics of Ethernet (e.g., types, standards, capabilities)
7. Describe how DHCP and DNS assign, manage, and use IP addresses
8. Discuss the purposes and functions of common networking devices (e.g., modems, routers, switches)
9. Describe how IP and MAC addresses facilitate communication over networks

Computer Hardware and Connectivity (20 test items)

1. Describe computer components (e.g., CPU, motherboard, GPU)
2. Describe expansion cards (e.g., graphics cards, sound cards, NIC)
3. Discuss considerations when purchasing or upgrading a computer
4. Describe computer storage devices (e.g., SSD, HDD, external drives)
5. Explain peripheral cables and connectors (e.g., RJ45/11, USB, thunderbolt)
6. Describe the characteristics of network cables (e.g., cat 5e, coaxial, fiber)
7. Apply troubleshooting methodologies to identify and solve common hardware problems
8. Discuss symptoms and causes of computer power issues (e.g., lights, fans, circuit fault)

Security (15 test items)

1. Discuss the purposes and characteristics of protective measures (e.g., access control, permissions, auditing, event logging)
2. Discuss digital security threats (e.g., viruses, malware, spyware)
3. Discuss antivirus and firewall configurations
4. Discuss the danger of social engineering and ways to prevent it
5. Discuss common cyber attacks and vulnerabilities (DoS, DDoS, phishing, SQL injection, malware, etc.)

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6. Discuss types of security threats (e.g., internal or external, footprinting, spoofing)
7. Differentiate between confidentiality, integrity, and availability
8. Describe types of vulnerabilities and how to address them (e.g., non-compliance, zero-day)
9. Discuss Wi-Fi Protect Access features, versions, and characteristics

Laptops, Tablets, and Mobile Devices (15 test items)

1. Describe preventive care of laptops and mobile devices (e.g., battery, charging, heat, cleaning)
2. Discuss hardware differences between laptops, mobile devices, and desktops (e.g., RAM, CPU, efficiency, power supply)
3. Discuss cross-device data synchronization (e.g., cloud, USB, Wi-Fi)
4. Describe the capabilities, limitations, and requirements for Bluetooth
5. Troubleshoot connectivity issues on laptops and mobile devices
6. Discuss wireless connectivity methods for laptops and mobile devices (e.g., 5G, Hotspot, LTE)
7. Discuss replacement and upgrade of laptop components (e.g., RAM, adapter, battery, adapter cards)
8. Explain common hardware and power issues in laptops and mobile devices

Printers and Peripherals (10 test items)

1. Discuss printer hardware and consumables
2. Identify ports, interfaces, and cables used by printers
3. Troubleshoot printer connection issues (e.g., not responding, printer not found)
4. Determine causes of print quality issues (e.g., faded, blank, speckled, striped pages)
5. Explain basic maintenance of laser, inkjet, and thermal printers
6. Discuss printer sharing methods (e.g., PC host, network, Ethernet)
7. Customize print jobs with preferences and settings (e.g., trays, duplex, modes)

References

Association for Computing Machinery. *Information Technology Curricula 2017*. https://www.acm.org/binaries/content/assets/education/curricula-recommendations/it2017.pdf

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 1 Objectives*. https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1101-exam-objectives-(3-0)

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 2 Objectives*. https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1101-exam-objectives-(3-0)

Codecademy. *Introduction to IT*. https://www.codecademy.com/learn/introduction-to-it

GFC Global. *Computer basics*. https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/computerbasics/basic-parts-of-a-computer/1/

GeeksforGeeks. *Computer fundamentals*. https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/computer-science-fundamentals/computer-fundamentals-tutorial/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Customer Service (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Customer Service allows members to demonstrate their ability to deliver exceptional service in a professional setting. Competitors engage with internal and external customers by answering inquiries, resolving issues, and promoting positive customer experiences. This event includes an objective test and a role play to assess both knowledge and real-time interaction skills.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

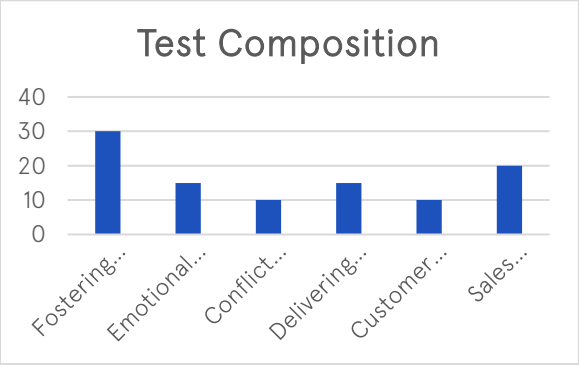
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Fostering Positive Relationships
- Emotional Intelligence
- Conflict Resolution
- Delivering on a Brand Promise
- Customer Relationship Management
- Sales Processes and Techniques

Test questions are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Customer Service (High School)

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Client Service at a previous National Leadership Conference are not eligible to compete in this event.**
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.

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- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The objective test score determines the top 15 competitors advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a customer service–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials

- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges

- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience

- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring

- The objective test score determines the top 15 competitors advancing to role play round. Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie in the role play round.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

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Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Customer Service (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fostering Positive Relationships (30 test items)

1. Explain the nature of positive customer relations (CR:003, LAP-CR-003) (CS)
2. Demonstrate a customer service mindset (CR:004, LAP-CR-004) (CS)
3. Develop rapport with customers (CR:029) (CS)
4. Reinforce service orientation through communication (CR:005) (CS)
5. Respond to customer inquiries (CR:006) (CS)
6. Interpret business policies to customers/clients (CR:007) (CS)
7. Adapt communication to the cultural and social differences among clients (CR:019) (CS)
8. Anticipate unspoken customer needs (CR:053) (CS)
9. Accommodate special needs/specific requests of customers (CR:054) (CS)
10. Build and maintain relationships with customers (CR:030) (SP)

Emotional Intelligence (15 test items)

1. Build trust in relationships (EI:128, LAP-EI-128) (CS)
2. Show empathy for others (EI:030, LAP-EI-030) (PQ)
3. Foster open, honest communication (EI:129, LAP-EI-129) (SP)
4. Treat others with dignity and respect (EI:136, LAP-EI-036) (PQ)

Conflict Resolution (10 test items)

1. Use conflict-resolution skills (EI:015, LAP-EI-915) (CS)
2. Handle difficult customers (CR:009, LAP-CR-009) (CS)
3. Handle customer/client complaints (CR:010, LAP-CR-010) (CS)
4. Determine strategies for resolving customer-service situations (CR:046) (SP)

Delivering on a Brand Promise (15 test items)

1. Identify company's brand promise (CR:001, LAP-CR-001) (CS)
2. Determine ways of reinforcing the company's image through employee performance (CR:002) (CS)
3. Explain the importance of meeting and exceeding customer/guest expectations (CR:067) (CS)

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4. Identify factors associated with positive customer experiences (CR:052) (CS)
5. Deliver positive moments of truth (CR:055) (CS)

Customer Relationship Management (10 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of customer relationship management (CR:016, LAP-CR-016) (SP)
2. Explain the role of ethics in customer relationship management (CR:017, LAP-CR-017) (SP)
3. Describe the use of technology in customer relationship management (CR:018) (SP)
4. Use Customer Relationship Management (CRM) technology (CR:024)

Sales Processes and Techniques (20 test items)

1. Establish relationship with customer/client (SE:110) (CS)
2. Determine customer/client needs (SE:111) (CS)
3. Recommend specific products (SE:114, LAP-SE-114) (CS)
4. Demonstrate good/service (SE:374, LAP-SE-374) (SP)
5. Convert customer/client objections into selling points (SE:874, LAP-SE-874) (SP)
6. Close the sale (SE:895, LAP-SE-895) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Help Scout. *21 key customer service skills (and how to develop them).* https://www.helpscout.com/blog/customer-service-skills/

HubSpot. *What is customer service?* https://blog.hubspot.com/service/customer-service

Zendesk. *What is customer service?* https://www.zendesk.com/blog/customer-service-skills/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Customer Service (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Customer Service Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Communicates position on role play scenario	*No position communicated*	*Communicates position not related to problem*	*Communicates position on problem*	*Communicates in a professional manner position on problem in scenario*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Displays empathy/diplomacy when responding to role play scenario	*No empathy or diplomacy displayed*	*Empathy or diplomacy displayed in response to role play scenario*	*Empathy and diplomacy displayed in response to role play scenario*	*Display of empathy and diplomacy skills add to resolution of role play scenario*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates conflict resolution and closure to the role play	*No closure was provided*	*Situation was closed OR conflict was resolved*	*Conflict was resolved, the situation has closure*	*Conflict was resolved, the situation has closure, and client (judge) is satisfied*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Role Play Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor did not appear prepared*	*Competitor was prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Cybersecurity

Future Business Leaders of America

Cybersecurity challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of protecting systems and data from digital threats such as viruses, malware, phishing, and spyware. Through an objective test, members explore foundational cybersecurity principles, tools, and best practices used to defend against cyberattacks.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

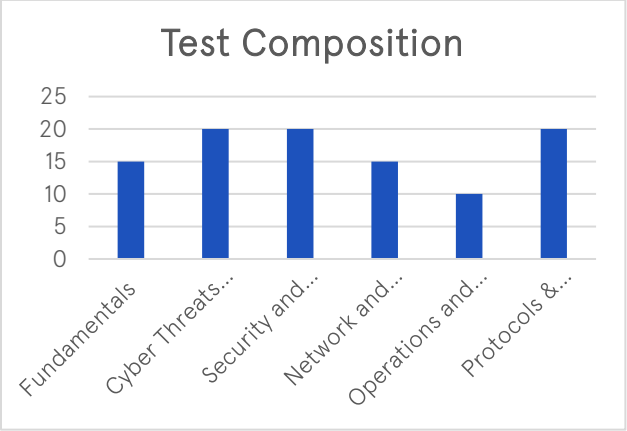
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Security Fundamentals
- Cyber Threats and Vulnerabilities
- Security and Design
- Network and Data Security
- Security Operations and Management
- Security Protocols and Threat Mitigation

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Cybersecurity

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Security Fundamentals (15 test items)

1. Describe Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability
2. Describe measures for establishing digital trust (e.g., identity proofing, non-repudiation, attestation)
3. Explain the concepts of authentication, authorization, and accounting
4. Provide examples of Zero Trust
5. Describe examples of deception and disruption technology for defending against attackers (e.g., honeypots, honeynets, honeyfiles)
6. Explain how binary, hexadecimal, and decimal are used in cryptography
7. Explain the purpose of least privilege principles

Cyber Threats and Vulnerabilities (20 test items)

1. Describe web and software sources of security vulnerabilities (e.g., injections, overflows, jailbreaking, race conditions)
2. Discuss attributes of threat actors and their goals (e.g., internal and external threats, financial gain, espionage, data theft)
3. Describe types of viruses
4. Discuss types of security vulnerabilities (e.g., backdoors, zero-days, unpatched software)
5. Discuss social engineering scams and attacks (e.g., phishing, phone scams, email scams)
6. Describe the purpose, methods, and mechanics of a DDoS attack
7. Describe the characteristics of types of malware (e.g., viruses, Trojans, worm, logic bombs)
8. Describe cryptographic attacks (e.g., downgrades, collisions, birthday attacks)
9. Discuss vulnerabilities of wireless networks

Security and Design (20 test items)

1. Explain how using cloud infrastructure affects system security
2. Discuss the security implications of microservice architecture (e.g., more attack surfaces, authentication, increased complexity)
3. Differentiate between logical and physical segmentation
4. Explain how containerization and virtualization can increase security
5. Describe security risks and challenges associated with the Internet of Things
6. Describe the concepts of backups, RAID, and UPS
7. Identify examples of the CIA triad in network design (e.g., UPS, encryption, data integrity)
8. Explain the role of testing in building secure cyber architecture

Network and Data Security (15 test items)

1. Describe the purpose of cryptography
2. Differentiate between public and private key cryptography
3. Discuss shift ciphers, Caesar ciphers, and substitution ciphers
4. Describe the three states of data
5. Describe the importance and use of access control models (e.g., MAC, DAC, RBAC)
6. Discuss authentication and authorization of network resources (e.g., multifactor, certificates, tokens)

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7. Describe how blockchains and hashing can be used for authentication and data integrity

Security Operations and Management (10 test items)

1. Describe common security policies (e.g., acceptable use, information security, business continuity, disaster recovery)
2. Discuss elements of disaster prevention and recovery plans
3. Describe types of firewalls (e.g., network-based, NGFW, WAF)
4. Explain the use of firewall access lists and rules to increase security
5. Describe best practices for company messaging, email, and data security
6. Describe the impact of change management on security

Security Protocols and Threat Mitigation (20 test items)

1. Provide examples of secure protocols (e.g., SSH, HTTPS, TLS, WPA2)
2. Describe the purpose of intrusion prevention and detection systems
3. Describe policies and practices to prevent viruses, phishing and email scams
4. Explain methods of obfuscation (e.g., tokenization, data masking, steganography)
5. Describe how strong passwords increase security
6. Describe the purpose of digital certificates and Certificate Authorities (CAs)
7. Describe the importance of patches, updates, and version control for security
8. Explain the use of pen testing for increasing security

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

Adelaide University. *Cyber security basics: Exploring the fundamentals of cyber security*. https://online.adelaide.edu.au/blog/cyber-security-fundamentals

Association for Computing Machinery. *Cybersecurity Curricula 2017*. https://cybered.hosting.acm.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/02/newcover_csec2017.pdf

Codecademy. *Introduction to cybersecurity*. https://www.codecademy.com/learn/introduction-to-cybersecurity

CompTIA. *Security+ Certification Exam Objectives*. https://assets.ctfassets.net/82ripq7fjls2/6TYWUym0Nudqa8nGEnegjG/0f9b974d3b1837fe85ab8e6553f4d623/CompTIA-Security-Plus-SY0-701-Exam-Objectives.pdf

Cybersecurity Guide. *Mastering the basics: A comprehensive guide to cybersecurity 101 for the digital age*. https://cybersecurityguide.org/resources/cybersecurity-101/

The Academic Initiative of the Cyber Innovation Center. *K-12 Cybersecurity Learning Standards*. https://cyber.org/sites/default/files/2021-10/K-12%20Cybersecurity%20Learning%20Standards_1.0.pdf

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Data Analysis

Future Business Leaders of America

Data Analysis challenges members to examine and interpret a data set to uncover insights and inform decision-making. Members present their findings to a panel of judges, demonstrating analytical thinking, data visualization, and the ability to draw meaningful conclusions.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety**

2026-2027 Topic

From donating food to giving blood, there have never been more ways to support our communities.

Flinders Street Technology is a fictional technology services provider organized as a Public Benefit Corporation, operating in the United States and 31 other countries. Flinders Street Tech is developing a Social Impact Plan for the communities it serves in the US. It wants to understand how formal and informal volunteering, charitable giving, and other measures of social engagement have changed over time across the US.

Using the data provided and your own research, identify relevant trends and recommend priorities for the plan.

- 2023 CEV
- 2021 CEV
- 2019 CEV
- 2017 CEV
- Previous CEV data is available from the US Census Bureau.

Note: Some information provided may not necessarily be useful in your analysis; you do not need to use all the information provided.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Data Analysis

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Use of Industry Terminology:** Apply accurate, field-specific terminology to explain concepts, methods, and findings.
- **Depth of Analysis & Global Context:** Provide a thorough, industry-standard analysis of the data and connect findings to broader implications, including global, societal, or economic impact.
- **Visualizations & Interpretation:** Include at least three competitor-created visuals to clearly illustrate trends.
- **Recommendations & Feasibility:** Present a realistic and well-supported recommendation, identify necessary resources and justify the plan with data and credible sources.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

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Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Use of Industry Terminology:** Apply accurate, field-specific terminology to explain concepts, methods, and findings.
- **Depth of Analysis & Global Context:** Provide a thorough, industry-standard analysis of the data and connect findings to broader implications, including global, societal, or economic impact.
- **Visualizations & Interpretation:** Include at least three competitor-created visuals to clearly illustrate trends.
- **Recommendations & Feasibility:** Present a realistic and well-supported recommendation, identify necessary resources and justify the plan with data and credible sources.

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Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Data Analysis

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Data Analysis Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the event topic during presentation	*No understanding of event topic OR incorrect topic used*	*Understanding of topic inconsistent with event guidelines*	*Demonstrates understanding of the topic during the presentation*	*Demonstrates use of industry terminology of the topic during the presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Provides analysis of data	*No attempt made to analyze the data*	*Limited, surface-level analysis provided*	*Provides analysis of the data*	*Provides deep, industry-standard analysis of data and addresses broader global impact*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Provides visualizations of data	*No visualizations provided*	*One visualization provided that provides a superficial overview of data*	*Two visualizations provided that try to explain the trends found in the data*	*At least three competitor-created visualizations provided that explain the overall trends found in the data in the context of the topic*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Identifies recommendation to accomplish the purpose	*No recommendation identified*	*Recommendation provided, but plan not developed*	*Logical recommendation and plan developed*	*Feasible recommendation and plan developed, and necessary resources identified with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Uses suitable and accurate statements related to the topic's information in presentation	*More than three statements are inaccurate*	*One or two statements are inaccurate*	*All statements are accurate*	*All statements are accurate with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Data Analysis

Future Business Leaders of America

Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Data Science & AI

Future Business Leaders of America

Data Science & AI challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of data analysis, machine learning, and the principles of artificial intelligence through an objective test. This event introduces members to the role of data and AI in solving real-world problems and driving innovation across industries.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

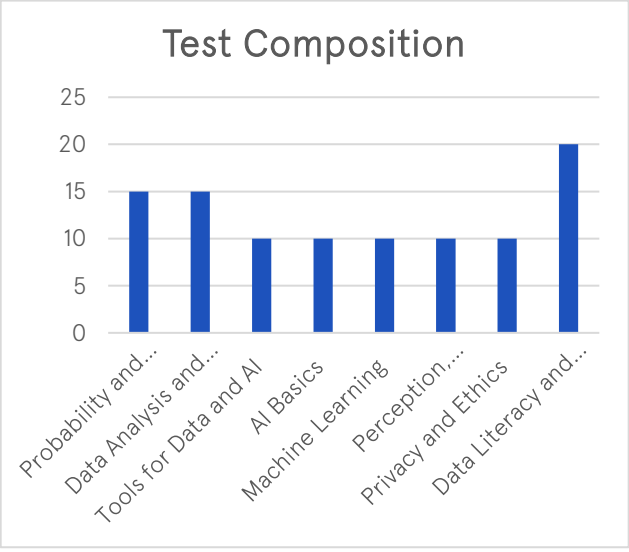
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Probability and Statistics Foundations
- Data Analysis and Statistics for AI
- Tools for Data and AI
- AI Basics
- Machine Learning
- Perception, Representation, and Reasoning
- Privacy and Ethics
- Data Literacy and Foundations

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Data Science & AI

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- `Test Duration: 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Probability and Statistics Foundations (15 test items)

1. Calculate the mean, median, mode, and range of a dataset
2. Discuss the use of measures of statistical variance (e.g., standard deviation, variance, covariance)
3. Discuss the characteristics and importance of Gaussian (normal) distribution
4. Calculate the expected value of a random variable
5. Differentiate between types of variables (e.g., continuous, discrete)

Data Analysis and Statistics for AI (15 test items)

1. Select the most appropriate visual medium to display a dataset
2. Describe different types of diagrams (e.g., boxplots, histograms, scatterplots)
3. Discuss techniques for working with multivariate data (e.g., dependence and interdependence methods, multiple linear and logistic regression)
4. Discuss the importance of cleaning data
5. Identify factors that may affect data quality (e.g., duplicates, low quality sources, incomplete datasets)
6. Describe how data science algorithms are applied to real-world problems (e.g., linear regression, decision trees, k-means)

Tools for Data and AI (10 test items)

1. Write queries in SQL
2. Describe common packages and libraries for working with data and AI (e.g., Pandas, NumPy, PyTorch)
3. Discuss the use of Python for cleaning and wrangling datasets
4. Discuss the use of R for data science
5. Describe characteristics of relational databases

AI Basics (10 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of generative AI
2. Discuss capabilities and limitations of generative AI
3. List uses of generative AI (e.g., healthcare, research, digital art)
4. Describe AI subfields (e.g., computer vision, NLP, human interaction, robotics)
5. Define large language models (LLMs)
6. Discuss the capabilities of large language models (LLMs)

Machine Learning (10 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of machine learning
2. Describe the use of training, test, and validation datasets
3. Describe how machine learning algorithms behave (e.g., neural networks, decision trees, learning functions)
4. Characterize unsupervised, supervised, and reinforcement learning algorithms
5. Select an appropriate machine learning algorithm to solve a reasoning problem (e.g., supervised, unsupervised, reinforcement)
6. Explain the concept of deep learning

Perception, Representation, and Reasoning (10 test items)

1. Explain how predicate logic is used in AI models
2. Give examples of predicate logic

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3. Discuss differences between logic-based and probability-based reasoning
4. Describe Bayesian networks and their components (e.g., nodes, edges, Directed Acyclic Graphs)
5. Discuss the nature of knowledge representation and reasoning for AI

Privacy and Ethics (10 test items)

1. Discuss dilemmas that arise from AI systems (e.g., self-driving vehicles, generative AI, surveillance)
2. Describe how AI inherits bias (e.g., algorithmic bias)
3. Discuss security and privacy risks associated with LLMs
4. Discuss credibility concerns of LLMs (e.g., hallucinations, misinformation)

Data Literacy and Foundations (20 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of data science
2. Describe differences between structured and unstructured data
3. Identify numeric and categorical data points
4. Convert among common data representations (e.g., binary, hexadecimal, decimal)
5. Describe the types of data that could be gathered from various sources
6. Describe the importance of data wrangling and transformation
7. Describe the stages of the data science process

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

AI4K12. *Grade Band Progression Charts*. https://ai4k12.org/gradeband-progression-charts/

Association for Computing Machinery. *Computing Competencies for Undergraduate Data Science Curricula*. https://www.acm.org/binaries/content/assets/education/curricula-recommendations/dstf_ccdsc2021.pdf

CodeHS. *Intro to AI Syllabus*. https://codehs.com/uploads/224a0c7cb8de30b494ec9c2286a73a28

Google Cloud. *What is artificial intelligence (AI)*. https://cloud.google.com/learn/what-is-artificial-intelligence

Harvard. *Data Science Principles*. https://www.harvardonline.harvard.edu/course/data-science-principles

IBM. *IBM Data Science Professional Certificate*. https://www.coursera.org/professional-certificates/ibm-data-science/

Youcubed. *DS Learning Objectives and Standards by Unit*. https://hsdatascience.youcubed.org/resources-standards-and-course-approval/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Animation

Digital Animation allows members to design and present an original animated video that demonstrates creativity, storytelling, and technical skill. This event assesses members' understanding and application of fundamental animation principles through a pre-judged asset and a live presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Prejudge Asset submission due by state set date**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

From Start to Finish: The Journey of a Product

Create an animated video that tells the story of how a product travels from raw materials to the hands of a customer. Your animation should illustrate the key stages of the product's journey, including sourcing materials, manufacturing, transportation, distribution, retail, and the final customer experience.

How do people, technology, and transportation work together to bring everyday products to consumers?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Digital Animation

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Animated Video

Submission Deadline

- A URL linking to the animated video must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- The animated video must not exceed two minutes in length.
- Competitors may use any animation platform of their choice.
- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- QR codes are not allowed in the project.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the project. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- Projects must be new, original work and may not have been submitted at any previous National Leadership Conference.

Responsibility for Access

- Competitors are responsible for ensuring the video URL is accessible to judges. If the video cannot be viewed, a score of zero will be given for the pre-judged portion. Best Practice Note: If using a platform such as Google Drive or OneDrive, make sure sharing settings allow access to anyone with the link. If using YouTube or Vimeo, the video must be set to "Unlisted" (not "Private") to ensure it is not publicly searchable but still viewable by judges.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

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Event Specific Information

- **Project Concept & Design:** Design elements should support and enhance the concept.
- **Project Execution**: Demonstrate creativity, clarity, and consistency, with smooth and professional edits or transitions that enhance the overall presentation. Content should follow a logical flow.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.

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- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Video Showcase
  - The pre-judged asset (video) must be played as part of your presentation.
- Presentation
  - **Development Process:** Explain how the animation was planned and developed. Use industry terms and include tangible planning materials.
  - **Production Process:** Describe how the animation was created from concept to final edit. Use correct animation terminology and include examples of drafts, revisions, or timelines.
  - **Tools & Decision-Making:** Explain what software and hardware were used and why. Compare alternatives and justify the final choices based on project goals.
  - **Animation Techniques:** Identify and explain the animation techniques used with accurate industry terminology.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*

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- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Video Showcase
  - The pre-judged asset (video) must be played as part of your presentation.
- Presentation
  - **Development Process:** Explain how the animation was planned and developed. Use industry terms and include tangible planning materials.
  - **Production Process:** Describe how the animation was created from concept to final edit. Use correct animation terminology and include examples of drafts, revisions, or timelines.
  - **Tools & Decision-Making:** Explain what software and hardware were used and why. Compare alternatives and justify the final choices based on project goals.
  - **Animation Techniques:** Identify and explain the animation techniques used with accurate industry terminology.

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Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score will be added to the preliminary presentation round scores to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Animation

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Digital Animation Pre-Judged Asset (Project) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Project Concept & Design Evaluation: Fully address the concept/ topic	*Concept/topic is not followed*	*Concept/topic not fully developed*	*Fully addresses the concept/topic*	*A user with no knowledge of the concept/topic can identify topic based on video*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Concept & Design Evaluation: Color, contrast, background, typography, sound, and design are appropriate for the concept/topic	*Design elements are missing, inconsistent, or unrelated to the concept or topic.*	*Some appropriate design choices are made, but there are issues with consistency, readability, or alignment to the topic.*	*Most design elements (color, contrast, background, typography, sound) are well chosen and support the concept or topic effectively.*	*All design elements are skillfully selected and thoughtfully applied to enhance the concept or topic. Visual and audio choices work together to create a strong, cohesive experience.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Concept & Design Evaluation: Graphics are appropriate for concept/topic	*Graphics are missing, off-topic, or unrelated to the concept.*	*Some graphics relate to the topic, but their purpose or quality is unclear or inconsistent with the concept.*	*Graphics are mostly appropriate and support the concept or topic. Visuals are clear and contribute to the animation's message.*	*Graphics are well-designed, consistently align with the concept, and strongly enhance the storytelling. Visual choices are purposeful and add clarity, tone, or emphasis to the topic.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Concept & Design Evaluation: Information related to the topic is accurate	*No information related to the topic is provided, or the information is entirely inaccurate.*	*Some information is relevant, but there are noticeable inaccuracies or missing key details.*	*Information is mostly accurate and clearly connected to the topic. Minor errors, if any, do not affect understanding.*	*All information is accurate, well researched, and clearly supports the topic. Content enhances understanding and adds depth to the animation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Evaluation: Overall quality of elements of animation	*Animation lacks basic elements such as movement or timing; appears incomplete or disjointed.*	*Animation shows limited use of animation principles. Movements may be rough, inconsistent, or distracting.*	*Animation demonstrates solid application of fundamental animation elements. Movements, timing, and transitions are generally smooth and support the story or message.*	*Animation is polished and fluid, with strong, consistent application of animation principles. Timing, movement, and transitions enhance storytelling and create a professional-quality experience.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Project Evaluation: Quality of editing and transition	*There are no transitions or evidence of video editing incorporated*	*Transitions exist but are rough and do not flow easily*	*Transitions flow seamlessly and serve as a logical component of the video*	*Multiple types of transitions are used and all flow seamlessly*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Project Evaluation: Logical flow of thoughts	*Flow of video does not seem logical*	*Flow does not connect each element of the video*	*Flow is logical and appears sequenced*	*Flow is logical including a clear beginning, middle, and end*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Evaluation: Video concludes with proper credits and acknowledgement of copyright and sources	*Video does not include credits*	*Video includes credits but they are limited*	*Video includes credits that recognize the creator, contributors, and acknowledgement of materials used*	*Video includes credits that recognize the creator, contributors, and includes written acknowledgement of copyright and sources*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Video Time	*Video is over 2 minutes*		*Video is 2 minutes or under*		
	0 points		5 points		
				Pre-judged Asset Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Animation

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Digital Animation Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the event topic	*No understanding of event topic OR incorrect topic used*	*Understanding of topic inconsistent from video to presentation*	*Demonstrates the topic through presentation*	*Demonstrates expertise of the topic through presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describes the development process	*No explanation of the development process*	*Explains the development process but does not share tangible planning documents*	*Explains the development process and shares tangible planning documents*	*Explains development process using industry terminology and displays tangible planning documents*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describes the production process	*No explanation of the production process*	*Explains the production process but does not share tangible planning documents*	*Explains the production process and shares tangible planning documents*	*Explains the production process using industry terminology and displays tangible planning documents*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describes software and hardware used	*No explanation of software and hardware used*	*Explains software OR hardware used*	*Explains software AND hardware used*	*Explains software and hardware used as well as alternative options and reasoning for final choice*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Describes animation techniques used	*No explanation of animation techniques used*	*Identifies animation techniques used*	*Identifies animation techniques used with industry terminology*	*Identifies and explains animation techniques used with industry terminology*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Copyright and source information is noted and documented, and video content is original	*Copyright information or sources not addressed or cited incorrectly AND video content is not original*	*Material violates copyright and source guidelines OR video content is not original*	*Copyright information and sources documented, and video content is original*	*Copyright compliance is documented, sources cited using visual representation and video content is original*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Animation

Future Business Leaders of America

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	*Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines*	*Execution Aligned with Guidelines:* ✓ *Pre-recorded segment is no longer than 2 minutes* ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (130 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Video Production

Digital Video Production recognizes members who demonstrate the ability to plan, produce, and present a compelling video tailored to a specific audience. This event highlights video as a powerful tool for communication and promotion and includes a pre-judged asset and a live presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Prejudge Asset submission due by state set date**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

The Power of Community: Stories That Inspire

Produce a documentary-style video that tells the story of a person, organization, business, or community initiative making a meaningful difference in your local community. Through interviews, video footage, and thoughtful storytelling, showcase the challenges they face, the work they do, and the positive impact they have on the people they serve.

How can one story inspire others to become involved and make a difference?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Digital Video Production

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Video

Submission Deadline

- A URL linking to the video must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- The video must not exceed two minutes in length.
- Competitors may use any video creation platform of their choice.
- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- QR codes are not allowed in the project.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the project. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- Assets must be new, original work and may not have been submitted at any previous National Leadership Conference.

Responsibility for Access

- Competitors are responsible for ensuring the video URL is accessible to judges. If the video cannot be viewed, a score of zero will be given for the pre-judged asset. Best Practice Note: If using a platform such as Google Drive or OneDrive, make sure sharing settings allow access to anyone with the link. If using YouTube or Vimeo, the video must be set to "Unlisted" (not "Private") to ensure it is not publicly searchable but still viewable by judges.

Judging & Ownership

- Projects will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information

- **Project Concept & Design:** Design elements should support and enhance the concept.

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- **Project Execution**: Demonstrate creativity, clarity, and consistency, with smooth and professional edits or transitions that enhance the overall presentation. Content should follow a logical flow.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

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Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Video Showcase
  - The pre-judged asset (video) must be played as part of your presentation.
- Presentation:
  - **Project Planning:** Explain how the idea was developed, including the steps taken to plan the project
  - **Project Creation:** Describe the process used to build and complete the project, including how the components were assembled and the final version was produced.
  - **Tools and Equipment:** List the programs, websites, or apps used and equipment involved, such as a microphone, tablet, or camera.
  - **Techniques Used:** Explain the methods used to create different parts of the project, providing examples of special effects, layouts, transitions, or other techniques used to enhance clarity and creativity.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).

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- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Video Showcase
  - The pre-judged asset (video) must be played as part of your presentation.
- Presentation:
  - **Project Planning:** Explain how the idea was developed, including the steps taken to plan the project
  - **Project Creation:** Describe the process used to build and complete the project, including how the components were assembled and the final version was produced.
  - **Tools and Equipment:** List the programs, websites, or apps used and equipment involved, such as a microphone, tablet, or camera.
  - **Techniques Used:** Explain the methods used to create different parts of the project, providing examples of special effects, layouts, transitions, or other techniques used to enhance clarity and creativity.

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Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score will be added to the preliminary presentation round scores to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Video Production

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Digital Video Production Pre-judged Asset (Project) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Video Content: Fully address the concept and/or topic	*Concept and/or topic is not followed*	*Concept and/or topic not fully developed*	*Fully addresses the concept and/or topic*	*A user with no knowledge of the concept and/or topic can identify topic based on video*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Video Content: Video contains multiple elements providing evidence of production skill	*No evidence of video production skill demonstrated*	*Video is designed using limited video editing skill*	*Video contains transitions and use of multiple technologies*	*Video contains multiple advanced film techniques*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Video Content: Grammar, spelling, and punctuation	*Video contains 4 or more grammar, spelling, punctuation errors*	*Video contains 3 or less spelling, grammar, or punctuation errors*	*Video contains one grammar, spelling, or punctuation error*	*Video is grammar, spelling, punctuation error free*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Video Content: Copyright information and sources are noted and documented, and video content is original	*Copyright information or sources not addressed or cited incorrectly AND video content is not original*	*Material violates copyright and source guidelines OR video content is not original*	*Copyright information and sources documented, and video content is original*	*Copyright compliance is documented, sources cited using visual representation, and video content is original*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Evaluation: Video has logical flow of information	*Flow of video does not seem logical*	*Flow does not connect each element of the video*	*Flow is logical and appears sequenced with beginning, middle, and end*	*Video is logical, flows well and includes a call to action at the end*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Project Evaluation: Quality of editing and transition	*There are no transitions or evidence of video editing incorporated*	*Transitions exist but are rough and do not flow easily*	*Transitions flow seamlessly and serve as a logical component of the video*	*Multiple types of transitions are used and all flow seamlessly*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Project Evaluation: Audio and visual elements are coordinated	*Audio and visual elements are limited*	*Audio and visual elements do not include variety*	*Audio uses a variety of sources including direct audio and dubbed audio; visual includes multiple camera angles and techniques*	*Audio and visual uses variety of sources and special effects*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Evaluation: Use of video/film techniques	*Video technology use not evident*	*Video incorporates use of film techniques*	*Video incorporates advanced use of film techniques*	*Video contains multiple advanced film techniques such as special effects*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Video Time	*Video is over 2 minutes*		*Video is 2 minutes or under*		
	0 points		5 points		
				Pre-judged Asset Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Video Production

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Digital Video Production Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the event topic	*No understanding of event topic*	*Understanding of topic inconsistent from video to presentation*	*Demonstrates the topic through presentation*	*Demonstrates expertise of the topic through presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describes the use and implementation of innovative technology	*No explanation of use or implementation of technology*	*Identification OR implementation of innovation technology*	*Implementation and demonstration of video techniques, equipment, and software*	*Expert description and demonstration of video techniques, equipment, and software*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Explains the design and development process	*No explanation or description of the design and development process*	*Competitor(s) explains the design OR development process*	*Competitor(s) explain both the design and the development process*	*Expert industry explanation of both design and development process*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Incorporates video into presentation	*Does not present video*	*Video of any length presented*	*Video is presented, but inadequate introduction and transition back into presentation*	*Video is presented, with adequate introduction and transition back into presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Copyright and source information is noted and documented, and video content is original	*Copyright information or sources not addressed or cited incorrectly AND video content is not original*	*Material violates copyright and source guidelines OR video content is not original*	*Copyright information and sources documented, and video content is original*	*Copyright compliance is documented, sources cited using visual representation and video content is original*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Digital Video Production

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Pre-recorded segment is no longer than 2 minutes* ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (120 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Economics

Economics challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of key economic concepts and principles through an objective test. This event covers topics such as supply and demand, market structures, fiscal and monetary policy, and the global economy, encouraging members to explore how economic forces shape the world.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

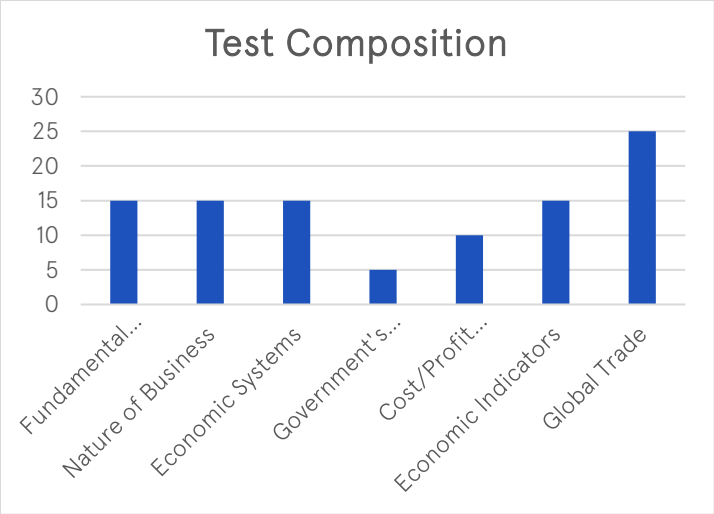
National Leadership Conference:	State/District:
Timing Structure: **Test Duration: 50 minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Fundamental Economic Concepts
- Nature of Business
- Economic Systems
- Government's Impact on Business
- Cost/Profit Relationships
- Economic Indicators
- Global Trade

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Economics

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Economics

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fundamental Economic Concepts (15 test items)

1. Distinguish between economic goods and services (EC:002, LAP-EC-902) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of economic resources (EC:003, LAP-EC-903) (CS)
3. Describe the concepts of economic and economic activities (EC:001, LAP-EC-901) (CS)
4. Determine economic utilities created by business activities (EC:004, LAP-EC-904) (CS)
5. Explain the principles of supply and demand (EC:005, LAP-EC-905) (CS)
6. Describe the functions of prices in markets (EC:006, LAP-EC-906) (CS)

Nature of Business (15 test items)

1. Explain the role of business in society (EC:070, LAP-EC-070) (CS)
2. Describe the types of business activities (EC:071, LAP-EC-071) (CS)
3. Describe the types of business models (EC:138) (SP)
4. Explain the organizational design of businesses (EC:103, LAP-EC-103) (SP)
5. Discuss the global environment in which businesses operate (EC:104, LAP-EC-104) (SP)
6. Describe factors that affect the business environment (EC:105, LAP-EC-105) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of business ethics (EC:106, LAP-EC-106) (SP)
8. Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets (EC:107, LAP-EC-107) (SP)

Economic Systems (15 test items)

1. Explain the types of economic systems (EC:007, LAP-EC-907) (CS)
2. Identify the impact of small business/entrepreneurship on market economics (EC:065) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of private enterprise (EC:009, LAP-EC-909) (CS)
4. Identify factors affecting a business's profit (EC:010, LAP-EC-910) (CS)
5. Determine factors affecting business risk (EC:011, LAP-EC-911) (CS)
6. Explain the concept of competition (EC:012, LAP-EC-912) (CS)

Government's Impact on Business (5 test items)

1. Determine the relationship between government and business (EC:008, LAP-EC-016) (CS)
2. Describe the nature of taxes (EC:072, LAP-EC-072) (SP)

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Cost/Profit Relationships (10 test items)

1. Explain the concept of productivity (EC:013, LAP-EC-913) (CS)
2. Analyze impact of specialization/division of labor on productivity (EC:014, LAP-EC-914) (SP)
3. Explain the concept of organized labor and business (EC:015, LAP-EC-915) (SP)
4. Explain the impact of the law of diminishing returns (EC:023, LAP-EC-023) (SP)

Economic Indicators (15 test items)

1. Discuss the measure of consumer spending as an economic indicator (EC:081) (SP)
2. Describe the economic impact of inflation on business (EC:083) (SP)
3. Explain the concept of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) (EC:017, LAP-EC-917) (SP)
4. Discuss the impact of a nation's unemployment rates (EC:082, LAP-EC-082) (SP)
5. Explain the economic impact of interest-rate fluctuations (EC:084) (SP)
6. Determine the impact of business cycles on business activities (EC:018, LAP-EC-918) (SP)

Global Trade (25 test items)

1. Explain the nature of global trade (EC:016, LAP-EC-916) (SP)
2. Discuss the impact of globalization on business (EC:109) (SP)
3. Describe the determinants of exchange rates and their effects on the domestic economy (EC:100, LAP-EC-100) (SP)
4. Explain cultural considerations that impact global business relations (EC:110) (SP)
5. Discuss the impact of cultural and social environments on global trade (EC:045, LAP-EC-045) (SP)
6. Describe the impact of electronic communication tools (e.g., internet, video-and computer-conferencing, webcasts, email) on global business activities (EC:111) (SP)
7. Explain the impact of major trade alliances on business activities (EC:112) (SP)
8. Describe the impact of the political environment on world trade (EC:113) (SP)
9. Explain the impact of geography on world trade (EC:114) (SP)
10. Describe the impact of a country's history on world trade (EC:115) (SP)
11. Explain the impact of a country's economic development on world trade (EC:116) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Council for Economic Education. https://www.councilforeconed.org/

Federal Reserve Education. https://www.federalreserveeducation.org/

Investopedia. *Economics.* https://www.investopedia.com/economics-4689800

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Entrepreneurship

Future Business Leaders of America

Entrepreneurship challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of what it takes to start and manage a successful business. Through an objective test and a role play scenario, members apply entrepreneurial concepts such as business planning, innovation, risk management, and strategic decision-making.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Testing: 50-minute testing period

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

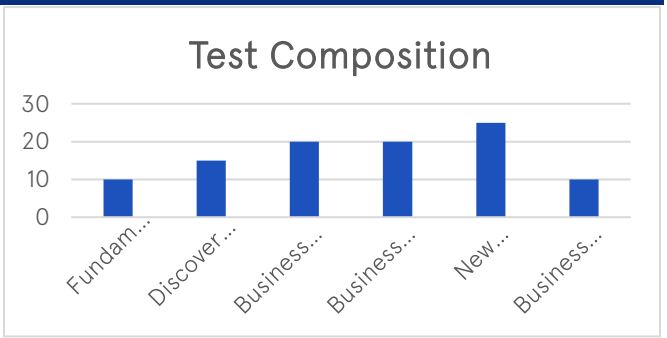
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Fundamentals of Entrepreneurship
- Discovery Strategies
- Business Venture Concepts
- Business Venture Resources
- New Business Venture Activities
- Business Law and Regulations



Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Entrepreneurship

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.

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- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

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Role Play Prompt
- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a entrepreneurship-related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

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Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Entrepreneurship

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fundamentals of Entrepreneurship (10 test items)

1. Describe the nature of entrepreneurship (EN:039) (SP)
2. Explain the role requirements of entrepreneurs and owners (EN:040) (SP)
3. Describe the use of business ethics in entrepreneurship (EN:044, LAP-EN-044) (SP)
4. Describe small-business opportunities in international trade (EN:041) (SP)

Discovery Strategies (15 test items)

1. Explain the need for entrepreneurial discovery (EN:001) (ON)
2. Discuss entrepreneurial discovery processes (EN:002) (ON)
3. Assess global trends and opportunities for business ventures (EN:003) (ON)
4. Determine opportunities for venture creation (EN:004) (ON)
5. Assess opportunities for venture creation (EN:005) (ON)
6. Generate venture ideas (EN:006) (ON)

Business Venture Concepts (20 test items)

1. Describe entrepreneurial planning considerations (EN:007) (ON)
2. Explain tools used by entrepreneurs for venture planning (EN:008) (ON)
3. Assess start-up requirements (EN:009) (ON)
4. Assess risks associated with venture (EN:010) (ON)
5. Describe external resources useful to entrepreneurs during concept development (EN:011) (ON)
6. Assess the need to use external resources for concept development (EN:012) (ON)
7. Select strategies to protect intellectual property (EN:013) (ON)
8. Use components of business plan to define venture idea (EN:014) (ON)

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Business Venture Resources (20 test items)

1. Describe processes used to acquire adequate financial resources for venture creation/start-up (EN:015) (ON)
2. Select sources to finance venture creation/start-up (EN:016) (ON)
3. Explain factors to consider in determining a venture's human-resources needs (EN:017) (ON)
4. Explain considerations in making the decision to hire staff (EN:018) (ON)
5. Describe considerations in selecting capital resources (EN:019) (ON)
6. Identify capital resources needed for the venture (EN:020) (ON)
7. Assess the costs/benefits associated with resources (EN:021) (ON)

New Business Venture Activities (25 test items)

1. Use external resources to supplement entrepreneur's expertise (EN:022) (ON)
2. Explain the complexity of business operations (EN:023) (ON)
3. Evaluate risk-taking opportunities (EN:024) (ON)
4. Explain the need for business systems and procedures (EN:025) (ON)
5. Describe the use of operating procedures (EN:026) (ON)
6. Explain methods/processes for organizing workflow (EN:027) (ON)
7. Develop and/or provide product/service (EN:028) (ON)
8. Use creative problem-solving in business activities/decisions (EN:029) (ON)
9. Explain the impact of resource productivity on venture success (EN:030) (ON)

Business Law and Regulations (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of tax regulations on business (BL:009) (ON)
2. Develop strategies for legal/government compliance (BL:011) (ON)
3. Describe legal issues affecting businesses (BL:001) (SP)

References

Center for American Entrepreneurship. *What is entrepreneurship?* https://startupsusa.org/what-is-entrepreneurship/

Hayes, A. *Entrepreneur: What it means to be one and how to get started*. https://www.investopedia.com/terms/e/entrepreneur.asp

Indeed. *What is a business venture? (Characteristics and examples)*. https://uk.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/what-is-business-venture

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Entrepreneurship

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Entrepreneurship Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Fundamentals of Entrepreneurship/ Discovery Strategies/ Business Venture Concepts/ Business Venture Resources/ New Business Venture Activities / Business Law and Regulations*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Event Planning

Future Business Leaders of America

Event Planning allows members to demonstrate their knowledge of the event planning industry by developing and presenting a plan for a real event. Members showcase their event planning skills in organization, budgeting, promotion, and logistics through a live presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Event Planning

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.

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- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

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Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: The presentation should include information and evidence about the actual event

- **Event Overview:** Purpose, goals, target audience, event type
- **Planning Process:** Timeline, task assignments, planning meetings
- **Budget:** Full income/expense breakdown (include donations, in-kind, revenue)
- **Logistics:** Venue, vendors, staffing, layout diagrams
- **Marketing & Promotion:** Targeted strategies used to promote the event
- **Legal & Risk Management:** Contracts, insurance, permits, safety plans
- **Execution Summary:** Date of event, photos, challenges and how they were handled
- **Evaluation & Reflection:** Attendance and satisfaction metrics, budget outcome (under/over), lessons learned and improvement recommendations, evidence of attendee feedback

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

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Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: The presentation should include information and evidence about the actual event

- **Event Overview:** Purpose, goals, target audience, event type
- **Planning Process:** Timeline, task assignments, planning meetings
- **Budget:** Full income/expense breakdown (include donations, in-kind, revenue)
- **Logistics:** Venue, vendors, staffing, layout diagrams
- **Marketing & Promotion:** Targeted strategies used to promote the event
- **Legal & Risk Management:** Contracts, insurance, permits, safety plans
- **Execution Summary:** Date of event, photos, challenges and how they were handled
- **Evaluation & Reflection:** Attendance and satisfaction metrics, budget outcome (under/over), lessons learned and improvement recommendations, evidence of attendee feedback

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Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
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Important FBLA Documents

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Event Planning

Future Business Leaders of America

Event Planning Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Event Overview: *Purpose, goals, target audience, event type*	*No overview is provided, or the information is irrelevant or missing key components (e.g., no purpose or event type is stated).*	*Overview is vague, unclear, or missing more than one required element (e.g., lacks specific goals or does not identify a clear target audience).*	*Overview clearly identifies the event's purpose, goals, target audience, and type. Information is appropriate and aligns with the overall project.*	*Overview is thorough, well-articulated, and demonstrates strategic alignment between the event's purpose, goals, audience, and type. The rationale is compelling and reflects thoughtful planning.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Planning Process: *Timeline, task assignments, planning meetings*	*No evidence of a planning process is provided; timeline, task assignments, and planning meetings are absent or not addressed.*	*Planning process is incomplete or unclear; may be missing one or more elements such as a timeline or task assignments. Limited evidence of organized planning.*	*A clear planning process is outlined, including a logical timeline, defined task assignments, and documentation of planning meetings. Demonstrates adequate coordination.*	*Planning process is detailed and well-structured, with a comprehensive timeline, clear delegation of responsibilities, and documented planning meetings. Demonstrates strong organization and proactive project management.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Budget: *Full income/expense breakdown (include donations, in-kind, revenue)*	*No budget is provided, or budget lacks both income and expense information.*	*Budget is incomplete, unclear, or missing key elements such as in-kind contributions, donations, or revenue sources. Limited detail or accuracy*	*A complete and accurate budget is presented with clear income and expense breakdowns. Includes donations, in-kind contributions, and revenue, with appropriate formatting and organization.*	*Budget is comprehensive, well-organized, and detailed. Includes thoughtful categorization of all income and expenses, clear documentation of donations and in-kind support, and demonstrates strategic financial planning and responsibility.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Logistics: *Venue, vendors, staffing, layout diagrams*	*No logistical information is provided, or content is irrelevant or missing all key components (venue, vendors, staffing, and layout).*	*Logistics are addressed superficially or are missing multiple elements. Limited clarity around venue, vendor coordination, staffing, or event layout.*	*Logistics are clearly outlined and include relevant details for venue, vendors, staffing, and layout diagrams. Demonstrates adequate preparation and coordination.*	*Logistics are comprehensive, well-documented, and demonstrate advanced planning. Venue, vendors, and staffing plans are clearly defined and supported with professional-quality layout diagrams and thoughtful coordination of all moving parts.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Marketing & Promotion: *Targeted strategies used to promote the event*	*No marketing or promotional strategies are provided, or content is irrelevant or unrelated to the event.*	*Marketing strategies are vague, minimally developed, or not clearly connected to the target audience. Limited use of promotional tools or platforms.*	*Clear and appropriate marketing strategies are outlined and tailored to the event's target audience. Demonstrates use of relevant promotional methods and materials.*	*Marketing and promotion plan is strategic, creative, and well-executed. Demonstrates a strong understanding of the target audience through tailored messaging, varied platforms, and measurable outreach methods. Shows innovation and alignment with event goals.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Legal & Risk Management: *Contracts, insurance, permits, safety plans*	*No legal or risk management information is provided, or none of the required components are addressed.*	*Limited or unclear attention to legal and safety considerations. One or more key elements (contracts, insurance, permits, or safety plans) are missing or incomplete.*	*Legal and risk management components are clearly addressed, including relevant contracts, insurance, permits, and safety measures. Demonstrates an understanding of standard compliance.*	*Legal and risk management plans are thorough, well-documented, and demonstrate a proactive approach to compliance and safety. Includes detailed plans, accurate documentation, and thoughtful preparation for risk scenarios.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Event Planning

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Execution Summary: *Date of event, photos, challenges and how they were handled*	*No execution summary is provided, or the event did not occur. Key elements (date, photos, or reflection on challenges) are missing entirely.*	*Execution summary is incomplete or lacks clarity. May be missing one or more key elements such as photos or explanation of how challenges were addressed.*	*Summary provides a clear overview of the event, including date, photos, and a description of challenges encountered with explanations of how they were managed. Demonstrates successful execution.*	*Summary is thorough and engaging, with a well-documented event date, strong photo evidence, and thoughtful analysis of challenges and solutions. Demonstrates adaptability, leadership, and a reflective understanding of real-time problem solving.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Evaluation & Reflection: *Attendance and satisfaction metrics, budget outcome (under/over), lessons learned and improvement recommendations, evidence of attendee feedback*	*No evaluation or reflection is provided. No data, feedback, or analysis is included.*	*Limited or vague evaluation. May include some metrics or feedback, but lacks depth, completeness, or clear insights. Few or no lessons learned are shared.*	*Evaluation includes clear attendance and satisfaction data, budget outcome, and meaningful reflection. Identifies lessons learned and offers reasonable recommendations for improvement. Some attendee feedback is documented.*	*Evaluation is comprehensive, data-driven, and reflective. Includes well-analyzed attendance and satisfaction metrics, clear budget outcome, actionable improvement strategies, and strong evidence of attendee feedback. Demonstrates a high level of self-assessment and commitment to continuous improvement.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (180 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Financial Planning

Financial Planning challenges members to apply personal finance knowledge by analyzing a family scenario and developing a plan to help them meet their financial goals. Members present their strategies in areas such as budgeting, saving, investing, and debt management through a live presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic Synopsis

Rebuilding Financial Security: The Smith Family's Future

The Smith family is working to rebuild financial security after a period of unemployment, reduced household income, unexpected expenses, and increased credit card debt. With one child preparing to attend college, aging-parent care responsibilities, limited emergency savings, and retirement and insurance concerns, the family must balance several competing financial priorities. They are seeking guidance on improving cash flow, rebuilding savings, reducing debt, preparing for college and future caregiving expenses, increasing retirement contributions, and strengthening their overall financial protection.

Refer to pages 9-11 for the full topic and information.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Financial Planning

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
	Items Competitor Must Provide	**Items FBLA Provides**
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).

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- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.

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- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Budgeting:** Explain the importance of tracking income and expenses. How can effective budgeting contribute to achieving long-term financial goals?
- **Debt Management:** What strategies can be used to responsibly manage and reduce debt? Consider both short-term and long-term approaches.
- **Investments & Retirement:** Should one prioritize investing or saving for retirement, or is it feasible to do both? Justify your reasoning based on the client's financial situation and goals.
- **Goal Attainment:** Based on the financial goals provided, what steps or strategies would you recommend to help achieve them?
- **Recommendations:** What specific financial recommendations or alternative approaches would you suggest to improve the individual's financial outlook?
- **Professional Guidance:** Are there financial professionals or services the individual should consult? Explain the value they may provide.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance

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- More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

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2026-2027 Topic & Details

Background

The Smith family has recently experienced several major life changes that have significantly affected their finances. They have asked your financial planning team to review their financial situation and develop a comprehensive financial plan that will help them achieve both their short-term and long-term goals.

The family wants realistic recommendations that improve their financial security while preparing for future expenses.

Family Profile

Family Member	Age	Occupation/Status	Annual Gross Salary	Key Notes
John Smith	45	Manufacturing Supervisor	$71,842	Recently accepted a new position after his previous employer closed a local facility; new job offers slightly lower pay but better retirement benefits.
Jane Smith	43	Registered Nurse (Part-Time)	$38,617	Reduced work hours to help care for her aging mother.
Emily Smith	17	High school senior	N/A	Planning to attend a four-year university next year.
Matthew Smith	13	Middle school student	N/A	Middle school student.

Financial Goals

1. Build a stronger emergency fund.
2. Pay off high-interest debt.
3. Save for Emily's college expenses.
4. Increase retirement savings.
5. Determine if the family has adequate insurance coverage.
6. Develop a realistic monthly budget.
7. Prepare financially for Jane's mother potentially moving into their home within the next three years.

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Annual Income

Source	Amount
John's Salary	$71,842
Jane's Salary	$38,617
Interest Income	$286
Dividend Income	$547
Total Gross Income	**$111,292**

Estimated Taxes

Tax	Annual Amount
Federal Income Tax	$9,143
State Income Tax	$2,581
Social Security & Medicare	$8,514
Total Taxes	**$20,238**

Estimated Net Annual Income: $91,054
Estimated Monthly Net Income: $7,587.83

Assets

Asset	Value
Checking Account	$2,743
Savings Account	$5,687
Emergency Fund	$3,928
Home Market Value	$318,450
John' 401(k)	$87,362
Jane's IRA	$29,184
529 College Savings Plan	$13,247
Brokerage Investment Account	$15,876
Two Vehicles	$31,425
Household Furnishings	$17,840
Total Assets	**$525,742**

Debts

Debt	Balance	Interest Rate
Mortgage	$226,784	5.6%
Auto Loan	$14,238	4.48%
Credit Card #1	$7,482	22.94%
Credit Card #2	$3,618	19.76%
Student Loan	$17,863	4.92%
Total Debt	**$269,985**	

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Monthly Expenses

Category	Monthly Cost
Mortgage	$1,687.42
Utilities	$338.76
Groceries	$872.53
Transportation	$541.89
Gasoline	$247.38
Auto Insurance	$218.64
Health Insurance Premiums	$433.17
Medical Expenses	$192.45
Cell Phones	$146.82
Internet	$87.99
Streaming Services	$68.43
Dining Out	$364.25
Entertainment	$281.76
Clothing	$169.58
Child Activities	$233.91
Credit Card Payments	$462.37
Student Loan Payment	$228.14
Auto Loan Payment	$389.63
Miscellaneous	$267.84
Total Monthly Expenses	**$7,232.96**

Current Monthly Surplus
Monthly Net Income: $7,587.83
Monthly Expenses: $7,232.96
Current Monthly Surplus: $354.87

Current Investments:

Retirement:

1. John contributes 6.2% to his employer's 401(k).
    a. Employer matches 50% of the first 6%.
2. Jane contributes 3.4% to her IRA annually.

Education Savings

1. 529 Plan currently contains $13,247.
2. Family contributes $100 per month.

Investment mix:

1. 68% Stock Index Funds
2. 22% Bond Funds
3. 10% Cash

Insurance Coverage

1. Health Insurance
2. Employer-sponsored family plan
3. $3,500 deductible
4. 20% coinsurance after deductible

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Homeowners Insurance
1. Dwelling Coverage: $275,000
2. Personal Property: $150,000
3. Liability: $300,000

Auto Insurance
1. Liability: 100/300/100
2. Collision and Comprehensive
3. $1,000 deductible

Life Insurance
1. John: Employer Group Policy: $150,000
2. Jane: Employer Group Policy: $50,000
3. No additional individual life insurance policies.

Disability Insurance
John: Employer short-term disability only
Jane: None

Umbrella Liability Policy
None

Retirement Planning
Desired Retirement Ages
1. John: 65
2. Jane: 65

Estimated Retirement Income Goal: Approximately 80% of current household income

Current Retirement Savings Rate: Approximately 8% of household income

Financial planners generally recommend saving 15% or more of annual income for retirement, depending on age and financial goals.

Additional Information

During the past year:
1. John experienced a three-month period of unemployment.
2. The family used most of their emergency savings to cover living expenses.
3. Credit card balances increased due to unexpected home and medical repairs.
4. Jane reduced her work schedule to provide care for her mother.
5. Interest rates on one credit card increased after a promotional rate expired.

The family is financially stable today but is concerned about unexpected expenses and wants to improve their long-term financial outlook.

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Deliverables:

Your financial planning team has been hired to prepare recommendations for the Smith family.

Develop a financial plan that addresses the following:

- Analyze the family's current financial health using the information provided.
- Prepare a revised monthly budget that improves cash flow.
- Recommend strategies for rebuilding an emergency fund.
- Develop a debt repayment plan, including prioritization of high-interest debt.
- Evaluate current investments and recommend any changes.
- Recommend strategies for increasing retirement savings while balancing other financial goals.
- Evaluate the family's insurance coverage and identify any gaps or risks.
- Recommend strategies to help pay for Emily's college education.
- Identify tax planning opportunities that could improve the family's financial position.
- Prioritize the family's financial goals and justify the order of implementation.
- Identify potential financial risks over the next five years and recommend strategies to reduce those risks.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Financial Planning

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Financial Planning Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the topic and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No topic description or synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides topic synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides topic synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of topic synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Budgeting: *Explain the importance of tracking income and expenses. How can effective budgeting contribute to achieving long-term financial goals?*	*No explanation is provided, or the response is unrelated to budgeting, income/expense tracking, or long-term financial goals.*	*Explanation is vague, incomplete, or demonstrates limited understanding. Mentions tracking or long-term goals but does not clearly connect them or explain their importance.*	*Provides a clear explanation of why tracking income and expenses is important and how budgeting supports long-term financial goals. Shows a foundational understanding of personal finance.*	*Provides a detailed and insightful explanation of the relationship between tracking income/expenses and achieving financial goals. Demonstrates strong financial literacy and includes real-world applications or examples to support key points.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Debt Management: *What strategies can be used to responsibly manage and reduce debt? Consider both short-term and long-term approaches.*	*No strategies are provided, or the response is unrelated to debt management.*	*Provides a limited or overly general explanation. May mention basic strategies but lacks clarity, detail, or distinction between short-term and long-term approaches.*	*Clearly identifies responsible strategies for managing and reducing debt. Includes both short-term and long-term approaches with appropriate explanations*	*Provides a thorough and well-structured explanation of multiple debt management strategies, clearly distinguishing between short-term and long-term methods. Demonstrates strong financial understanding and includes real-world examples or rationale for selecting specific strategies.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Investments & Retirement: *Should one prioritize investing or saving for retirement, or is it feasible to do both? Justify your reasoning based on the client's financial situation and goals.*	*No position or reasoning is provided, or response does not address investments, retirement, or the client's financial situation.*	*Provides a vague or unsupported opinion. Minimal consideration of the client's financial situation or goals. Limited understanding of the balance between investing and saving for retirement.*	*Presents a clear and logical recommendation to prioritize investing, saving for retirement, or both. Provides reasonable justification based on the client's financial situation and goals.*	*Offers a well-reasoned and personalized recommendation grounded in financial principles. Thoroughly analyzes the client's situation and long-term goals and clearly explains how the proposed balance of investing and retirement saving supports their financial success.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Goal Attainment: *Based on the financial goals provided, what steps or strategies would you recommend to help achieve them?*	*No strategies or steps are provided, or response does not address the client's financial goals.*	*Provides general or vague recommendations that lack alignment with the specific financial goals. Minimal explanation or rationale is given.*	*Recommend appropriate and realistic steps or strategies that align with the client's financial goals. Explanation demonstrates a solid understanding of goal-based financial planning.*	*Provides well-structured, actionable, and personalized strategies tailored to the client's financial goals. Demonstrates clear understanding of the planning process with strong rationale and possible contingencies. May include timelines, prioritization, or measurement methods.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Recommendations: *What specific financial recommendations or alternative approaches would you suggest to improve the individual's financial outlook?*	*No financial recommendations are provided, or the response is irrelevant or off-topic*	*Provides vague, overly general, or unrealistic recommendations. Suggestions may not be clearly tied to the individual's financial situation or may lack actionable detail.*	*Offers relevant and specific financial recommendations or alternative approaches that align with the individual's financial circumstances. Suggestions are practical and clearly explained.*	*Provides insightful, well-supported, and tailored financial recommendations. Demonstrates strong financial reasoning, with alternative approaches and justification for each recommendation that clearly supports an improved financial outlook.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Financial Planning

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Professional Guidance: *Are there financial professionals or services the individual should consult? Explain the value they may provide.*	*No financial professionals or services are identified, or response is unrelated to professional guidance.*	*Mentions a financial professional or service but provides limited explanation of their role or value. Lacks clarity or relevance to the individual's financial needs.*	*Identifies appropriate financial professionals or services (e.g., financial advisor, tax preparer, credit counselor) and explains how they can support the individual's financial goals.*	*Provides a well-reasoned explanation of multiple relevant financial professionals or services. Clearly articulates the unique value each can provide based on the individual's financial situation and goals. Demonstrates strong understanding of when and why to seek expert guidance*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (150 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Financial Statement Analysis

Financial Statement Analysis allows members to apply their knowledge of accounting principles to interpret and evaluate financial information. Based on a given topic, members analyze financial statements and present their findings and recommendations to a panel of judges.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Analyzing Costco's Financial Performance: Insights for Long-Term Success

Costco Wholesale Corporation, one of the world's leading membership-based warehouse retailers, continues to operate in a rapidly evolving business environment shaped by changing consumer behavior, economic conditions, competition, and growth opportunities.
Using Costco's fiscal year 2025 Annual Report and other publicly available financial information, analyze the company's financial performance and condition. Develop recommendations that support Costco's long-term financial success and strategic objectives.

How can financial analysis help organizations evaluate performance, identify opportunities, manage risk, and make informed business decisions?

Refer to event specifics information below for more information.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Financial Statement Analysis

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

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- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Perform an analysis of **Costco Wholesale Corporation's Fiscal Year 2025 Annual Report** and other publicly available financial information. (found at SEC's EDGAR website)
- Analyze key information from Costco's:
  - Consolidated Balance Sheets
  - Consolidated Statements of Income
  - Consolidated Statements of Cash Flows
  - Consolidated Statements of Shareholders' Equity
- Evaluate Costco's financial performance and condition using relevant financial metrics, ratio analysis, trends, and industry benchmarks. Consider factors such as:
  - Profitability
  - Liquidity
  - Efficiency
  - Solvency
  - Growth
- Discuss significant changes between fiscal year 2025 and prior periods, including financial results, assets, liabilities, cash flows, and business operations.
- Explain what the financial results indicate about Costco's overall financial health, opportunities, and risks.
- Recommend 2-3 strategic actions that support Costco's long-term financial success. Recommendations may address:
  - Growth opportunities
  - Operational efficiency
  - Financial risk management
  - Capital allocation and investment decisions
- Demonstrate how financial statement analysis can help organizations evaluate performance, identify opportunities, manage risks, and make informed business decisions.

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Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

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- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

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- Analyze key information from Costco's:
  - Consolidated Balance Sheets
  - Consolidated Statements of Income
  - Consolidated Statements of Cash Flows
  - Consolidated Statements of Shareholders' Equity
- Evaluate Costco's financial performance and condition using relevant financial metrics, ratio analysis, trends, and industry benchmarks. Consider factors such as:
  - Profitability
  - Liquidity
  - Efficiency
  - Solvency
  - Growth
- Discuss significant changes between fiscal year 2025 and prior periods, including financial results, assets, liabilities, cash flows, and business operations.
- Explain what the financial results indicate about Costco's overall financial health, opportunities, and risks.
- Recommend 2-3 strategic actions that support Costco's long-term financial success. Recommendations may address:
  - Growth opportunities
  - Operational efficiency
  - Financial risk management
  - Capital allocation and investment decisions
- Demonstrate how financial statement analysis can help organizations evaluate performance, identify opportunities, manage risks, and make informed business decisions.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

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Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Financial Statement Analysis

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Financial Statement Analysis Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Describes each financial statement and its purpose	*Does not describe any of the financial statements, or the information is incorrect or unrelated.*	*Mentions one or more financial statements but provides unclear or incomplete descriptions. May confuse the purpose of each statement.*	*Accurately describes all three financial statements and clearly explains what each one is used for. Shows understanding of how they help a business track its finances.*	*Provides clear, accurate, and well-explained descriptions of all three financial statements. Demonstrates strong understanding of how each statement works together to show a full picture of the company's financial health.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Performs financial analysis of each financial statement	*No analysis of the financial statements is provided, or information is incorrect or off-topic.*	*Some attempt is made to analyze the financial statements, but the explanation is limited, unclear, or misses key information. May only focus on one statement.*	*Clearly analyzes each financial statement, identifying important details from the Income Statement, Balance Sheet, and Cash Flow Statement. Shows understanding of how each part contributes to the overall financial picture.*	*Provides a strong, detailed analysis of all three financial statements. Highlights key figures and trends, explains what they mean, and connects them to the company's financial health. Demonstrates a high level of financial understanding.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describes financial condition of the company using insights gained from financial analysis	*Does not describe the company's financial condition, or the description is incorrect or not based on any analysis.*	*Gives a basic or unclear description of the company's financial condition. Provides little connection to the financial data or analysis.*	*Clearly describes the company's financial condition using key insights from the financial analysis. Shows understanding of how the company is performing overall.*	*Gives a well-supported description of the company's financial condition, using specific insights from the analysis. Demonstrates a strong understanding of what the numbers mean and how they reflect the company's strengths and challenges.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Offers guidance for business decision making	*No suggestions are made, or ideas are not connected to the financial analysis.*	*Gives general or unclear suggestions that don't clearly relate to the company's financial situation.*	*Provides clear and realistic suggestions for business decisions based on the financial analysis. Shows an understanding of how financial information can help guide a company's choices.*	*Offers strong, well-thought-out suggestions that are closely tied to the financial data. Shows deep understanding of how the company can use the analysis to improve or grow. May include multiple options or explain possible outcomes.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Highlight key differences between this year's financial statements and prior periods: revenues, costs, margins, assets, liabilities, etc.	*No differences between time periods are mentioned, or the response is unrelated to the financial statements.*	*Mentions a few changes but with little detail or explanation. May list numbers without showing what they mean or why they matter.*	*Clearly points out important differences between this year and past years. Explains how key areas like sales, costs, and profits have changed and why those changes are important.*	*Gives a detailed and thoughtful comparison of several key financial areas. Clearly explains the meaning of the changes and what they show about the business's performance over time.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Analyze what changes reveal about the company's current financial health.	*No analysis is given, or the answer does not relate to financial health or important financial areas. No use of ratios, trends, or comparisons.*	*Shows a basic or unclear explanation of financial health. Mentions some financial areas but gives little detail or support using ratios, trends, or comparisons.*	*Gives a clear explanation of the company's financial health in key areas like profitability and liquidity. Uses some ratios, trends, or comparisons to support the analysis.*	*Gives a detailed and thoughtful explanation of the company's financial health using multiple financial areas and specific data. Clearly supports the analysis with well-chosen ratios, trends over time, and comparisons to industry or past performance.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Financial Statement Analysis

Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Recommend 2-3 strategic business decisions backed by analysis	*No suggestions are provided, or the ideas don't relate to the financial data.*	*Suggestions are unclear, unrealistic, or not clearly connected to the financial information.*	*Gives 2-3 clear and realistic suggestions that relate to the financial analysis. Shows understanding of how the company could grow, save money, or reduce risk..*	*Gives 2-3 thoughtful, creative, and well-explained suggestions. Each idea is strongly supported by financial data and shows a clear understanding of how the company can improve or succeed in the future.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (140 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Educator

Future Business Educator gives competitors the opportunity to explore a career in business education by demonstrating their knowledge, instructional planning, and presentation skills. This event includes a pre-judged asset and a live presentation focused on teaching concepts relevant to the field.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Presentation with Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Prejudge Asset submission due by state set date**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Where Leaders Begin: Developing Essential Leadership Skills

Business professionals rely on leadership skills to communicate effectively, solve problems, work collaboratively, and achieve organizational goals. Strong leadership contributes to success in the workplace, the classroom, and the community.

Develop and deliver an engaging lesson on a leadership topic of your choice for a business education classroom. Topics may include, but are not limited to, communication, teamwork, decision-making, conflict resolution, leadership styles, goal setting, ethical leadership, emotional intelligence, or other leadership concepts relevant to business education.

Your lesson should help students understand and apply leadership concepts in business, school, and everyday life.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Future Business Educator

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements
To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Lesson Plan

Submission Deadline

- A PDF must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- The lesson plan must be no more than three pages in length and formatted to fit standard 8.5" x 11" paper.
- Competitors must use the lesson plan template provided on the final page of these guidelines. While the format may be retyped or adjusted, all original components must be included. The lesson plan should be designed to cover a full class period.
- Links and QR codes are not permitted within the lesson plan.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the asset. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- Assets must be new, original work and may not have been submitted at any previous National Leadership Conference.
- *Note:* The lesson plan does not need to follow the FBLA Production Test Reference Guide, formerly known as the FBLA Format Guide.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Preliminary Presentation Details: The Lesson

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

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- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, interactive whiteboard, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged assets, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Judges will play the role as middle school or secondary students. Competitors will select one part of their lesson plan to teach to the judges during the presentation.
- **Demonstrate Subject Mastery:** Show deep understanding of the business education topic through accurate, thorough content and clear communication.
- **Align Materials to Objectives:** Ensure all instructional materials support the stated lesson goals and consider diverse learning needs and styles.
- **Design Engaging Learning Activities:** Incorporate creative, hands-on activities that motivate students and allow them to actively demonstrate their understanding.
- **Organize a Professional Lesson Plan:** Present a well-structured, creative, and visually polished lesson plan that is both interesting and appropriate for a classroom setting.

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Final Presentation Details: The Lesson

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, interactive whiteboard, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged assets, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

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Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Judges will play the role as middle school or secondary students. Competitors will select one part of their lesson plan to teach to the judges during the presentation.
- **Demonstrate Subject Mastery:** Show deep understanding of the business education topic through accurate, thorough content and clear communication.
- **Align Materials to Objectives:** Ensure all instructional materials support the stated lesson goals and consider diverse learning needs and styles.
- **Design Engaging Learning Activities:** Incorporate creative, hands-on activities that motivate students and allow them to actively demonstrate their understanding.
- **Organize a Professional Lesson Plan:** Present a well-structured, creative, and visually polished lesson plan that is both interesting and appropriate for a classroom setting.

Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score will be added to the preliminary presentation round scores to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

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Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Educator

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Future Business Educator Pre-Judged Asset (Lesson Plan) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Documents are free of spelling, punctuation, and grammatical errors	*Three or more errors*	*Two errors*	*No spelling errors, and not more than 1 punctuation or grammatical error*	*No spelling or grammatical errors, and not more than 1 punctuation error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Business & Academic Standards	*No standards identified*	*Standards are identified, but not business or academic related*	*Standards are identified, either business OR academic*	*Business standards are identified and connected to academic standards*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Objectives (Competencies & Presentation Indicator)	*No objectives listed*	*Objectives are identified, may not be specific & measurable*	*Objectives are identified and are specific and measurable*	*Objectives are identified and relate to meaningful skills or concepts essential to student learning*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Outcome & Measurement	*No outcome or measurement listed*	*Outcome or measurement listed*	*Outcome and measurement are listed*	*The measurement of the outcome reflects objectives*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Resources & Materials	*Resources & materials are not listed or not appropriate*	*Resources & materials are listed, not effectively implemented*	*Range of resources and materials are listed with specific citation information*	*Resources and materials are selected and/or designed to meet diverse learning needs*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Instructional Activities	*Plan of activities is so vague or generalized that it is unusable*	*Plan of activities lack elements or details for effective delivery*	*Plan of activities is clear and designed to promote critical thinking, problem solving or creativity*	*Plan of activities utilizes multiple strategies and includes guiding questions appropriate for engaging students in higher-level thinking*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Guideline Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Lesson Plan aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Lesson Plan was submitted as PDF* ✓ *Links or QR codes were not used (except for citation purposes)* ✓ *No more than 3 pages long*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Pre-judged Asset Total (60 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Educator

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Future Business Educator Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrated knowledge of subject matter	*No knowledge of the subject matter demonstrated*	*Demonstrated limited understanding of the subject matter*	*Demonstrated understanding of the subject matter*	*Demonstrated extensive understanding of the subject matter*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presented material met the objectives of the lesson plan	*Presented material was not included, objectives not stated*	*Presented material was included, but not connected to the stated lesson plan objectives*	*Presented material was included and connected to the stated lesson plan objectives*	*Materials meet the stated objectives and accommodate learner differences*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presented material appropriate for audience and subject	*Activities/materials are not included or not appropriate for the grade level or topic*	*Activities/materials are included but do not give students clear opportunities for guided practice*	*Activities/materials are included and give students opportunities for practice*	*Activities/materials engage and motivate students with opportunities to demonstrate skills*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presented interesting, motivating and creative lesson plan	*Lesson plan is unorganized*	*Lesson plan is organized*	*Lesson plan is organized; and interesting, motivating, OR creative*	*Lesson plan is organized, interesting, motivating, creative, and presented professionally*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates proper verbal and nonverbal communication skills	*Verbal AND nonverbal communication skills are inappropriate*	*Verbal and/or nonverbal communication skills are weak or distracting*	*All questions were clearly answered using good grammar and appropriate body language*	*Verbal communication skills are excellent; nonverbal communication is natural*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Educator

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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LESSON PLAN TEMPLATE

This template may be retyped/recreated

Competitor Name:
Competitor School: Competitor State:

Lesson Plan Title		
Content Area		
Grade Level		
Business and/or Academic Standard		
Objectives *(What should students be able to do after your lesson?)*		
Outcome / Measurement *(How to assess that students met your learning objectives?)*		
Resources and Materials		
Anticipatory Set / Gaining Learners' Attention		Time Spent
Informing Learners of Objective		Time Spent
Teacher Input / Modeling / Check for Understanding		Time Spent
Guided Practice		Time Spent
Independent Practice		Time Spent
Closure		Time Spent
Notes		

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Leader

Future Business Leaders of America

Future Business Leader is FBLA's premier event recognizing members who exemplify leadership, business knowledge, and active involvement in the organization. Competitors are evaluated through pre-judged assets, an objective test, and a presentation (interview), showcasing their readiness for success in business and leadership roles.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset, Objective Test, and Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Test Duration**: 50 minutes
- **Interview: 10** minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Prejudge Asset submission due by state set date**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

There is no test composition available for this objective test. Visit www.fbla.org for access to information about FBLA.

- FBLA Organization
- FBLA Bylaws & Handbook
- FBLA National Competitive Event Guidelines
- FBLA National Publications
- FBLA Mission, Pledge and Goals
- General Business and Technology Knowledge (including, but not limited to, accounting, banking, law, entrepreneurship, marketing, international business, management, organizational leadership, information technology, cybersecurity)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Leader

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Preliminary & Final Round	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Chair for Competitor

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of four phases: a pre-judged asset, an objective test, preliminary presentation (interview), and a final presentation (interview).

Pre-judged Asset Details: Cover Letter & Resume

Submission Deadline

- A PDF of the cover letter and resume must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- Cover Letter Specifics
  - Must be no longer than one page.
  - Should clearly state why the competitor is deserving of this award.
  - Address the letter to: Jennifer Woods, President and CEO, Future Business Leaders of America, 12100 Sunset Hills Drive, Suite 200, Reston, VA 20190
- Resume Specifics
  - Must not exceed two pages in length.
  - Should include the competitor's education, extracurricular activities, awards and honors, FBLA involvement, and work or volunteer experience.
  - Photographs are not permitted on the résumé.
- Assets must be formatted to fit standard 8.5" x 11" paper.
- Links and QR codes are not permitted.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the asset. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- *Note:* The assets do not need to follow the FBLA Production Test Reference Guide, formerly known as the FBLA Format Guide.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test. Note: There is no objective test composition/question breakdown available for this competition.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

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Materials
- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices
- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Calculators
- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review
- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Preliminary Presentation Details: Interview

Timing Structure
- **Equipment Set-Up:** 0 minutes
- **Presentation:** 10 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 0 minutes

Venue & Format
- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines
- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- No technology may be brought to the interview.

Non-Technology Items
- No materials may be brought to the interview.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Final Presentation Details: Interview

Timing Structure
- **Equipment Set-Up:** 0 minutes
- **Presentation:** 10 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 0 minutes

Advancement to Finals
- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

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Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The final round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- No technology may be brought to the interview.

Non-Technology Items

- No materials may be brought to the interview.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation

Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score, objective test and preliminary presentation (interview) round scores will be added together to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Leader

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Future Business Leader Pre-Judged Assets Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Cover Letter: States award applying for	*No award stated*	*Award stated does not match qualification*	*States award and shows match of award to qualifications*	*States award and shows match of award to qualifications with demonstrated experience*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Cover Letter: Promotes self in letter – lists skills, achievements, volunteerism, experience, etc.	*No self-promotion included*	*Describes skills and academic achievements, but no volunteerism or experience included*	*Describes skills, academic achievements, and volunteerism or experience*	*Describes skills, academic achievements, and multiple volunteerism or experiences*	
	0 points	1-3 points	4-6 points	7-8 points	
Cover Letter: States that the resume is included with the letter and asks for interview	*No resume statement nor interview requested*	*States resume included but does not ask for interview*	*States resume is included and asks for interview*	*States resume is included, asks for interview, provides opportunity to request more information*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Resume: Targets award on cover letter	*No award targeted*	*Targeted award does not match cover letter*	*Targeted award matches cover letter*	*Resume supports targeted award on cover letter*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Resume: Reader friendly – categories can be found easily, white space utilized, professional fonts and font sizes	*Resume is unreadable*	*Resume design is distracting*	*Resume is reader friendly*	*Resume is professional in design for targeted award*	
	0 points	1-3 points	4-6 points	7-8 points	
Resume: Includes education, activities, awards/honors, FBLA experience and volunteerism/work experience information	*No education, activities, volunteerism, experience information listed*	*One-two sections included*	*Three-four sections included*	*Five or more sections support targeted award*	
	0 points	1-3 points	4-6 points	7-8 points	
Resume: Brief, concise information	*Resume not included*	*Information provided, but in paragraph form*	*Sections are clearly identified with organized information*	*Clearly identified and organized information in each section supports targeted award*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Spelling & Grammar: Documents are free of spelling, punctuation, and grammatical errors	*Three or more errors*	*Two errors*	*No spelling errors, and not more than 1 punctuation or grammatical error*	*No spelling or grammatical errors, and not more than 1 punctuation error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
All directions followed	*Cover letter longer than one page, not addressed correctly; Resume longer than two pages, photograph or QR code included*		*Cover letter no more than one page, addressed correctly; Resume no more than two pages, no photograph or QR code included; documents submitted as PDF*		
	0 points		5 points		
				Pre-judged Assets Total (50 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Future Business Leader

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Future Business Leader Presentation Interview Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Illustrates participation and leadership experiences in FBLA	*Has not been involved in FBLA other than to pay membership dues and attend one state/national conference*	*Has limited participation in FBLA activities OR has had limited FBLA leadership opportunities*	*Can communicate participation in FBLA throughout high school and discuss leadership experiences in FBLA*	*Can explain how participation and leadership experiences in FBLA have transferred to other areas of life*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Explains participation in other school and/or community organizations	*No evidence of participation in other school and/or community organizations*	*Participates in only one additional school and/or community organization other than FBLA*	*Explains participation in other school and/or community organizations*	*Explains how participation in FBLA has complemented or enhanced other school and/or community organizations*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Explains and shows areas of outstanding achievement	*No other achievements outside of FBLA*	*Has limited areas of outstanding achievement other than FBLA*	*Can explain and show areas of outstanding achievement*	*Can explain how participation in FBLA has complemented or enhanced other areas of outstanding achievement*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Indicates understanding of career knowledge and career plans	*No career plans at this time*	*May have an idea for a career but has developed no solid plans OR obtained any career knowledge*	*Knows career plans and shows some evidence that the career knowledge has been obtained*	*Can discuss how career plans were decided and how the plans will be achieved. Can also discuss how the career knowledge was acquired and how it will be used*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Demonstrates proper greeting, introduction, and closing	*Does not use proper greeting, introduction OR closing*	*Greeting, introduction, OR closing was weak*	*Strong greeting, introduction AND closing*	*Creative in their introduction of themselves and asks for or provides follow-up action in the conclusion*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Demonstrates strong self-confidence, appropriate assertiveness, and enthusiasm	*Did not demonstrate self-confidence, assertiveness, OR enthusiasm*	*Demonstrated minimal self-confidence, assertiveness, AND enthusiasm*	*Used strong eye contact, appropriate assertiveness, AND enthusiasm*	*Led the interview process and effectively used interview time*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Demonstrates proper verbal and nonverbal communication skills	*Verbal AND nonverbal communication skills are inappropriate*	*Verbal and/or nonverbal communication skills are weak or distracting*	*All questions were clearly answered using good grammar and appropriate body language*	*Verbal communication skills are excellent; nonverbal communication is natural*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *No technology used* ✓ *Did not bring materials to the interview* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Graphic Design

Graphic Design allows members to showcase their creativity and technical skills by developing original visual content. Members present their designs and explain the development process to a panel of judges, demonstrating their understanding of design principles, software tools, and effective visual communication.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Grand Reopening: Rebranding a Renovated Hotel

A hotel in your area has recently completed a major renovation and is preparing to relaunch with a fresh identity that reflects its updated facilities, guest experience, and brand vision. Develop a cohesive visual identity that communicates the hotel's personality and appeals to its target audience.

Create a branding package that establishes a recognizable identity and supports the hotel's grand reopening. The package should include logo development, visual identity standards, promotional materials, and branded assets that demonstrate how the brand can be applied across multiple touchpoints and customer experiences.

Your final designs should demonstrate strong branding principles, visual communication, and consistency while creating an identity that supports the hotel's relaunch and attracts future guests.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Graphic Design

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

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- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Clear and Detailed Design Process:** The design process is clearly described from start to finish, showing how key design principles (such as balance, contrast, alignment, and spacing) were used to guide creative decisions.
- **Visually Compelling and Purposeful Design:** The final design is visually strong, appropriate for the intended audience, and clearly supports the goals of the project. Design choices are intentional, engaging, and encourage interest or action.
- **Thoughtful Use of Tools and Technology:** Design tools and software are clearly identified, with an explanation of how each contributed to the quality and effectiveness of the final product.
- **Interpretation of Theme and Visual Alignment:** The design demonstrates a clear understanding of the event topic or theme. Visual elements are aligned with the overall message, brand, or purpose and are used intentionally to strengthen the design's impact.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

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Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

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- **Thoughtful Use of Tools and Technology:** Design tools and software are clearly identified, with an explanation of how each contributed to the quality and effectiveness of the final product.

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- **Interpretation of Theme and Visual Alignment:** The design demonstrates a clear understanding of the event topic or theme. Visual elements are aligned with the overall message, brand, or purpose and are used intentionally to strengthen the design's impact.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Graphic Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Graphic Design Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Description of the event topic and materials	*Event topic not followed; or materials not described*	*Event topic and at least one of the materials described*	*Event topic and all materials described*	*All materials and event topic described, and the competitors connect the different pieces together*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Explains the design and development process	*No explanation of the design process is provided, or the explanation is unrelated or unclear. Design principles are not mentioned.*	*Gives a basic or vague explanation of the design process. May mention one or two steps or design choices, but without connecting them to design principles.*	*Clearly explains the steps taken to develop the design. Includes specific references to design principles and how they were used to improve the final product.*	*Provides a thoughtful, detailed explanation of the full design and development process. Clearly connects decisions to multiple design principles and shows a strong understanding of how those principles were applied to create an effective and visually strong design.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Create interest and desire for the design	*Design does not attract attention or connect with the audience. No effort is made to create interest or appeal.*	*Design shows some effort to create interest, but it may be too plain, confusing, or not well-matched to the audience or brand.*	*Design is visually appealing and appropriate for the audience. It clearly creates interest in the product, service, or brand.*	*Design is eye-catching, memorable, and highly engaging. It strongly connects with the target audience and creates a clear desire to take action or learn more. Shows creativity and strong brand appeal*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Programs/Tools used to design graphics	*Programs used to create the graphics were not addressed*	*Names one or more tools, but does not explain how or why they were used. Explanation may be unclear or not connected to the project.*	*Clearly identifies the tools or programs used and explains their role in creating the design. Shows understanding of how the tools supported the design process.*	*Provides a clear, thoughtful explanation of the tools or programs used and why they were selected. Demonstrates strong understanding of how the tools enhanced the quality and effectiveness of the design.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Consistency in graphic design to theme	*Consistency in graphic design to theme not addressed*	*Explains how graphic design is consistent with theme*	*Demonstrates with visual aids the consistency between graphic design and theme*	*Emphasize interpretation of the topic and design as it relates to graphic design and theme including use of visual aids*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Graphic Design

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (120 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Healthcare Administration

Future Business Leaders of America

Healthcare Administration challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of medical terminology, office procedures, and administrative functions within a healthcare setting. Through an objective test, members explore the skills and knowledge essential to supporting efficient and effective healthcare operations.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

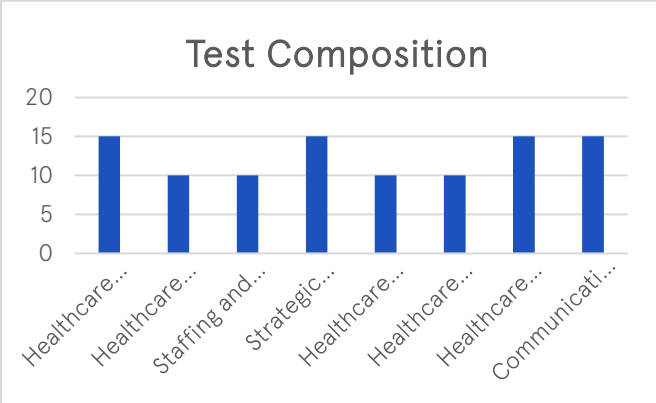
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Healthcare Organizations and Structure
- Healthcare Finances and Budgeting
- Staffing and Training
- Strategic Management
- Healthcare Technology
- Healthcare Billing and Insurance
- Healthcare Policy and Regulation
- Communication and Leadership



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Healthcare Administration

Future Business Leaders of America

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

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- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Healthcare Organizations and Structure (15 test items)

1. Discuss different healthcare facilities (e.g., hospitals, physicians' offices, urgent care centers)
2. Discuss types of healthcare services (e.g., outpatient, inpatient, long-term care)
3. Describe different roles and titles in healthcare
4. Describe organizational structures of healthcare organizations (e.g., functional, matrix, multidivisional)
5. Compare public and private healthcare
6. Describe organizational leaders in healthcare administration (e.g., medical officer, nursing officer, financial officer)

Healthcare Finances and Budgeting (10 test items)

1. Describe the nature of budgets (FI:106, LAP-FI-106) (SP)
2. Explain the nature of operating budgets (FI:098) (SU)
3. Describe the nature of cost-benefit analysis (FI:357, LAP-FI-357) (MN)
4. Determine relationships among total revenue, marginal revenue, output, and profit (FI:358) (MN)

Staffing and Training (10 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
2. Determine hiring needs (HR:353) (SU)
3. Orient new employees (management's role) (HR:361) (SU)
4. Explain the role of training and human resources development (HR:362) (SU)

Strategic Management (15 test items)

1. Explain the concept of management (SM:001, LAP-SM-001) (CS)
2. Explain factors that affect management (SM:100) (SP)
3. Describe strategic analysis tools (e.g., PEST, SWOT, TOWS)

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4. Discuss the nature of managerial planning (SM:063) (SP)
5. Explain managerial considerations in organizing (SM:064, LAP-SM-064) (SP)
6. Describe managerial considerations in staffing (SM:065, LAP-SM-065) (SP)
7. Discuss managerial considerations in directing (SM:066, LAP-SM-066) (SP)
8. Describe the nature of managerial control (control process, types of control, what is controlled) (SM:004, LAP-SM-004) (SP)

Healthcare Technology (10 test items)

1. Describe digital medical records
2. Discuss the use of telemedicine and telehealth
3. Discuss the use of AI in healthcare
4. Discuss the importance of data analytics in healthcare
5. Describe information systems used in healthcare (e.g., CIS, PACS)

Healthcare Billing and Insurance (10 test items)

1. Describe the process of healthcare billing
2. Discuss the relationship between health insurance and medical billing
3. Describe healthcare service models (e.g., value-based, fee-for-service, managed care)
4. Evaluate managed care structures (e.g., HMO, PPO, POS)

Healthcare Policy and Regulation (15 test items)

1. Discuss HIPAA rules (e.g., Privacy, Security, Breach Notification)
2. Describe laws related to medical billing and fraud (e.g., Anti-Kickback Statute, Stark Law)
3. Describe OSHA regulations related to healthcare facilities
4. Discuss Medicare and Medicaid
5. Describe federal agencies that affect healthcare policy (e.g., CMS, HHS, CDC)
6. Describe the importance of compliance in healthcare administration

Communication and Leadership (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature of staff communication (CO:014) (CS)
2. Choose and use appropriate channel for workplace communication (CO:092) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of leadership (EI:009, LAP-EI-909) (CS)
4. Explain the nature of ethical leadership (EI:131, LAP-EI-131) (CS)
5. Model ethical behavior (EI:132, LAP-EI-132) (CS)
6. Explain the nature of leadership in organizations (HR:493, LAP-HR-493) (SU)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Hospitality & Event Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Hospitality & Event Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of the hospitality industry and event planning through an objective test and a role play scenario. Members apply their knowledge in areas such as customer service, operations, logistics, and marketing to solve real-world business situations.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Testing: 50-minute testing period

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

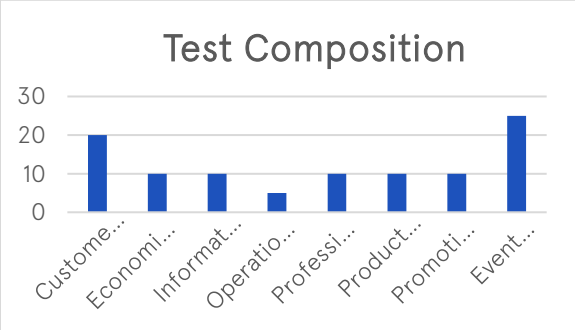
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Customer Relations
- Economics and Finances
- Information Management
- Operations
- Professional Development
- Product/Service Management
- Promotion and Selling
- Event Management



Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

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District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a hospitality and event management–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)
- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

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MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Customer Relations (20 test items)

1. Explain the importance of meeting and exceeding customer/guest expectations (CR:067) (CS)
2. Anticipate unspoken customer needs (CR:053) (CS)
3. Accommodate special needs/specific requests of customers (CR:054) (CS)
4. Process customer/guest orders (CR:021) (CS)
5. Maintain service standards during peaks in demand (CR:039) (CS)
6. Resolve hospitality and tourism related conflicts for customers (CR:044) (CS)
7. Explain the nature of guest recovery (CR:045) (CS)
8. Explain the nature of customer service in the hospitality and tourism industry (CR:049) (CS)

Economics and Finances (10 test items)

1. Explain the relationship between the economy and hospitality and tourism (EC:136) (SP)
2. Discuss considerations in accepting credit-card payments (FI:789) (SP)
3. Explain cash control procedures (e.g., signature cards, deposit slips, internal/external controls, cash clearing, etc.) (FI:113) (CS)

Information Management (10 test items)

1. Describe the impact of mobile technology on the hospitality and tourism industry (NF:313) (SP)
2. Explain the need for hospitality and tourism business information (NF:279) (CS)
3. Describe current issues and trends in the hospitality and tourism industry (NF:048) (SP)
4. Obtain hospitality and tourism information from online sources (e.g., search engines, online databases, blogs, forums, listservs, web analytics, social media, geolocation services) (NF:286) (SP)

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Operations (5 test items)

1. Explain security considerations in the hospitality and tourism industry (OP:115) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of place (distribution) in the hospitality and tourism industry (OP:529) (CS)
3. Identify environmental sustainability issues in hospitality and tourism (OP:658) (SP)

Professional Development (10 test items)

1. Describe the nature of the hospitality and tourism industry (PD:111) (CS)
2. Explain the roles and responsibilities of hospitality and tourism organizations (PD:398) (CS)
3. Describe the interdependence of segments of the hospitality and tourism industry (PD:399) (SP)
4. Discuss the role of ethics in hospitality and tourism (PD:400) (SP)
5. Explain career opportunities in hospitality and tourism (PD:272, LAP-PD-272) (CS)

Product/Service Management (10 test items)

1. Explain the concept of product in the hospitality and tourism industry (PM:081) (CS)
2. Explain guarantees in hospitality and tourism (PM:314) (CS)
3. Describe services offered by the hospitality and tourism industry (PM:095) (CS)

Promotion and Selling (10 test items)

1. Describe the concept of promotion in the hospitality and tourism industry (PR:121) (CS)
2. Explain promotional methods used by the hospitality and tourism industry (PR:082) (SP)
3. Establish relationship with hospitality and tourism customer/guest (SE:499) (CS)
4. Determine hospitality and tourism customer/guest needs (SE:500) (CS)
5. Explain factors that motivate people to choose a hospitality and tourism site (SE:220) (SP)

Event Management (25 test items)

1. Identify factors affecting attendee satisfaction with events (CR:056) (SP)
2. Describe the nature of event budgeting (FI:794) (SP)
3. Develop event budget (FI:795) (SP)
4. Determine staffing needs for events (HR:558) (SP)
5. Identify alternative staffing options (HR:557) (SP)
6. Explain the nature of event marketing (MK:024) (CS)
7. Explain types of events (PD:346) (SP)
8. Describe the nature of the event industry (PD:347) (SP)
9. Explain the nature of event planning (PJ:011) (SP)
10. Describe the nature of event management (PJ:012) (SP)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Hospitality & Event Management

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Hospitality & Event Management Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Customer Relations/Economics and Finances/ Information Management/Operations/Professional Development/ Product/Service Management/ Promotion and Selling/ Event Management*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Expectation Item	**Not Demonstrated**	**Below Expectations**	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**	**Points Earned**
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Human Resource Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Human Resource Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of key HR functions, including staffing, training, employee relations, and performance management. Through an objective test, members explore how effective human resource practices support organizational success and employee development.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **50-minute test**

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

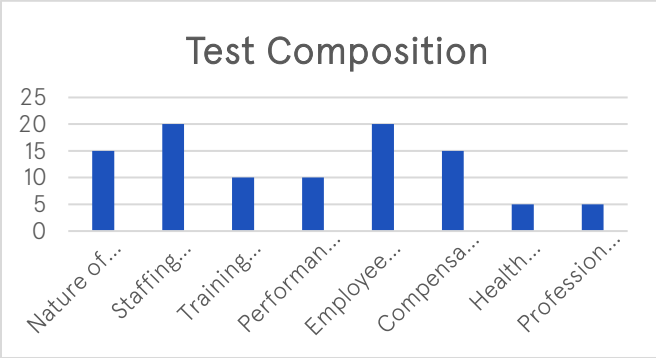
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Nature of Human Resources Management
- Staffing and Talent Acquisition
- Training and Development
- Performance Management
- Employee Relations and Issue Resolution
- Compensation and Total Rewards
- Health and Safety
- Professional Development in Human Resources



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Human Resource Management

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Nature of Human Resources Management (15 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
2. Explain the role of ethics in human resources management (HR:411, LAP-HR-411) (SP)
3. Explain the nature of leadership in organizations (HR:493, LAP-HR-493) (SU)
4. Describe the use of technology in human resources management (HR:412) (SP)
5. Explain human resources management functions (HR:413) (SP)
6. Discuss factors that impact human resources management (e.g., availability of qualified employees, alternative staffing methods, employment laws/regulations, company policies/procedures, compensation and benefit programs, staff diversity) (HR:415) (SP)
7. Explain unfair labor practices (BL:119) (SP)

Staffing and Talent Acquisition (20 test items)

1. Describe planning techniques used in the hiring process (e.g., succession planning, forecasting) (HR:416) (SP)
2. Determine hiring needs (HR:353) (SU)
3. Develop job descriptions and profiles (HR:518) (MN)
4. Recruit new employees (HR:498) (SU)
5. Screen job applications/resumes (HR:354) (SU)
6. Interview job applicants (HR:355) (SU)
7. Explain assessment methods used in the hiring process (HR:522) (SP)
8. Select and hire new employees (HR:356) (SU)
9. Complete new hire documentation and reporting (NF:273) (SP)

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Training and Development (10 test items)

1. Orient new employees (HR:360) (CS)
2. Explain the role of training and human resources development (HR:362) (SU)
3. Explain the nature of management/supervisory training (HR:363) (SU)
4. Train staff (HR:392) (SU)
5. Coach employees (HR:364) (SU)

Performance Management (10 test items)

1. Supervise staff (HR:393) (SU)
2. Assess employee performance (HR:368) (SU)
3. Assess team performance (HR:494) (SU)
4. Recognize/Reward employees (HR:365) (SU)

Employee Relations and Issue Resolution (20 test items)

1. Describe ways that businesses build positive employer-employee relationships (HR:449) (SU)
2. Foster employee engagement and commitment (HR:513) (SU)
3. Handle employee complaints and grievances (HR:366) (SU)
4. Explain labor-relations issues (HR:452) (SP)
5. Discuss issues associated with workplace diversity (e.g., ethnic, generational, religious, gender) (HR:515) (SP)
6. Manage employee issues (e.g., attendance, workplace harassment, workplace violence) (HR:544) (SU)
7. Explain the nature of remedial action (HR:369) (SU)
8. Conduct exit interviews (HR:357) (SU)
9. Dismiss/Fire employees (HR:358) (SU)

Compensation and Total Rewards (15 test items)

1. Discuss employee compensation (HR:390) (SU)
2. Explain issues associated with the payroll process (HR:394) (SU)
3. Explain payroll functions (HR:465) (SP)
4. Explain components of total rewards system (HR:467) (SP)
5. Explain the nature of benefit plans (e.g., health insurance, life insurance, educational assistance, health club membership) (HR:475) (SP)
6. Comply with compensation and benefit laws (BL:120) (SP)

Health and Safety (5 test items)

1. Describe general health and safety practices monitored and assessed by human resources management (OP:212) (SP)
2. Discuss the nature of incident and emergency response plans (OP:213) (SP)

Professional Development in Human Resources (5 test items)

1. Explain career opportunities in human resources management (PD:187) (SP)
2. Describe certifications for human resources-management professionals (e.g., Professional in Human Resources [PHR], Senior Professional in Human Resources [SPHR], Global Professional in Human Resources [GPHR]) (PD:188) (SP)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Impromptu Speaking (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Impromptu Speaking challenges members to think quickly and deliver a well-organized, engaging speech on a topic revealed onsite at the competition. Members demonstrate their ability to communicate effectively, organize ideas on the spot, and present with confidence under time constraints.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Speech with a Topic given on-site

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation (Speech):** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards • Pencil • Secret speech topic revealed onsite

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Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation (speech) and a final presentation (speech).

Preliminary Presentation (Speech) Details

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Speech Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of the topic at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the speech.

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Materials

- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Audience

- Presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the speech topic until the event concludes.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event

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Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample speech topics can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Impromptu Speaking (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Impromptu Speaking Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Incorporates provided topic	*Provided topic is not mentioned in speech*	*Topic is not clearly incorporated into speech*	*Topic was clearly incorporated into speech*	*Topic was clearly incorporated and expanded thoroughly throughout the speech*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identify and execute a consistent theme	*No theme presented*	*Theme was identified, but not consistent throughout speech*	*Theme identified and consistent throughout speech*	*Personal stories are utilized to expand on the central theme*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Include accurate and appropriate supporting information	*No supporting information provided OR inappropriate material used*	*One example of supporting information provided*	*Multiple examples of supporting information provided*	*Multiple examples of supporting information included to develop and enhance the speech*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Introduce the topic immediately (Introduction)	*Topic was not introduced*	*Introduction was not clearly presented*	*Introduction was clearly presented, and topic was defined immediately*	*Introduction was clearly presented, and topic was defined immediately with an effective transition into the speech body*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Support the topic throughout (Body)	*Speech did not have a topic*	*Multiple topics presented without clear connections*	*Central topics were identified, connected, and supported throughout the speech*	*Smooth transitions were effectively utilized to support the central topic*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Provide effective conclusion (Closing)	*Speech did not have a conclusion*	*Conclusion was not clearly presented*	*Effective conclusion was presented*	*Conclusion provides connection to entire presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Delivers quality extemporaneous presentation	*Does not address audience at all*	*Reads speech directly from notes with minimal eye contact*	*Glances at notes occasionally while keeping appropriate eye contact with audience*	*Glances at notes occasionally, keeps appropriate eye contact, and utilizes appropriate body language and hand gestures*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-5 points	6-10 points	11-15 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (100 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Insurance & Risk Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Insurance & Risk Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of risk management principles and various types of insurance. Through an objective test, members explore how individuals and businesses identify, assess, and mitigate risks through insurance products and strategic planning.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

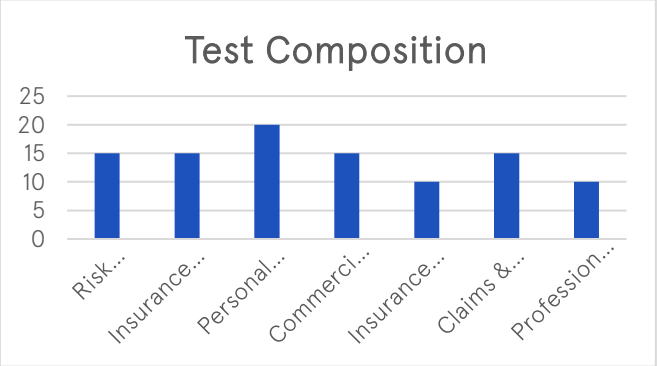
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Risk Management Fundamentals
- Insurance Industry & Legal Principles
- Personal Insurance Products
- Commercial & Specialized Insurance Products
- Insurance Operations & Underwriting
- Claims & Fraud Management
- Professional Development in Insurance



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
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Recognition

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Risk Management Fundamentals (15 test items)

1. Explain the role of ethics in risk management (RM:041, LAP-RM-041) (SP)
2. Describe the use of technology in risk management (RM:042) (SP)
3. Discuss legal considerations affecting risk management (RM:043) (SP)
4. Discuss the nature of enterprise risk management (ERM) (RM:062) (SP)
5. Discuss the nature of risk control (i.e., internal and external) (RM:058) (SP)
6. Describe alternative risk transfer (ART) techniques (e.g., reinsurance, self-insurance, captives) (PD:292) (SP)

Insurance Industry & Legal Principles (15 test items)

1. Describe the nature of the insurance industry (PD:157) (CS)
2. Discuss the role of supervisory/regulatory bodies in the insurance industry (PD:289) (SP)
3. Explain ethical issues in insurance (PD:290) (SP)
4. Discuss federal and state regulation governing the insurance industry (BL:101) (SP)
5. Discuss fundamental legal principles that pertain to insurance (e.g., indemnity, insurable interest, subrogation, utmost good faith) (BL:082) (MN)
6. Describe the nature of insurance contracts (BL:083) (MN)

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Personal Insurance Products (20 test items)

1. Describe components of automobile insurance coverage (PD:319) (SP)
2. Discuss components of homeowners/renters insurance (PD:321) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of health insurance coverage (PD:320) (SP)
4. Discuss the nature of life insurance (PD:323) (SP)
5. Explain the nature of liability insurance (PD:322) (SP)
6. Describe the nature of disability insurance (PD:324) (SP)
7. Discuss the nature of Medicaid (PD:331) (SP)
8. Explain the nature of Medicare (PD:332) (SP)
9. Discuss the role of life insurance in investment, retirement, and estate planning (PD:334) (SP)
10. Evaluate an existing client's insurance needs (PD:336) (SP)

Commercial & Specialized Insurance Products (15 test items)

1. Describe components of commercial property insurance (PD:327) (SP)
2. Explain the nature of commercial liability insurance (PD:328) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of title insurance (PD:326) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of workers compensation insurance (PD:330) (SP)
5. Discuss the nature of unemployment insurance (PD:329) (SP)
6. Discuss components of flood and earthquake insurance (PD:325) (SP)
7. Discuss the nature of domestic and international business insurance (PD:335) (SP)
8. Discuss trends in the insurance industry (e.g., hacker insurance, identity theft insurance) (PD:224) (SP)

Insurance Operations & Underwriting (10 test items)

1. Explain insurance underwriting techniques and processes (RA:004) (SP)
2. Discuss the nature of credit-based insurance scores (RA:002) (SP)
3. Explain the importance of actuarial science in the insurance industry (RA:001) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of pricing and rate-making in insurance (OP:373) (SP)

Claims & Fraud Management (15 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of insurance claims (OP:188) (CS)
2. Process an insurance claim (OP:289) (SP)
3. Inspect property damage (OP:291) (SP)
4. Evaluate injury claims and needed medical treatment (OP:371) (SP)
5. Assign value to an insurance claim (OP:372) (SP)
6. Use claims analytics (NF:204) (SP)
7. Discuss the nature of insurance fraud (OP:187) (SP)

Professional Development in Insurance (10 test items)

1. Discuss employment opportunities in the finance industry (PD:152, LAP-PD-152) (CS)
2. Explain career opportunities in insurance (PD:293) (SP)
3. Discuss licensing and certification in the insurance industry (PD:225) (SP)
4. Describe the services of professional organizations in insurance (PD:294) (SP)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

International Business (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

International Business gives members the opportunity to explore the dynamic global economy and understand how businesses operate across borders. Through an objective test and a role play scenario, members apply their knowledge of international trade, cultural awareness, global marketing, and economic systems.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

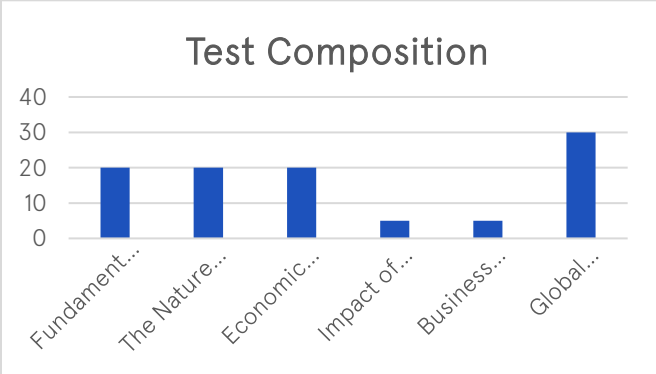
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Fundamental Economic Concepts
- The Nature of Business
- Economic Systems
- Impact of Government
- Business Law
- Global Trade

Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
International Business (High School)

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a global business–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)
- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fundamental Economic Concepts (20 test items)

1. Distinguish between economic goods and services (EC:002, LAP-EC-902) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of economic resources (EC:003, LAP-EC-903) (CS)
3. Describe the concepts of economics and economic activities (EC:001, LAP-EC-901) (CS)
4. Determine economic utilities created by business activities (EC:004, LAP-EC-904) (CS)
5. Explain the principles of supply and demand (EC:005, LAP-EC-905) (CS)
6. Describe the functions of prices and markets (EC:006, LAP-EC-906) (CS)

The Nature of Business (20 test items)

1. Explain the role of business in society (EC:070, LAP-EC-070) (CS)
2. Discuss the global environment in which businesses operate (EC:104, LAP-EC-104) (SP)
3. Describe factors that affect the business environment (EC:105, LAP-EC-105) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of business ethics (EC:106, LAP-EC-106) (SP)
5. Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets (EC:107, LAP-EC-107) (SP)

Economic Systems (20 test items)

1. Explain the types of economic systems (EC:007, LAP-EC-907) (CS)
2. Identify the impact of small business/entrepreneurship on market economies (EC:065) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of private enterprise (EC:009, LAP-EC-909) (CS)
4. Identify factors affecting a business's profit (EC:010, LAP-EC-910) (CS)
5. Determine factors affecting business's risk (EC:011, LAP-EC-911) (CS)
6. Explain the concept of competition (EC:012, LAP-EC-912) (CS)

Impact of Government (5 test items)

1. Determine the relationship between government and business (EC:008, LAP-EC-016) (CS)
2. Describe the nature of taxes (EC:072, LAP-EC-072) (SP)

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Business Law (5 test items)

1. Explain the nature of import/export law (BL:145) (SP)
2. Describe the nature of customs regulations (BL:126) (SP)

Global Trade (30 test items)

1. Explain the nature of global trade (EC:016, LAP-EC-916) (SP)
2. Discuss the impact of globalization on business (EC:109) (SP)
3. Describe the determinants of exchange rates and their effects on the domestic economy (EC:100, LAP-EC-100) (SP)
4. Explain cultural considerations that impact global business relations (EC:110) (SP)
5. Discuss the impact of cultural and social environments on global trade (EC:045, LAP-EC-045) (SP)
6. Describe the impact of electronic communication tools (e.g., internet, video, and computer-conferencing, webcasts, email) on global business activities (EC:111) (SP)
7. Explain the impact of major trade alliances on business activities (EC:112) (SP)
8. Describe the impact of the political environment on world trade (EC:113) (SP)
9. Explain the impact of geography on world trade (EC:114) (SP)
10. Describe the impact of a country's history on world trade (EC:115) (SP)
11. Explain the impact of a country's economic development on world trade (EC:116) (SP)
12. Discuss the impact of bribery and foreign monetary payments on business (EC:140) (SP)
13. Identify requirements for international business travel (e.g., passport, visa, proof of citizenship, immunizations, and sponsorship letters) (EC:141) (SP)

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Lumen. *Introduction to business*. https://courses.lumenlearning.com/wmintrobusinessx51xmaster/chapter/reading-what-is-international-business/

Hayes, A. *Understanding international commerce: Benefits, challenges, and key players*. https://www.investopedia.com/terms/i/international-commerce.asp

Aggarwai, C. *International business: Meaning, importance, and its forms*. https://www.shiksha.com/online-courses/articles/international-business-meaning-importance-its-forms/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

International Business (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

International Business Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Fundamental Economic Concepts/ The Nature of Business/Economic Systems/ Impact of Government/ Business Law/ Global Trade*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Business Communication

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Business Communication challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of fundamental communication skills in a business setting through an objective test. This event introduces concepts such as written and verbal communication, digital messaging, and professional etiquette used to share information within and outside an organization.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

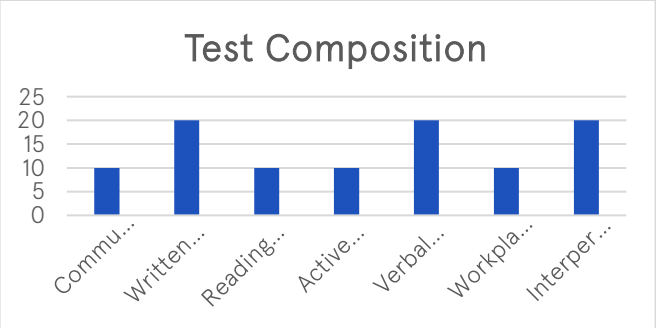
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Communication Basics
- Written Communication
- Reading to Understand
- Active Listening
- Verbal Communication
- Workplace Communication
- Interpersonal Relationships



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Business Communication

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Communication Basics (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of effective communications (EI:007, LAP-EI-140) (PQ)
2. Foster open, honest communication (EI:129, LAP-EI-129) (SP)

Written Communication (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature of effective written communications (CO:016) (CS)
2. Select and utilize appropriate formats for professional writing (CO:088) (CS)
3. Edit and revise written work consistent with professional standards (CO:089) (CS)
4. Write professional emails (CO:090) (CS)
5. Write business letters (CO:133) (CS)
6. Write informational messages (CO:039) (CS)
7. Write inquiries (CO:040) (CS)

Reading to Understand (10 test items)

1. Identify sources that provide relevant, valid written material (CO:054) (PQ)
2. Extract relevant information from written materials (CO:055) (PQ)
3. Apply written directions to achieve tasks (CO:056) (PQ)
4. Analyze company resources to ascertain policies and procedures (CO:057) (CS)

Active Listening (10 test items)

1. Explain communication techniques that support and encourage a speaker (CO:082) (PQ)
2. Follow oral directions (CO:119) (PQ)
3. Demonstrate active listening skills (CO:017, LAP-CO-017) (PQ)

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Verbal Communication (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature of effective verbal communications (CO:147) (PQ)
2. Ask relevant questions (CO:058) (PQ)
3. Interpret others' nonverbal cues (CO:059) (PQ)
4. Provide legitimate responses to inquiries (CO:060) (PQ)
5. Give verbal directions (CO:083) (PQ)
6. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience (CO:084) (CS)
7. Participate in group discussions (CO:053) (CS)
8. Make oral presentations (CO:025, LAP-CO-025) (SP)

Workplace Communication (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of staff communication (CO:014) (CS)
2. Choose and use appropriate channel for workplace communication (CO:092) (CS)
3. Participate in a staff meeting (CO:063) (CS)

Interpersonal Relationships (20 test items)

1. Show empathy for others (EI:030, LAP-EI-030) (PQ)
2. Exhibit cultural sensitivity (EI:033, LAP-EI-033 (CS)
3. Treat others with dignity and respect (EI:036, LAP-EI-036) (PQ)
4. Foster positive working relationships (EI:037, LAP-EI-037) (CS)
5. Consider conflicting viewpoints (EI:136, LAP-EI-136) (CS)
6. Participate as a team member (EI:045, LAP-EI-045) (CS)
7. Use appropriate assertiveness (EI:008, LAP-EI-008) (PQ)
8. Use conflict-resolution skills (EI:015, LAP-EI-915) (CS)

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Nextiva. *What is business communication & how can it benefit your company?* https://www.nextiva.com/blog/what-is-business-communication.html

Indeed. *Guide to business communications: Types, methods, and tips*. https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/guide-to-business-communications

Forbes. *From excruciatingly complex to exactly what you need*. https://www.forbes.com/councils/forbesbusinesscouncil/2023/11/20/a-guide-for-mastering-the-art-of-business-communication/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Business Concepts

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Business Concepts allows members to demonstrate their knowledge of foundational business principles through an objective test. This event introduces members to key business functions such as management, marketing, finance, and operations, encouraging a broad understanding of how businesses operate.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

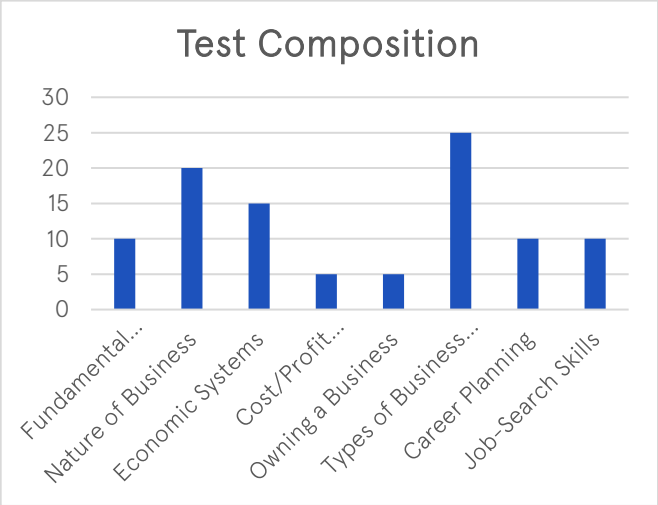
Event Information:	
National Leadership Conference: **Timing Structure:** **Test Duration: 50 Minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	**State/District:** Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Fundamental Economic Concepts
- Nature of Business
- Economic Systems
- Cost/Profit Relationships
- Owning a Business
- Types of Business Activities
- Career Planning
- Job-Search Skills

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Business Concepts

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure..
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- The number of competitors will determine the number of winners. The maximum number of winners for each competitive event is 10.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fundamental Economic Concepts (10 test items)

1. Distinguish between economic goods and services (EC:002, LAP-EC-902) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of economic resources (EC:003, LAP-EC-903) (CS)
3. Describe the concepts of economics and economic activities (EC:001, LAP-EC-901) (CS)
4. Explain the principles of supply and demand (EC:005, LAP-EC-905) (CS)

Nature of Business (20 test items)

1. Explain the role of business in society (EC:070, LAP-EC-070) (CS)
2. Describe types of business models (EC:138) (SP)
3. Explain the organizational design of businesses (EC:103, LAP-EC-103) (SP)
4. Discuss the global environment in which businesses operate (EC:104, LAP-EC-104) (SP)
5. Describe factors that affect the business environment (EC:105, LAP-EC-105) (SP)
6. Explain the nature of business ethics (EC:106, LAP-EC-106) (SP)
7. Explain how organizations adapt to today's markets (EC:107, LAP-EC-107) (SP)
8. Determine the relationship between government and business (EC:008, LAP-EC-016) (CS)

Economic Systems (15 test items)

1. Explain the types of economic systems (EC:007, LAP-EC-907) (CS)
2. Identify the impact of small business/entrepreneurship on market economies (EC:065) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of private enterprise (EC:009, LAP-EC-909) (CS)
4. Identify factors affecting a business's profit (EC:010, LAP-EC-910) (CS)
5. Explain the concept of competition (EC:012, LAP-EC-912) (CS)

Cost/Profit Relationships (5 test items)

1. Explain the concept of productivity (EC:013, LAP-EC-913) (CS)
2. Analyze impact of specialization/division of labor on productivity (EC:014, LAP-EC-914) (SP)

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Owning a Business (5 test items)

1. Explain types of business ownership (BL:003, LAP-BL-003) (CS)
2. Describe the nature of entrepreneurship (EN:039) (SP)

Types of Business Activities (25 test items)

1. Describe types of business activities (EC:071, LAP-EC-071) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of positive customer relations (CR:003, LAP-CR-003) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of accounting (FI:085, LAP-FI-085) (CS)
4. Explain the role of finance in business (FI:354, LAP-FI-354) (CS)
5. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
6. Explain marketing and its importance in a global economy (MK:001, LAP-MK-901) (CS)
7. Discuss the nature of information management (NF:110, LAP-NF-110) (CS)
8. Explain the nature of operations (OP:189, LAP-OP-189) (CS)
9. Explain the concept of production (OP:017, LAP-OP-017) (CS)
10. Explain the concept of management (SM:001, LAP-SM-001) (CS)

Career Planning (10 test items)

1. Assess personal interests and skills needed for success in business (PD:013) (PQ)
2. Analyze employer expectations in the business environment (PD:020) (PQ)
3. Explain employment opportunities in business (PD:025, LAP-PD-025) (CS)
4. Job-Search Skills (10 test items)
5. Complete a job application (PD:027) (PQ)
6. Interview for a job (PD:028) (PQ)
7. Write a cover letter (PD:030) (CS)
8. Prepare a resume (PD:031) (CS)

Job-Search Skills (10 test items)

1. Complete a job application (PD:027) (PQ)
2. Interview for a job (PD:028) (PQ)
3. Write a cover letter (PD:030) (CS)
4. Prepare a resume (PD:031) (CS)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Investopedia. *Business economics.* https://www.investopedia.com/terms/b/business-economics.asp

OpenStax. *Introduction to business*. https://openstax.org/books/introduction-business/pages/1-introduction

Chron. *Role of government in business.* https://smallbusiness.chron.com/role-government-business-803.html

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Business Presentation

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Business Presentation gives members the opportunity to develop and deliver a business-focused presentation using presentation software as a visual aid. Members demonstrate their ability to organize content, communicate ideas clearly, and enhance their message through effective visual support.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School (9th or 10th grade only)
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Where Leaders Begin: Leading a Multigenerational Workforce

Today's workplaces bring together employees from multiple generations, each contributing unique experiences, perspectives, communication styles, and work preferences. Develop a presentation that explores how business leaders can build collaboration, strengthen communication, and create an inclusive workplace where employees of all generations can succeed.

How can effective leadership transform generational differences into organizational success?

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Business Presentation

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
	Items Competitor Must Provide	**Items FBLA Provides**
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

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Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Use of Business Vocabulary:** Use business terms throughout the presentation, while showing understanding
- **Clear Purpose and Logical Flow:** Clearly state the purpose of the presentation and organize ideas in a way that is easy to follow and builds logically from start to finish.
- **Recommendations:** Provide clear, realistic recommendations that make sense based on the topic.
- **Clean, Professional Design using Technology:** Slides and/or visuals should support and explain the message of the presentation.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.

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- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Use of Business Vocabulary:** Use business terms throughout the presentation, while showing understanding
- **Clear Purpose and Logical Flow:** Clearly state the purpose of the presentation and organize ideas in a way that is easy to follow and builds logically from start to finish.
- **Recommendations:** Provide clear, realistic recommendations that make sense based on the topic.
- **Clean, Professional Design using Technology:** Slides and/or visuals should support and explain the message of the presentation.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

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Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Business Presentation

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Business Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the event topic in presentation	*No understanding of event topic OR incorrect topic used*	*Understanding of topic inconsistent from the event guidelines*	*Demonstrates the topic throughout presentation*	*Demonstrates use of industry terminology throughout presentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describes the purpose with a logical sequence of ideas	*No evidence of purpose and logical sequence*	*Purpose stated OR logical sequence of ideas given*	*Purpose is described using a logical sequence of ideas*	*Purpose is well-defined and in a logical sequence of ideas*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Summarizes information from the event topic and identifies recommendations	*No summary or recommendations identified*	*Recommendations or summary provided, but plan not developed*	*Summary was effective and logical recommendations developed*	*Summary provided logical connection to all aspects of the event topic through entire presentation, with feasible recommendations identified*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Technology demonstrates proper formatting, design elements, and business presentation features	*No use of technology or design*	*Proper formatting and design elements are consistent with theme*	*Demonstrates with visual aids proper formatting and design elements*	*Emphasize interpretation of the topic through proper formatting and design of the presentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Uses suitable and accurate statements of information in presentation	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Business Presentation

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	*Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines*	*Execution Aligned with Guidelines:* ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (115 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Business Procedures

Introduction to Business Procedures challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of basic office procedures and workplace practices through an objective test. This event introduces members to topics such as administrative tasks, business protocols, and decision-making in a professional environment.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

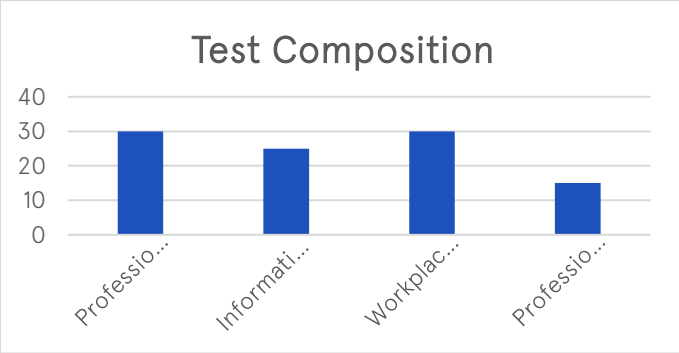
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Professional Communication & Correspondence
- Information Management & Technology
- Workplace Protocols & Decision Making
- Professional Development & Career Readiness



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Business Procedures

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Professional Communication & Correspondence (30 test items)

1. Demonstrate active listening skills (CO:017, LAP-CO-017) (SP)
2. Explain communication techniques that support and encourage a speaker (CO:082) (SP)
3. Interpret others' nonverbal cues (CO:059) (PQ)
4. Handle phone calls in a businesslike manner (CO:114) (CS)
5. Select and utilize appropriate formats for professional writing (CO:088) (CS)
6. Write professional emails (CO:090) (CS)
7. Write business letters (CO:133) (CS)
8. Select and use appropriate graphic aids (CO:087) (CS)
9. Make oral presentations (CO:025, LAP-CO-025) (SP)
10. Reinforce service orientation through communication (CR:005) (CS)

Information Management & Technology (25 test items)

1. Identify ways that technology impacts business (NF:003, LAP-NF-003) (PQ)
2. Demonstrate basic email functions (NF:004) (PQ)
3. Demonstrate basic word processing skills (NF:007) (PQ)
4. Demonstrate basic spreadsheet applications (NF:010) (PQ)
5. Demonstrate personal information management/productivity applications (NF:005) (PQ)
6. Obtain needed information efficiently (NF:078) (CS)
7. Discuss the nature of information management (NF:110, LAP-NF-110) (CS)
8. Use an integrated business software application package (NF:088) (CS)
9. Describe the nature of business records (NF:001, LAP-NF-001) (SP)

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Workplace Protocols & Decision Making (30 test items)

1. Identify sources that provide relevant, valid written material (CO:054) (PQ)
2. Apply written directions to achieve tasks (CO:056) (PQ)
3. Analyze company resources to ascertain policies and procedures (CO:057) (CS)
4. Adhere to company protocols and policies (PD:250, LAP-PD-250) (CS)
5. Follow rules of conduct (PD:251, LAP-PD-251) (CS)
6. Follow chain of command (PD:252, LAP-PD-252) (CS)
7. Demonstrate ethical work habits (EI:004, LAP-EI-004) (PQ)
8. Make decisions (PD:017, LAP-PD-017) (CS)
9. Demonstrate problem-solving skills (PD:077, LAP-PD-077) (CS)
10. Explain the need for innovation skills (PD:126, LAP-PD-126) (CS)
11. Use time-management skills (PD:019, LAP-PD-019) (SP)

Professional Development & Career Readiness (15 test items)

1. Interview for a job (PD:028) (PQ)
2. Explain employment opportunities in business (PD:025, LAP-PD-025) (CS)
3. Set personal goals (PD:018, LAP-PD-018) (CS)
4. Prepare a resume (PD:031) (CS)
5. Write a cover letter (PD:030) (CS)

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Coursera. *What is a business process and how is it used?* https://www.coursera.org/articles/business-process

Indeed. *Business processes: Definition, characteristics and examples*. https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/business-processes

Scribe. *How to effectively document procedures (with examples)*. https://scribe.com/library/examples-of-procedures-in-business

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to FBLA

Introduction to FBLA allows members to demonstrate their knowledge of the organization's history, structure, programs, and leadership through an objective test. This event encourages members to deepen their understanding of FBLA and become more engaged in its mission and opportunities.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- FBLA History
- FBLA Corporate & Division Bylaws
- FBLA Programs
- FBLA Pledge, Mission, Goals, Creed
- FBLA High School Competitive Events
- FBLA Structure
- FBLA Dress Code
- FBLA Publications
- FBLA Deadlines
- FBLA Website & Communications
- FBLA Partners

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas. There is no test composition for this test.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to FBLA

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Information Technology

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Information Technology challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of fundamental IT concepts through an objective test. This event introduces members to key areas such as computer systems, software, networks, and data management, highlighting how technology is used to organize and deliver information in business settings.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

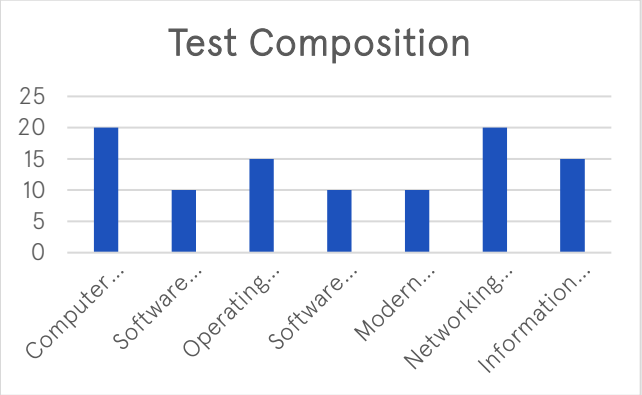
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Computer Hardware
- Software Fundamentals
- Operating Systems
- Software Applications
- Modern Technologies
- Networking Concepts
- Information Management Concepts

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Information Technology

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

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  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
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- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an objective test administered online during the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

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- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
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Sample Preparation Resources

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Computer Hardware (20 test items)

1. Describe different types of computers and their use cases (mainframe, personal, tablet, supercomputer, etc.)
2. Discuss common computer hardware components and their functions (e.g., CPU, RAM, hard drive)
3. Troubleshoot common computer hardware problems
4. Explain the purposes of expansion cards (e.g., graphics cards, sound cards, network adapters)
5. Evaluate decisions regarding the purchase and upgrade of computer hardware
6. Describe computer storage devices (e.g., SSD, HDD, external drives)
7. Explain the steps of basic hardware installation and configuration
8. Evaluate the performance of computer system components (CPU, GPU, etc.)
9. Discuss connectivity devices and peripherals (e.g., printers, scanners, USB devices, Bluetooth)
10. Interpret hardware requirements for running software

Software Fundamentals (10 test items)

1. Distinguish between system, application, and specialized software
2. Explain the importance of software updates and patches
3. Explain the functions of various system utilities (e.g., antivirus, disk management, backup tools)
4. Describe appropriate use cases for specialized software applications
5. Identify the steps of the Software Development Life Cycle
6. Describe how software interacts with hardware to perform tasks

Operating Systems (15 test items)

1. Explain the purpose and functions of operating systems
2. Discuss types of operating systems (e.g., mobile, desktop)
3. Troubleshoot common operating system issues (e.g., blue screen of death, crashing, boot issues)
4. Discuss the characteristics of different platform operating systems (e.g., Windows, macOS, Linux, Android, iOS)
5. Discuss basic operating system processes (e.g., booting and partitioning, caching, virtual memory, file systems)
6. Apply basic command-line utilities for Windows and Unix-like systems (e.g., file management, process monitoring, troubleshooting)
7. Describe steps for configuring an operating system (e.g., account setup and management, permissions, updates)

Software Applications (10 test items)

1. Evaluate the most appropriate type of application for a business task (e.g., word processing, spreadsheet, email, presentation)
2. Discuss the uses of common workplace applications (e.g., word processing, spreadsheet, email, collaboration)
3. Describe email application features used in business and collaboration contexts
4. Explain the functions of team collaboration software (e.g., Microsoft Teams, Zoom)
5. Troubleshoot common email problems (e.g., spam, not receiving emails, fraud, phishing)

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Modern Technologies (10 test items)

1. Describe the function and applications of the cloud
2. Describe the purpose and applications of virtualization
3. Describe the Internet of Things (IoT)
4. Discuss use cases for artificial intelligence
5. Describe the nature of artificial intelligence

Networking Concepts (20 test items)

1. Describe different types of networks (e.g., LAN, WAN)
2. Describe basic network security practices (e.g., encryption, VPN, packet sniffing, authentication)
3. Discuss common network security threats (e.g., viruses, phishing, backdoors)
4. Describe different connectivity technologies (e.g., Ethernet, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth)
5. Discuss the functions of common network devices (e.g., modems, routers, switches)
6. Discuss types of network environments (e.g., peer-to-peer, client-server, thin client)
7. Explain relationships between major network components (e.g., servers, clients, switches)
8. Describe each layer of the Open System Interconnection (OSI) model
9. Explain basic networking protocols (e.g., TCP/IP, UDP, DHCP, SMP)
10. Discuss the characteristics of network topologies (e.g., star, bus, ring)
11. Describe tools and procedures for troubleshooting networks (e.g., ping, tracert, checking cable connections)

Information Management Concepts (15 test items)

1. Describe data storage methods (local, cloud, etc.)
2. Discuss basic database operations and use cases
3. Explain the importance of disaster recovery and list examples
4. Discuss physical and digital security practices to protect information
5. Describe ways in which personal data is collected, stored, stolen, and sold
6. Explain regulations pertaining to intellectual property, privacy, and licensing

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References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Marketing Concepts

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Marketing Concepts allows members to demonstrate their understanding of foundational marketing principles through an objective test. This event introduces topics such as product promotion, pricing strategies, consumer behavior, and the methods used to effectively sell goods and services.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

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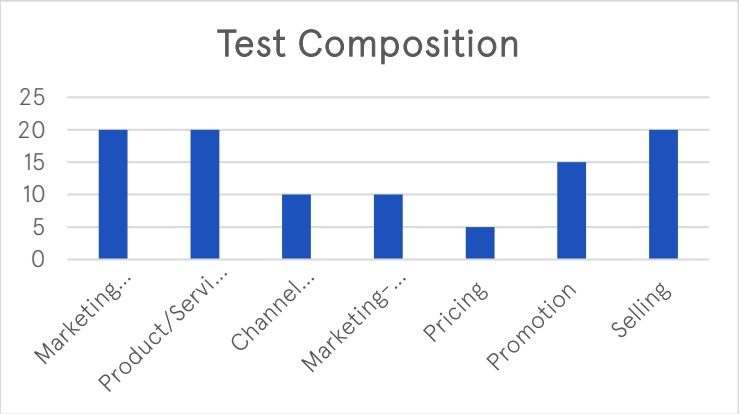
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Marketing Fundamentals
- Product/Service Management
- Channel Management
- Marketing-Information Management
- Pricing
- Promotion
- Selling



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Marketing Concepts

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
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- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
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Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Marketing Concepts

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Marketing Fundamentals (20 test items)

1. Describe marketing functions and related activities (MK:002, LAP-MK-002) (CS)
2. Explain marketing and its importance in a global economy (MK:001, LAP-MK-901) (CS)
3. Explain the concept of market and market identification (MP:003, LAP-MP-003) (CS)
4. Explain the concept of marketing strategies (MP:001, LAP-MP-001) (CS)
5. Explain employment opportunities in marketing (PD:024, LAP-PD-024) (CS)
6. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior (MK:014, LAP-MK-014) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of marketing planning (MP:006) (SP)
8. Explain the nature of marketing plans (MP:007, LAP-MP-007) (SP)

Product/Service Management (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function (PM:001, LAP-PM-001) (SP)
2. Identify the impact of product life cycles on marketing decisions (PM:024, LAP-PM-024) (SP)
3. Describe the uses of grades and standards in marketing (PM:019, LAP-PM-019) (CS)
4. Explain warranties and guarantees (PM:020, LAP-PM-920) (CS)
5. Explain the concept of the product mix (PM:003, LAP-PM-003) (SP)
6. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services (PM:042, LAP-PM-042) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of product/service branding (PM:021, LAP-PM-021) (SP)

Channel Management (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of channel management (CM:001, LAP-CM-001) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of channels of distribution (CM:003, LAP-CM-003) (CS)
3. Describe the use of technology in the channel management function (CM:004) (CS)

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Marketing-Information Management (10 test items)

1. Describe the need for marketing data (IM:012, LAP-IM-012) (CS)
2. Identify data monitored for marketing decision making (IM:184, LAP-IM-184) (SP)
3. Explain the nature and scope of the marketing-information management function (IM:001, LAP-IM-001) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of marketing research (IM:010, LAP-IM-010) (SP)

Pricing (5 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of the pricing function (PI:001, LAP-PI-001) (SP)
2. Explain factors affecting pricing decisions (PI:002, LAP-PI-902) (SP)

Promotion (15 test items)

1. Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function (PR:001, LAP-PR-901) (CS)
2. Explain the types of promotion (i.e., institutional, product) (PR:002, LAP-PR-902) (CS)
3. Identify the elements of the promotional mix (PR:003, LAP-PR-903) (SP)
4. Explain types of advertising media (PR:007, LAP-PR-007) (SP)

Selling (20 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of the selling function (SE:017, LAP-SE-017) (CS)
2. Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships (SE:076, LAP-SE-076) (CS)
3. Acquire product information for use in selling (SE:062, LAP-SE-062) (CS)
4. Explain the selling process (SE:048, LAP-SE-048) (CS)
5. Explain company selling policies (SE:932, LAP-SE-932) (CS)
6. Analyze product information to identify product features and benefits (SE:109, LAP-SE-109) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Investopedia. *Understanding marketing in business: Key strategies and types.* https://www.investopedia.com/terms/m/marketing.asp

Wolters Kluwer. *Business success depends upon successful marketing.* https://www.wolterskluwer.com/en/expert-insights/business-success-depends-upon-successful-marketing

HubSpot. *What is marketing, and what's its purpose?* https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/what-is-marketing#what-is-marketing

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Parliamentary Procedure

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Parliamentary Procedure challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of the basic principles and rules used to conduct orderly and effective meetings. Through an objective test, members explore topics such as motions, voting procedures, and meeting structure based on parliamentary law.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

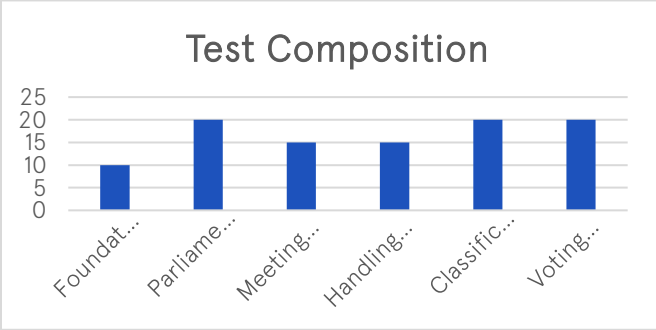
Important Notes:
- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Foundations of Parliamentary Procedure
- Parliamentary Terminology
- Meeting Structure and Order of Business
- Handling a Main Motion
- Classification of Motions
- Voting and Elections



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Parliamentary Procedure

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guides

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Foundations of Parliamentary Procedure (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and purpose of parliamentary procedure
2. Identify the official parliamentary authority (Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised)
3. Discuss the fundamental principles of parliamentary law (e.g., rights of the majority and minority)
4. Describe the concept of "one thing at a time"
5. Identify the basic rights of an individual member

Parliamentary Terminology (20 test items)

1. Define common parliamentary terms (e.g., floor, chair, quorum, pending)
2. Explain the concept of immediately pending motions
3. Define the different types of meetings (e.g., regular, special)
4. Identify the differences between a plurality and a majority vote
5. Define the roles of "pro tem" and "ex officio" positions
6. Describe the concept of obtaining the floor
7. Differentiate between a meeting and a session

Meeting Structure and Order of Business (15 test items)

1. Describe the components of a standard order of business
2. Explain the purpose and basic contents of meeting minutes
3. Describe the process for opening and closing a meeting
4. Explain the primary duties of the presiding officer
5. Describe the basic record-keeping role of the secretary
6. Explain the formal process for approving and correcting minutes

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Handling a Main Motion (15 test items)

1. List the six steps in handling a main motion from introduction to announcement of the result
2. Explain the process for seeking recognition from the chair
3. Describe the requirement and process for seconding a motion
4. Discuss the basic rules and time limits for debate
5. Explain the process the chair uses for stating the question

Classification of Motions (20 test items)

1. Identify the four basic classes of motions
2. Describe the purpose of common Subsidiary motions (e.g., Postpone, Amend)
3. Describe the purpose of common Privileged motions (e.g., Adjourn, Recess)
4. Explain the purpose of basic Incidental motions (e.g., Point of Order)
5. Distinguish between debatable and non-debatable motions
6. Explain the concept of the order of precedence for motions
7. Explain the purpose of the motion to amend

Voting and Elections (20 test items)

1. Identify common methods of voting (e.g., voice, rising, show of hands)
2. Explain the use and purpose of a ballot vote
3. Define the requirements for a two-thirds vote
4. Describe the process for basic nominations from the floor
5. Explain the chair's responsibility and rights in the voting process
6. Describe the process for a "Division of the Assembly" to verify a vote
7. Discuss the procedure for closing and reopening nominations

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Michigan State University. *Parliamentary procedure resource*. https://spartanexperiences.msu.edu/government/parliamentary-procedure-resource.html

MRSC. *Parliamentary procedure: A brief guide to Robert's Rules of Order*. https://mrsc.org/explore-topics/public-meetings/procedures/parliamentary-procedure

NACD. *Pocket guide to parliamentary procedure*. https://www.nacdnet.org/parliamentary-procedure/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Programming

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Programming allows members to design and develop a basic computer program based on a given topic. Members demonstrate their coding skills, logic, and creativity by presenting the completed program to a panel of judges.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School (9th & 10th grade only)
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Local Business Digital Ordering System

Many small businesses are expanding their services by offering customers the ability to place orders digitally. Develop a digital ordering system for a local business of your choice that provides customers with a convenient and user-friendly ordering experience.

Your program should allow customers to browse products or services, place and manage orders, calculate purchase totals, and review order information. Competitors should determine the specific features and functionality that best support the needs of the selected business and its customers.

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Your program should also account for real-world situations, such as unavailable items, inventory limits, invalid entries, or customer budget constraints.
Use any programming language or environment that demonstrates your understanding of variables, conditionals, loops, functions, lists or arrays, user input, and basic program organization.

How can your system improve the customer experience while helping a local business operate more efficiently?

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.

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- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).

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- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Code Quality & Structure:** Demonstrate organized, readable code using clear structure and meaningful function names.
- **User Experience:** Design a program that is easy to navigate with clear instructions for the user.
- **Input Validation:** Apply input checks that ensure the data is in the correct format and makes sense.
- **Functionality:** Explain how the program solves the assigned problem and connects to the topic.
- **Data & Logic:** Use appropriate data structures and logical flow to support program goals.
- **Documentation:** Include all required documentation and credit any external resources used:
  - A readme file that explains how to use the program
  - The source code
  - A list of any templates or libraries used
  - Clear credit for any outside resources

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.

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- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Code Quality & Structure:** Demonstrate organized, readable code using clear structure and meaningful function names.
- **User Experience:** Design a program that is easy to navigate with clear instructions for the user.

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- **Input Validation:** Apply input checks that ensure the data is in the correct format and makes sense.
- **Functionality:** Explain how the program solves the assigned problem and connects to the topic.
- **Data & Logic:** Use appropriate data structures and logical flow to support program goals.
- **Documentation:** Include all required documentation and credit any external resources used:
  - A readme file that explains how to use the program
  - The source code
  - A list of any templates or libraries used
  - Clear credit for any outside resources

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Programming

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Programming Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Code Quality					
Appropriate use of comments, naming conventions, and proper formatting	*No comments provided*	*Comments provided but are not logical*	*Comments provided assist judges throughout the demonstration*	*Comments provided are logical, useful, and complete*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
The program is modular in a way that makes logical, readable sense	*The program is written as one large block with no use of functions, methods, or modular structure.*	*Some attempt is made to break the program into sections, but the structure is unclear, inconsistent, or difficult to follow.*	*The program uses a modular structure with clear functions or methods. Each part of the program is organized in a way that makes sense and supports readability.*	*The program is highly organized with well-named, purpose-driven functions or modules. The structure makes the code easy to read, understand, and maintain, showing a strong understanding of clean programming practices.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
User Experience					
User interface is intuitive or clear instructions are provided	*No instructions provided and is not intuitive*	*Instructions provided or program is not intuitive*	*Appropriate & clear instructions are provided*	*Program is intuitive and clear instructions are provided*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Users can easily navigate between pages	*No help menu or navigation system incorporated*	*Includes basic help menu and usable navigation*	*Interface contains no spelling errors, has interactive help menu, and has no navigation errors*	*Program use also includes an intelligent feature such as an interactive Q&A*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
User input is validated	*User input isn't validated*	*User input validation attempted, but does not catch important edge cases or is not done correctly*	*User input is validated*	*Input validation applied on both syntactical and semantic levels*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Functionality					
Program addresses all parts of the prompt	*Program does not address the topic/problem*	*Program addresses the topic/problem at a minimal level*	*Program fully addresses the topic/problem*	*Program fully addresses the topic/problem, and the correlation is explained in the instructions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Program generates a presentable report	*Output reports are not accurate or not available*	*Output reports are not sufficient to analyze data*	*Output reports are error free and provide all necessary information to analyze data*	*Output reports allow user to customize and analyze information*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Data storage	*There is no storage of data*	*Variables are used inconsistently, or in a way that is unclear*	*Variable name and usage is clear. Variables store data that updates when necessary. Each variable performs only one job, and the correct data type is used*	*More complex data storage such as arrays and lists are used where appropriate and variable scope makes sense*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Programming

FBLA
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Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Documentation					
Comprehensive documentation is included: readme file, source code, templates/libraries used, and attribution for any open-source or copyrighted material.	*No documentation is provided, or required components are missing entirely.*	*Some documentation is provided, but it is incomplete, unclear, or missing key parts (such as attributions or templates used).*	*Documentation is mostly complete and includes a readme file, source code, and list of templates/libraries. Proper attribution is given where required.*	*Documentation is thorough, well-organized, and complete. All required components are included, clearly labeled, and professionally presented. Proper credit is clearly given for all external resources.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of three)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (130 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Public Speaking

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Public Speaking gives members the opportunity to develop and deliver a speech on a designated topic. This event helps members build confidence, organize ideas, and strengthen their verbal communication skills through a live presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th and 10th grades only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Speech

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Presentation: Maximum of 5 minutes**
  - *one-minute warning*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A): 2 minutes**

Important: Time allocations are exclusive. Time may not be shifted between segments.

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Where Leaders Begin: Serving Others

Deliver a speech explaining how serving others helps individuals develop leadership skills, build stronger communities, and create meaningful change. Support your ideas with examples from school, business, or everyday life.

How does serving others prepare individuals to become effective leaders?

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• N/A

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 0 minutes
- **Presentation:** Maximum of 5 minutes (one-minute warning)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 2 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. Time may not be shifted between segments.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Reference materials such as visual aids, props, handouts or electronic devices.

Copyright Compliance

- All competitors must comply with state and federal copyright laws.
- Facts and data must be cited using credible sources.

Event Specific Information

- The speech must be developed around the topic.
- When delivering the speech, competitors may use notes prepared before the event.

Final Presentation Details

The presentation guidelines outlined above will apply to the final presentation.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- **Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.**
- **Finalists may not** view other presentations in their own event.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.

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- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Public Speaking

FBLA
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Introduction to Public Speaking Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Topic & Theme *Incorporates provided topic and executes a consistent theme*	*Provided topic is not mentioned in speech*	*Topic is not clearly incorporated into speech*	*Topic was clearly incorporated into speech*	*Topic was clearly incorporated and expanded thoroughly throughout the speech, using personal stories*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Introduction *Introduce the speech*	*Speech had no introduction*	*Introduction was not clearly presented*	*Introduction was clearly presented, and topic was defined*	*Introduction was clearly presented, and topic was defined with an effective transition into the speech body*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Supporting Information (Body) *Include accurate and appropriate supporting information*	*Speech did not have a topic*	*Multiple topics presented without clear connections*	*Central topics were identified, connected, and supported throughout the speech*	*Central topics were identified, connected, and supported throughout the speech with smooth transitions effectively utilized to support the central topic*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Conclusion *Provide effective conclusion connected to the topic & theme*	*Speech did not have a conclusion*	*Conclusion was not clearly presented*	*Effective conclusion was presented*	*Conclusion provides connection to entire presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Pace & Fluency *Deliver speech with appropriate pace & lack of filler words*	*Maintained an inconsistent pace that was either too fast or slow, paired with excessive use of filler words*	*Displayed a distracting and uneven pace, accompanied by noticeable use of filler words*	*Maintained an appropriate pace with minimal use of filler words*	*Maintained a well-varied pace and eliminated filler words*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Engagement *Deliver speech with varied facial expressions, excellent eye contact with judges, good posture*	*Does not make eye contact or have varied facial expressions*	*Minimal varied facial expressions and/or eye contact*	*Appropriate facial expressions and eye contact*	*Appropriate eye contact, facial expressions, fully engaging the audience and didn't use notecards*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Vocal Clarity *Deliver speech with appropriate voice projection*	*Does not have voice projection*	*Minimal voice projection*	*Appropriate voice projection*	*Appropriate voice projection and diction*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Poise & Presence *Deliver speech with self-confidence, and poise*	*Did not demonstrate self-confidence, poise, or good posture*	*Demonstrated self-confidence, poise, or good posture*	*Demonstrated elevated self-confidence, poise, and good posture*	*Demonstrated elevated self-confidence, poise, posture, and assertiveness*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	*Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines*	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Avoided use of food, live animals, technology, visuals, props*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (110 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Retail & Merchandising

Introduction to Retail & Merchandising challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of basic principles in retail operations and merchandising strategies through an objective test. Topics include product placement, inventory control, customer experience, and sales techniques within the retail environment.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

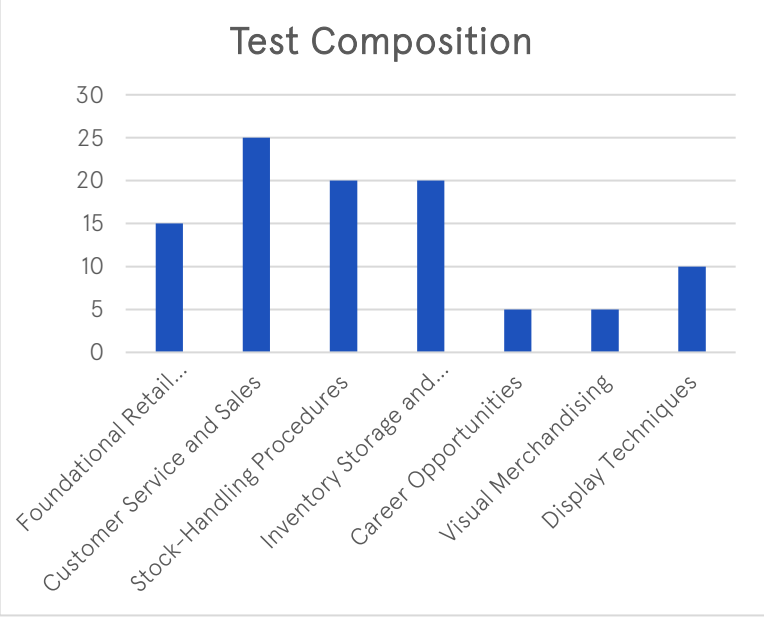
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Foundational Retail Knowledge
- Customer Service and Sales
- Stock-Handling Procedures
- Inventory Storage and Control
- Career Opportunities
- Visual Merchandising
- Display Techniques

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Retail & Merchandising

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Retail & Merchandising

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation
MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Foundational Retail Knowledge (15 test items)

1. Explain the evolution of retailing (PD:148) (CS)
2. Describe the role of merchandisers in retailing (PD:148) (CS)
3. Distinguish between retailing and marketing (MK:003) (CS)
4. Explain the importance of merchandising to retailers (MK:020) (CS)

Customer Service and Sales (25 test items)

1. Establish relationship with customer/client (SE:110) (CS)
2. Determine customer/client needs (SE:111) (CS)
3. Recommend specific products (SE:114, LAP-SE-114) (CS)
4. Prepare cash drawers/banks (OP:194) (CS)
5. Open/Close register/terminal (OP:195) (CS)
6. Operate register/terminal (SE:153) (CS)
7. Process sales transactions (e.g., cash, credit, check) (SE:329) (CS)
8. Process returns/exchanges (SE:162) (CS)

Stock-Handling Procedures (20 test items)

1. Explain the receiving process (OP:384) (CS)
2. Explain stock-handling techniques used in receiving deliveries (OP:385) (CS)
3. Process incoming merchandise (OP:386) (CS)
4. Price mark merchandise (OP:390) (CS)
5. Route stock to sales floor (OP:394) (CS)
6. Rotate stock (OP:395) (CS)
7. Explain policies/procedures for handling shoplifters (OP:122) (CS)

Inventory Storage and Control (20 test items)

1. Explain storing considerations (OP:400) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of warehousing (OP:401) (CS)
3. Store inventory (OP:402) (CS)
4. Maintain inventory levels (OP:407) (CS)
5. Report out-of-stocks (OP:408) (CS)
6. Complete inventory counts (OP:409) (CS)

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7. Describe inventory control systems (OP:413) (CS)

Career Opportunities (5 test items)

1. Identify career opportunities in retailing (PD:038) (CS)
2. Explain career opportunities in merchandising (PD:134) (CS)

Visual Merchandising (5 test items)

1. Explain the use of visual merchandising in retailing (PR:023) (CS)
2. Distinguish between visual merchandising and display (PR:302) (CS)

Display Techniques (10 test items)

1. Explain types of display arrangements (PR:026) (CS)
2. Maintain displays (PR:052) (CS)
3. Dismantle/Store displays/display fixtures/forms (PR:054) (CS)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Brightpearl. *What is retail merchandising: A complete guide*. https://www.brightpearl.com/blog/what-is-retail-merchandising-a-complete-guide

CGS. *Comprehensive guide to retail merchandising*. https://www.cgsinc.com/blog/comprehensive-guide-retail-merchandising

Indeed. *What is merchandise retailing? (With best practices and tips)*. https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/merchandise-retailing

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Social Media Strategy

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Social Media Strategy allows members to develop and present a marketing strategy centered around a single social media platform. Members demonstrate their understanding of audience engagement, content creation, and campaign effectiveness through a live presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School (9th & 10th grade only)
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Tee Off the Fun: Grand Opening of a Family Mini Golf Course

A new family mini golf course is preparing for its grand opening and wants to use social media to introduce its brand, build excitement, and encourage families and friends to visit. Choose ***one*** social media platform and create a series of posts that promote the grand opening and showcases the unique experiences the mini golf course has to offer.

How can social media generate excitement, attract new customers, and encourage visitors to return for future experiences?

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District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Use of Industry Terminology:** Demonstrate knowledge of social media by using accurate terms and concepts throughout the presentation.
- **Strategy and Metrics:** Explain the campaign strategy clearly, including goals, target audience, content planning, and performance metrics. Use metrics to show how success is measured and how decisions were made.
- **Design and Development Process:** Describe how the campaign was planned and created, including creative choices, tools used, and how the approach was adjusted to better reach the intended audience.
- **Campaign and Ad Integration:** Present a campaign focused on one social media platform. Include three original, well-developed ads that are clearly connected to the campaign's message and audience.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.

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- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Use of Industry Terminology:** Demonstrate knowledge of social media by using accurate terms and concepts throughout the presentation.
- **Strategy and Metrics:** Explain the campaign strategy clearly, including goals, target audience, content planning, and performance metrics. Use metrics to show how success is measured and how decisions were made.
- **Design and Development Process:** Describe how the campaign was planned and created, including creative choices, tools used, and how the approach was adjusted to better reach the intended audience.
- **Campaign and Ad Integration:** Present a campaign focused on one social media platform. Include three original, well-developed ads that are clearly connected to the campaign's message and audience.

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Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Social Media Strategy

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Social Media Strategy Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the event topic	*No understanding of event topic OR incorrect topic used*	*Understanding of topic inconsistent during the presentation*	*Demonstrates the topic throughout presentation*	*Demonstrates use of industry terminology and expertise throughout presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrate knowledge of a social media strategy and metrics throughout	*No reference to social media strategy or metrics is made in the presentation.*	*Mentions strategy or metrics briefly but with limited understanding or detail. Metrics may be unclear or unrelated to campaign goals.*	*Shows clear understanding of social media strategy and includes relevant metrics to measure success. Strategy and metrics support the campaign's purpose*	*Demonstrates strong understanding of social media strategy with consistent references to goals, audience, content planning, and performance metrics. Metrics are clearly explained and effectively used to support decision-making and campaign evaluation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Explains the design and development process	*No explanation of the design or development process is provided.*	*Gives a brief or unclear explanation of how the campaign or ads were created. Missing key steps or reasoning behind design choices.*	*Clearly explains the steps taken to design and develop the campaign and ads. Shows understanding of how choices support the campaign's goals.*	*Provides a clear and detailed explanation of the full design and development process. Describes creative decisions, tools used, and how the campaign evolved to best meet the goals and audience needs.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Incorporates campaign into presentation	*No campaign is included, or campaign does not focus on a single platform or include any developed ads.*	*Campaign is included but lacks clarity or development. Fewer than three ads are presented, or ads are not clearly connected to a single platform.*	*Campaign is focused on one social media platform and includes three relevant ads. Ads are included in the presentation and generally support the campaign's message.*	*Campaign is clearly centered on one social media platform and features three well-developed, creative ads. Ads are thoughtfully integrated into the presentation and strongly support the campaign's goals, audience, and messaging.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Social Media Strategy

Future Business Leaders of America

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals* ✓ *Used only one social media platform*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Supply Chain Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Introduction to Supply Chain Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of the processes involved in the flow of goods, information, and finances within a supply chain. Through an objective test, members explore key concepts such as logistics, inventory control, procurement, and distribution strategies.

Educational Alignments

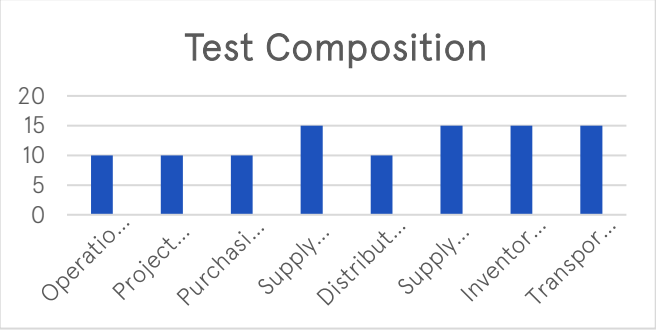
Event Overview	
Division	High School (9th & 10th graders only)
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:	
National Leadership Conference: **Timing Structure:** **Test Duration: 50 minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	**State/District:** Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Operations (10 test items)
- Project Management (10 test items)
- Purchasing (10 test items)
- Supply Chain Management's Role in Business (15 test items)
- Distribution (10 test items)
- Supply Chain Management Activities (15 test items)
- Inventory Processes (15 test items)
- Transportation Strategies (15 test items)



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Introduction to Supply Chain Management

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

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- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Introduction to Supply Chain Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Operations (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of operations (OP:189, LAP-OP-189) (CS)
2. Discuss the role of ethics in operations (OP:190, LAP-OP-190) (SP)
3. Describe the use of technology in operations (OP:191) (SP)

Project Management (10 test items)

1. Plan project (OP:519, LAP-OP-519) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of project management (OP:158, LAP-OP-158) (SP)
3. Describe the role of ethics in project management (OP:675, LAP-OP-675) (SP)

Purchasing (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of purchasing (OP:015, LAP-OP-015) (CS)
2. Maintain inventory of supplies (OP:031) (CS)
3. Explain the impact of the purchasing process on productivity (OP:247) (SP)
4. Discuss the nature of purchasing methods (OP:248) (SP)

Supply Chain Management's Role in Business (15 test items)

1. Explain the concept of supply chain (OP:443, LAP-OP-443) (CS)
2. Explain the benefits of supply chain collaboration (OP:444) (SP)
3. Describe the nature of supply chain management (OP:303, LAP-OP-303) (SP)
4. Explain the impact of supply chains on business performance (OP:477) (SP)

Distribution (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of distribution (OP:522) (CS)
2. Describe the use of technology in distribution (OP:524) (SP)
3. Explain legal considerations in distribution (OP:525) (SP)
4. Describe ethical considerations in distribution (OP:526) (SP)

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Supply Chain Management Activities (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature of order cycle time (OP:299) (SP)
2. Describe supply chain management strategies (OP:305) (SP)
3. Describe risk factors and trends affecting supply chain systems (e.g., sustainability, geopolitical volatility, cyber security, artificial intelligence, automation) (OP:499, LAP-OP-499) (SP)
4. Identify supply chain process improvement opportunities (OP:500) (SP)
5. Implement supply chain management strategies (OP:306) (SP)

Inventory Processes (15 test items)

1. Fulfill orders (OP:381) (CS)
2. Explain the receiving process (OP:384) (CS)
3. Explain storing considerations (OP:400) (CS)
4. Explain the nature of warehousing (OP:401) (CS)
5. Store inventory (OP:402) (CS)
6. Explain shipping processes (OP:405) (CS)

Transportation Strategies (15 test items)

1. Describe the transportation modes (OP:505) (SP)
2. Explain the scope of domestic and global transport systems (OP:506) (SP)
3. Explain international transportation and delivery system elements (OP:510) (SP)
4. Develop transportation plans (OP:511) (SP)
5. Assess transportation processes (OP:512) (SP)
6. Describe the nature and scope of reverse logistics (OP:513, LAP-OP-513) (SP)

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Fernando, J. *Understanding supply chain management (SCM) and its importance*. https://www.investopedia.com/terms/s/scm.asp

Indeed. *What is logistics and supply chain management?* https://www.indeed.com/hire/c/info/supply-chain-management-logistics?

IBM. *What is supply chain management?* https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/supply-chain-management

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Job Interview (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Job Interview challenges members to develop professional job application materials and demonstrate effective interviewing skills. This event includes pre-judged assets, along with a live interview to evaluate communication, poise, and readiness for the workplace.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Interview

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:	State/District:
Timing Structure: • **Presentation I**nterview: 10 minutes ○ *A one-minute warning will be provided* **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Not provided • **Prejudge Assets submission due by state set date** • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Job Interview (High School)

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Chair for Competitor

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
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- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, a preliminary presentation (interview), and a final presentation (interview).

Pre-judged Asset Details: Cover Letter & Resume

Submission Deadline

- A PDF of the cover letter and resume must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- The competitor must select a job position that they are currently qualified for or will be qualified for by the end of the school year. The chosen position may be part-time, an internship, or full-time.
- Cover Letter Specifics
  - Must be no longer than one page.
  - Address the letter to: Dr. Terry E. Johnson, Director of Human Resources, Merit Corporation, 1640 Franklin Place, Washington, DC 20041
  - *Note: Merit Corporation is a fictitious company*
- Resume Specifics
  - Must not exceed two pages in length.
  - Should include the competitor's education, activities, awards/honors, and work/volunteer experience.
  - Photographs are not permitted on the résumé.
- Assets must be formatted to fit standard 8.5" x 11" paper.
- Links and QR codes are not permitted.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the asset. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- *Note:* The assets do not need to follow the FBLA Production Test Reference Guide, formerly known as the FBLA Format Guide.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Preliminary Presentation Details: Interview

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 0 minutes
- **Presentation:** 10 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 0 minutes

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- No technology may be brought to the interview.

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Non-Technology Items

- No materials may be brought to the interview.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Final Presentation Details: Interview

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 0 minutes
- **Presentation:** 10 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 0 minutes

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The final round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- No technology may be brought to the interview.

Non-Technology Items

- No materials may be brought to the interview.
- Cover letters and résumés submitted by competitors will be provided to judges via the online rating sheet system.

Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score and preliminary presentation (interview) round scores will be added together to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation (interview) score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

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Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Job Interview (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Job Interview Pre-Judged Assets Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Cover Letter: States job applying for	*No job stated*	*Job stated does not match qualification*	*States job and shows match of job to qualifications*	*States job and shows match of job to qualifications with demonstrated experience*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Cover Letter: Promotes self in letter – lists skills, achievements, volunteerism experiences, etc.	*No self-promotion included*	*Describes skills and academic achievements, but no volunteerism/work experience included*	*Describes skills, academic achievements, and volunteerism/work experience*	*Describes multiple skills, academic achievements, and volunteerism/work experiences*	
	0 points	1-3 points	4-6 points	7-8 points	
Cover Letter: States that the resume is included with the letter and asks for interview	*No resume statement nor interview requested*	*States resume included but does not ask for interview*	*States resume is included and asks for interview*	*States resume is included, asks for interview, provides opportunity to request more information*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Resume: Targets job on cover letter	*No job targeted*	*Targeted job does not match cover letter*	*Targeted job matches cover letter*	*Resume supports targeted job on cover letter*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Resume: Reader friendly – categories can be found easily, white space utilized, professional fonts and font sizes	*Resume is unreadable*	*Resume design is distracting*	*Resume is reader friendly*	*Resume is professional in design for targeted job*	
	0 points	1-3 points	4-6 points	7-8 points	
Resume: Includes education, activities, awards/honors, and volunteerism/work experience information	*No education, activities, volunteerism, experience information listed*	*One-two sections included*	*Three sections included*	*Four or more sections support targeted job*	
	0 points	1-3 points	4-6 points	7-8 points	
Resume: Brief, concise information	*Resume is longer than two pages*	*Information provided, but in paragraph form*	*Sections are clearly identified with organized information*	*Clearly identified and organized information in each section supports targeted job*	
	0 points	1 point	2-3 points	4 points	
Spelling & Grammar: Documents are free of spelling, punctuation, and grammatical errors	*Three or more errors*	*Two errors*	*No spelling errors, and not more than 1 punctuation or grammatical error*	*No spelling or grammatical errors, and not more than 1 punctuation error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
All directions followed	*Cover letter longer than one page, not addressed correctly; Resume longer than two pages; photograph, link, or QR code included*		*Cover letter no more than one page, addressed correctly; Resume no more than two pages, no photograph, link, or QR code included; documents submitted as PDF*		
	0 points		5 points		
				Pre-judged Assets Total (50 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Job Interview (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Job Interview Presentation Interview Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Job Readiness & Qualifications *Selects a job aligned with current or near-future qualifications; demonstrates understanding of job duties and relevance to career goals.*	*No job is selected, or the job is unrelated to the competitor's skills, experience, or career interests.*	*Job is selected but only loosely aligns with the competitor's qualifications; limited understanding of job duties or career relevance is shown.*	*Job is appropriate based on current or anticipated qualifications; competitor shows a basic understanding of the role and its connection to career goals.*	*Job is thoughtfully selected and clearly aligned with current or near-future qualifications; competitor demonstrates strong understanding of job responsibilities and clearly connects the role to long-term career goals.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Interview Preparation & Research *Shows evidence of having researched the company or job and connects responses to that knowledge.*	*No evidence of research is presented; responses are generic and unrelated to the company or position.*	*Limited or superficial research is evident; minimal connection is made between responses and the company or role.*	*Research is apparent; responses include relevant information about the company or job and reflect a general understanding of the position.*	*Thorough research is clearly demonstrated; responses are tailored to the company and position, showing thoughtful insight and intentional preparation.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Response Quality & Critical Thinking *Answers questions thoughtfully and thoroughly, demonstrating problem-solving, decision-making, and self-awareness.*	*Responses are off-topic, incomplete, or show no evidence of critical thinking or self-awareness.*	*Responses are brief or vague, with limited explanation or reflection; minimal evidence of problem-solving or decision-making.*	*Responses are clear and mostly thorough, showing basic problem-solving and self-awareness with appropriate examples.*	*Responses are thoughtful, well-developed, and insightful; consistently demonstrate critical thinking, strong reasoning, and meaningful self-reflection.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presentation of Strengths & Experiences *Clearly articulates relevant skills, experiences, and accomplishments, providing specific examples when appropriate.*	*Does not mention any relevant skills, experiences, or accomplishments.*	*Mentions a few strengths or experiences, but lacks clarity or specific examples; connections to the job are unclear.*	*Clearly describes relevant skills and experiences, including at least one specific example to support qualifications for the position.*	*Articulates multiple strengths and accomplishments with strong, specific examples; clearly connects each to the job and demonstrates how they add value.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Career Goals & Motivation *Communicates short- and long-term career goals and enthusiasm for the position/industry.*	*Does not express any career goals or interest in the position or industry.*	*Career goals are vague or only short-term; limited enthusiasm or connection to the industry is shown.*	*Clearly communicates both short- and long-term goals with appropriate enthusiasm for the position or field.*	*Clearly articulates thoughtful short- and long-term goals, showing genuine passion for the position and industry; demonstrates a clear vision for the future and how the role aligns with it.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Demonstrates proper greeting, introduction, and closing	*Competitor does not use proper greeting, introduction, OR closing*	*Competitor greeting, introduction, OR closing was weak*	*Competitor has strong greeting, introduction, AND closing*	*Competitor is creative in their introduction of themselves and asks for or provides follow-up action in the conclusion*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Job Interview (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates proper verbal and nonverbal communication skills	*Verbal AND nonverbal communication skills are inappropriate*	*Verbal and/or nonverbal communication skills are weak or distracting*	*All questions were clearly answered using good grammar and appropriate body language*	*Verbal communication skills are excellent; nonverbal communication is natural*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *No technology used* ✓ *Did not bring materials to the interview* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (120 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Journalism

Future Business Leaders of America

Journalism challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of journalistic principles, media ethics, and the business of news through an objective test. This event encourages exploration of topics such as news writing, reporting, editing, and the evolving role of journalism in a digital economy.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

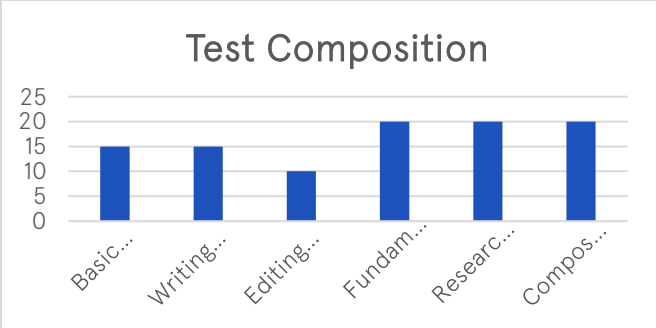
- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Basic Communication Skills
- Writing Skills
- Editing
- Fundamental Principles of Journalism
- Research and Investigation
- Compose News Stories



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Journalism

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Basic Communication Skills (15 test items)

1. Demonstrate active listening skills (CO:017, LAP-CO-017) (PQ)
2. Explain the nature of effective verbal communications (CO:147) (PQ)
3. Ask relevant questions (CO:058) (PQ)
4. Interpret others' nonverbal cues (CO:059) (PQ)
5. Employ communication styles appropriate to target audience (CO:084) (CS)
6. Utilize note-taking strategies (CO:085) (CS)
7. Organize information (CO:086) (CS)

Writing Skills (15 test items)

1. Demonstrate proper grammar
2. Explain the nature of syntax and sentence structure
3. Explain the nature of diction
4. Establish tone
5. Write an effective introduction and conclusion
6. Describe the process of structuring an argument in written form
7. Adapt writing for specific audiences

Editing (10 test items)

1. Monitor news stories as they move through the production chain
2. Review and proofread news stories
3. Apply formatting principles to news articles
4. Manage supporting materials for news stories (e.g., photos, infographics, videos)
5. Arrange and meet deadlines

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Fundamental Principles of Journalism (20 test items)

1. Discuss types of news media (e.g., print, digital, broadcast)
2. Describes types of news stories (e.g., news, features, editorials, columns, investigative reports)
3. Discuss the legal rights and responsibilities of journalists
4. Explain the nature of ethical standards in journalism
5. Explain the importance of accuracy in journalism
6. Explain the role of objectivity in journalism
7. Explain the role of confidentiality in journalism

Research and Investigation (20 test items)

1. Identify relevant issues in the community
2. Generate story ideas
3. Identify sources of information
4. Evaluate source credibility
5. Distinguish between primary and secondary sources
6. Discuss considerations in arranging an interview with a source
7. Discuss considerations in conducting an interview with a source

Compose News Stories (20 test items)

1. Determine the appropriate delivery platform for a story (e.g., article, video, audio, social media)
2. Compare and contrast different structures for news articles (e.g., inverted pyramid, hourglass, chronological, Q&A)
3. Adapt articles to meet organizational standards and style guides (e.g., tone, style, word count)
4. Apply quotes
5. Demonstrate appropriate attribution
6. Write compelling captions and headlines
7. Incorporate editor feedback

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Local Chapter Annual Business Report

Future Business Leaders of America

Local Chapter Annual Business Report gives chapter members the opportunity to document and present their Program of Work and accomplishments from the year. This event includes a pre-judged asset and a live presentation, highlighting the chapter's goals, activities, and overall impact.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Chapter
Event Elements	Pre-judged Asset and Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **PDF Prejudge Asset submission due by state set date**
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Local Chapter Annual Business Report

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of three phases: a pre-judged asset, preliminary presentation, and a final presentation.

Pre-judged Asset Details: Report

Submission Deadline

- A PDF of the report must be uploaded through the conference registration system by the state-specified deadline.

Asset Requirements:

- All content must be original and created specifically for this competition.
- QR codes and links are not allowed in the asset.
- Advisers or others may not assist in preparing the project. It must be created entirely by the competitor(s).
- Assets must be new, original work and may not have been submitted at any previous National Leadership Conference.

Judging & Ownership

- Assets will be judged prior to the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Pre-judged assets will not be returned. All submitted projects become the property of FBLA and may be published or reproduced for promotional purposes.

Event Specific Information

- **Number of Pages:** The report will be no more than seventeen (17) pages.
- Reports should follow the rating sheet sequence and be formatted to fit on 8 ½" x 11" paper.
- The first page (front cover) should include the name of school, state, and school year (2026-2027) on the cover.
- The second page must include a table of contents and each page must be numbered.
- Divider pages and appendices are optional and must be included in the page count.
- Reports must describe chapter activities conducted from the end of the 2026 State Leadership Conference to the end of the 2027 State Leadership Conference.
- Supporting materials related to chapter activities are clearly presented, relevant to the project, and displayed professionally.
- *Note:* The report does not need to follow the FBLA Production Test Reference Guide, formerly known as the FBLA Format Guide.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged asset, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in the presentation

- Presentations must describe chapter activities conducted from the end of the 2026 State Leadership Conference to the end of the 2027 State Leadership Conference.
- **Outline the Program of Work and Chapter Activities:** Explain the chapter's program of work and summarize the year's activities in a clear, chronological format. Connect each activity to chapter goals and objectives.
- **Describe Member-Focused Activities:** Highlight chapter efforts that support members in the areas mentioned in the rating sheet.
- **Describe Community and State/National Service:** Include service initiatives that benefit others, as mentioned in the rating sheet.
- **Summarize Conferences and Recognition**: Provide details about these areas listed in the rating sheet.

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Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Int Internet Access:** Not provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Pre-judged asset, visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

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- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in the presentation

- Presentations must describe chapter activities conducted from the end of the 2026 State Leadership Conference to the end of the 2027 State Leadership Conference.
- **Outline the Program of Work and Chapter Activities:** Explain the chapter's program of work and summarize the year's activities in a clear, chronological format. Connect each activity to chapter goals and objectives.
- **Describe Member-Focused Activities:** Highlight chapter efforts that support members in the areas mentioned in the rating sheet.
- **Describe Community and State/National Service:** Include service initiatives that benefit others, as mentioned in the rating sheet.
- **Summarize Conferences and Recognition**: Provide details about these areas listed in the rating sheet.

Scoring

- The pre-judged asset score will be added to the preliminary presentation round scores to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- The final presentation score determines the top winners.
- Pre-judged asset score will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final**.** Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.
- The Local Chapter Annual Business Report Award is named after Hamden L. Forkner. Dr. Forkner was a professor of education at the Teachers College at Columbia University, where he developed the concept of what would become the Future Business Leaders of America.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

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- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Local Chapter Annual Business Report

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Local Chapter Annual Business Report Pre-Judged Asset (Report) Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Include "State of the Chapter" remarks to current members by chapter president. Report on membership numbers and population size of school and community.	*No remarks or data on membership, school, or community population are included.*	*Remarks are vague or incomplete, and membership or population data are missing or unclear.*	*Includes a clear message from the chapter president and provides accurate membership, school, and community population data.*	*Include "State of the Chapter" remarks to current member by chapter president. Report on membership numbers and population size of school and community.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Program of Work	*Program of Work not included in report*	Program of Work is a calendar of activities/events	*Program of Work is a calendar with some objectives*	*Program of Work is an extensive document with alignment to specific chapter goals & objectives*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Report activities to benefit chapter and its members: • Recruitment • Leadership Development • Career Exploration & Preparation • Business Partnerships • Chapter Fundraising • Public Relations & Chapter Publicity	*No activities in the listed areas are described or included in the report.*	*Few activities are mentioned, with limited explanation or unclear connection to chapter/member benefit.*	*Includes relevant activities in most listed areas with clear descriptions of how they supported the chapter and its members.*	*Thoroughly details a wide range of well-executed activities in all areas, clearly demonstrating meaningful impact on chapter growth and member development.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describe activities to benefit other individuals and organizations: • State Projects & Programs • National Projects & Programs • Other community service projects	*No activities benefiting others or outside organizations are described in the report.*	*Mentions a few activities with minimal detail or unclear connection to state, national, or community service efforts.*	*Describes relevant activities supporting state, national, and community service initiatives, with clear explanation of purpose and outcomes.*	*Provides detailed, well-organized descriptions of impactful activities across all categories, highlighting meaningful service, collaboration, and results beyond the chapter.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Include conferences attended and recognition received: • Participation in FBLA conferences • Other chapter and individual recognitions earned • Competitive event winners and participation	*No conferences, recognitions, or competitive event participation are mentioned.*	*Includes limited or unclear details about conference attendance or recognition, with minimal connection to chapter involvement.*	*Clearly outlines conference participation, recognitions earned, and competitive event results with appropriate detail.*	*Provides a comprehensive and well-organized summary of conference involvement, awards, and competitive successes, demonstrating strong chapter engagement and achievement.*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Report Format					
Formatted and designed as business report **Note: does not need to follow Production Test Reference Guide**	*Does not format document*	*Inconsistent formatting, excessive white space, and/or unrelated graphics and/or photos*	*Consistent formatting throughout the report*	*Utilizes full bleed, effective use of space, related defined graphics, and consistent formatting*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Local Chapter Annual Business Report

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Chapter activity documentation included accurately and professionally displayed.	*No documentation included*	*Documentation included, but not professionally displayed*	*Documentation included*	*Documentation included and enhance the written report*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Include correct grammar, punctuation, and spelling	*5 or more grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*3-4 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No more than 2 grammar, punctuation, or spelling errors*	*No more than 1 grammar, punctuation, or spelling error*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Guideline Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Report was submitted as PDF* ✓ *Links or QR codes were not used (unless in citations)* ✓ *Report was 17 pages or under* ✓ *Report followed the sequence of the rating sheet & formatted for 8 ½" x 11" paper* ✓ *Cover Page with all criteria listed, table of contents included, all pages are numbered*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Pre-judged Asset Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Local Chapter Annual Business Report

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Local Chapter Annual Business Report Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Describe chapter's program of work and summary of year's activities	*No evidence of chapter's program of work and summary of year's activities presented*	*Chapter's program of work and summary of year's activities explained briefly*	*Chapter's program of work and summary of year's activities clearly outlined*	*Chapter's program of work and summary of year's activities clearly outlined. Activities are chronological, related to chapter goals/objectives and clearly explained*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Describe activities to benefit chapter and its members: • **Recruitment** • **Leadership Development** • **Career Exploration & Preparation** • **Business Partnerships** • **Chapter Fundraising** • **Public Relations & Chapter Publicity**	*No evidence of activities*	*There is at least one activity described in two of the components listed*	*There is at least one activity described in four of the components listed*	*There is at least one activity described in all components listed*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Describe activities to benefit other individuals and organizations: • **State Projects & Programs** • **National Projects & Programs** • **Other community service projects**	*No evidence of activities*	*There is at least one activity described in one of the components listed*	*There is at least one activity described in each component listed*	*Multiple activities are described in all components listed*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Describe conferences attended and recognition received: • **Participation in FBLA conferences** • **Other chapter and individual recognition earned** • **Competitive event winners and participation**	*No evidence of activities*	*There is at least one activity described in one of the components listed*	*There is at least one activity described in each component listed*	*Multiple activities are described in all components listed*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Local Chapter Annual Business Report

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)			
Presentation Total (110 points)			

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Management Information Systems

Future Business Leaders of America

Management Information Systems challenges members to apply their knowledge of how businesses use technology to manage information and support decision-making. Through an objective test and a role play scenario, members analyze a small business's environment and recommend effective information system solutions.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

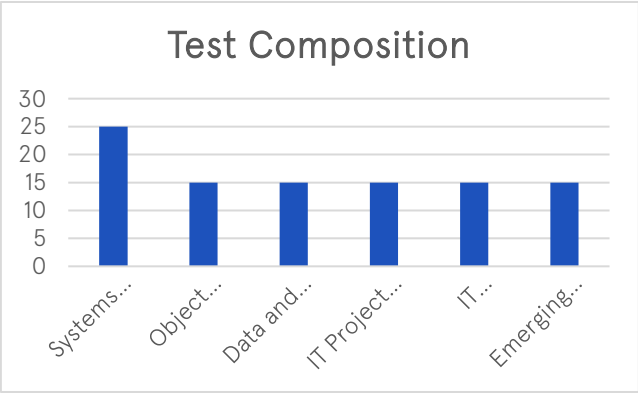
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Systems Design and Analysis
- Object Oriented Programming Concepts
- Data and Information Management
- IT Project Management
- IT Infrastructure
- Emerging Business Technologies

Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Management Information Systems

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario • Flip chart paper/markers • Easel for placement of flipchart during presentation

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
    - One individual or team event, and

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    - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

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Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a management information system–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials

- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges

- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience

- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring

- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

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Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Systems Design and Analysis (25 test items)

1. Describe typical phases of the Systems Development Life Cycle
2. Discuss methods for gathering and analyzing system requirements
3. Discuss the Agile methodology for software and project management
4. Discuss the Waterfall model of software and project management
5. Determine appropriate features for a new system based on gathered requirements
6. Describe the use of feasibility studies for financial, technical, and organizational analysis
7. Describe terms related to system design (e.g., input, output, controls, procedures)
8. Distinguish between validation and verification of a system
9. Describe the roles of stakeholders, end users, managers, and developers in system development
10. Discuss workflow artifacts used in system design and analysis (e.g., dataflow diagrams, entity relationship diagrams, class diagrams)

Object Oriented Programming Concepts (15 test items)

1. Describe features of object-oriented programming (OOP) languages (e.g., classes, objects, libraries)
2. Explain how business requirements can be translated into classes and functions
3. Describe key features of object-oriented programming (e.g., encapsulation, abstraction, polymorphism, inheritance)
4. Discuss the use and creation of libraries for software development
5. Distinguish between classes, objects, methods, and attributes
6. Identify modern OOP languages and frameworks
7. Analyze the benefits and drawbacks of OOP

Data and Information Management (15 test items)

1. Translate simple user stories and requirements into SQL statements
2. Describe terms related to relational database structure (e.g., relations, tuples, fields, records, keys)
3. Evaluate database schemas based on business requirements
4. Describe the importance of data redundancy
5. Describe best practices for data security and integrity (e.g., encryption, access control)
6. Describe NoSQL databases
7. Discuss the pros and cons of data storage methods (e.g., local, cloud, hybrid)
8. Discuss the use of structured, unstructured, and semi-structured data for business intelligence and decision making
9. Describe the use of Online Analytical Processing (OLAP)

IT Project Management (15 test items)

1. Describe the use of Agile principles in information systems development
2. Describe the processes of Scrum methodology for managing information systems projects
3. Describe the use of Waterfall methodology in information systems development
4. Discuss Agile methodology tenants (e.g., individuals and interactions, working software)
5. Select an appropriate methodology for a software or IT project

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6. Discuss the consequences of poor IT project management on budget, schedule, and performance (e.g., runaway projects)
7. Discuss the steps of the project life cycle
8. Describe the use of work products and tools for project management (e.g., kanban boards, user stories, spreadsheets)
9. Discuss the roles of end users and stakeholders in IT project development

IT Infrastructure (15 test items)

1. Describe the importance of IT infrastructure to business processes
2. Describe components of IT infrastructure (e.g., hardware, software, network components)
3. Describe how cloud and virtual components contribute to IT infrastructure
4. Discuss the business value of secure IT infrastructure
5. Describe the benefits of cloud-based architecture for businesses
6. Discuss the performance and cost tradeoffs of network topologies (e.g., mesh, star, bus)
7. Identify layers of the OSI and TCP/IP model
8. Describe services that contribute to business IT infrastructure (e.g., computing platforms, telecommunications services, data management services)
9. Discuss how to avoid common IT security vulnerabilities (e.g., authentication, authorization, access control)

Emerging Business Technologies (15 test items)

1. Discuss the effects of automation on businesses
2. Discuss the uses of artificial intelligence for businesses (e.g., customer support, automation, data insights)
3. Explain core characteristics of blockchain technology
4. Discuss the uses of blockchain for data security and integrity
5. Describe the Internet of Things (IoT)
6. Describe the characteristics of the cloud
7. Identify cloud-based applications and services (e.g., SaaS, IaaS, AWS, Canva)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

Association for Computing Machinery. *IS2020 A Competency Model for Undergraduate Programs in Information Systems*. https://www.acm.org/binaries/content/assets/education/curricula-recommendations/is2020.pdf

Coursera. *What is MIS (Management Information Systems)? Degree Guide*. https://www.coursera.org/articles/mis

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Management Information Systems

Future Business Leaders of America

Management Information Systems Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Systems Design and Analysis / Object Oriented Programming Concepts / Data and Information Management / IT Project Management / IT Infrastructure / Emerging Business Technologies*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Marketing

Future Business Leaders of America

Marketing challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of marketing concepts and strategies through an objective test and a role play scenario. Members apply their knowledge in areas such as market research, branding, promotion, and customer engagement to solve real-world business challenges.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Testing: 50-minute testing period

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

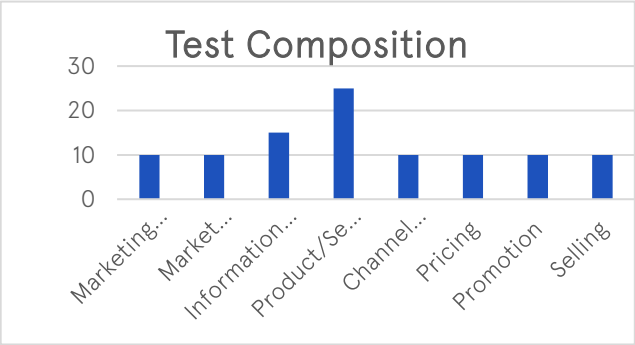
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Marketing Fundamentals
- Market Planning
- Marketing-Information Management
- Product/Service Management
- Channel Management
- Pricing
- Promotion
- Selling



Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.`

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Marketing

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a marketing–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)
- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Marketing Fundamentals (10 test items)

1. Explain marketing and its importance in a global economy (MK:001, LAP-MK-901) (CS)
2. Explain the need for professional and ethical standards in marketing (PD:137) (SP)
3. Discuss actions employees can take to achieve the company's desired results (MK:015, LAP-MK-015) (SP)
4. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior (MK:014, LAP-MK-014) (SP)
5. Describe connections between company actions and results (e.g., influencing consumer buying behavior, gaining market share, etc.) (MK:019, LAP-MK-019) (SP)

Market Planning (10 test items)

1. Explain the concept of marketing strategies (MP:001, LAP-MP-001) (CS)
2. Explain the concept of market and market identification (MP:003, LAP-MP-003) (CS)
3. Explain the nature of marketing planning (MP:006) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of marketing plans (MP:007, LAP-MP-007) (SP)
5. Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process (MP:008) (SP)

Marketing-Information Management (15 test items)

1. Identify data monitored for marketing decision making (IM:184, LAP-IM-184) (SP)
2. Explain the nature and scope of the marketing-information management function (IM:001, LAP-IM-001) (SP)
3. Explain the role of ethics in marketing-information management (IM:025, LAP-IM-025) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of marketing research (IM:010, LAP-IM-010) (SP)
5. Describe options businesses use to obtain marketing research data (i.e., primary and secondary research) (IM:281, LAP-IM-281) (SP)
6. Describe data-collection methods (e.g., observations, mail, diaries, phone, internet, discussion groups, interviews, scanners, tracking tools) (IM:289, LAP-IM-289) (SP)

Product/Service Management (25 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of the product/service management function (PM:001, LAP-PM-001) (SP)
2. Explain business ethics in product/service management (PM:040, LAP-PM-040) (SP)
3. Identify the impact of product life cycles on marketing decisions (PM:024, LAP-PM-024) (SP)
4. Identify consumer protection provisions of appropriate agencies (PM:017, LAP-PM-917) (SP)
5. Explain the concept of the product mix (PM:003, LAP-PM-003) (SP)
6. Describe the nature of product bundling (PM:041) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of corporate branding (PM:206, LAP-PM-206) (SP)
8. Describe factors used by businesses to position corporate brands (PM:207) (SP)
9. Describe factors used by marketers to position products/services (PM:042, LAP-PM-042) (SP)
10. Explain the nature of product/service branding (PM:021, LAP-PM-021) (SP)

Channel Management (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of channel management (CM:001, LAP-CM-001) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of channels of distribution (CM:003, LAP-CM-003) (CS)
3. Describe ethical considerations in channel management (CM:006, LAP-CM-006) (SP)

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Pricing (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of the pricing function (PI:001, LAP-PI-001) (SP)
2. Describe the role of business ethics in pricing (PI:015, LAP-PI-015) (SP)
3. Explain factors affecting pricing decisions (PI:002, LAP-PI-902) (SP)

Promotion (10 test items)

1. Explain the role of promotion as a marketing function (PR:001, LAP-PR-901) (CS)
2. Identify the elements of the promotional mix (PR:003, LAP-PR-903) (SP)
3. Describe the use of business ethics in promotion (PR:099, LAP-PR-099) (SP)
4. Explain types of advertising media (PR:007, LAP-PR-007) (SP)

Selling (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature and scope of the selling function (SE:017, LAP-SE-017) (CS)
2. Explain legal and ethical considerations in selling (SE:106, LAP-SE-106) (SP)
3. Describe the use of technology in the selling function (SE:107) (SP)
4. Acquire product information for use in selling (SE:062, LAP-SE-062) (CS)
5. Analyze product information to identify product features and benefits (SE:109, LAP-SE-109) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

American Marketing Association. *Definitions of marketing*. https://www.ama.org/the-definition-of-marketing-what-is-marketing/

HubSpot. *What is marketing, and what's its purpose?* https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/what-is-marketing

Investopedia. *Understanding marketing in business: Key strategies and types*. https://www.investopedia.com/terms/m/marketing.asp

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Marketing

Marketing Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Marketing Fundamentals / Market Planning / Marketing-Information Management / Product/Service Management / Channel Management / Pricing / Promotion / Selling*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (100 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Mobile Application Development

Future Business Leaders of America

Mobile Application Development allows members to design and develop a functional mobile app based on a given topic. Members present their app to a panel of judges, demonstrating creativity, user interface design, and technical problem-solving in a mobile platform environment.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Together We Go: Group Trip Planner

Planning a trip with family or friends often involves coordinating schedules, activities, budgets, and important information. Develop a mobile application that helps groups organize and manage a shared trip from planning through completion.

Your application should provide functionality that supports collaboration, communication, scheduling, budgeting, organization, and trip management for multiple users. Competitors should determine the specific features and user experience that best address the needs of travelers.

How can your application make planning and enjoying a group trip easier, more organized, and more collaborative?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Mobile Application Development

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.

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- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Presentation should cover the following aspects of the application

- The platform used to develop the application. The following platforms may be used to develop the project: Google's Android, Apple iOS, or Microsoft Windows Phone.
- The solution must run standalone with no programming errors.
- Applications may deploy from a smartphone, tablet, or both, but must be smartphone deployable.
- Applications do not need to be available for download from a digital-distribution multimedia-content service.
- The usability and functionality of the program must be demonstrated to the judges.
- Competitors must show the judges any of the following that are applicable: read me file, source code, documentation of templates/libraries used, documentation of copyright and sources of materials used.
- The presentation should follow the rating sheet and include the following:
  - Design and Code Quality: Explain the design and implementation of the application.
  - User Experience: Map the user journey and explain your UX design rationale. What focus is on the ease-of-use and accessibility of the interface?
  - Application Functionality: Social media integrations

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Presentation should cover the following aspects of the application

- The platform used to develop the application. The following platforms may be used to develop the project: Google's Android, Apple iOS, or Microsoft Windows Phone.
- The solution must run standalone with no programming errors.
- Applications may deploy from a smartphone, tablet, or both, but must be smartphone deployable.
- Applications do not need to be available for download from a digital-distribution multimedia-content service.
- The usability and functionality of the program must be demonstrated to the judges.
- Competitors must show the judges any of the following that are applicable: read me file, source code, documentation of templates/libraries used, documentation of copyright and sources of materials used.
- The presentation should follow the rating sheet and include the following:
  - Design and Code Quality: Explain the design and implementation of the application.
  - User Experience: Map the user journey and explain your UX design rationale. What focus is on the ease-of-use and accessibility of the interface?
  - Application Functionality: Social media integrations

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Mobile Application Development

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Mobile Application Development Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Design and Code Quality					
Planning Process	*No explanation or description of the planning process*	*Explains the process but does not share tangible planning documents*	*Explains the process and shares tangible planning documents*	*Explains process using industry terminology and displays tangible planning documents*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Appropriate use of classes, modules, and/or components	*No use of classes, modules, or components*	*Use of classes, modules, and/or components*	*Appropriate use of classes, modules, and/or components*	*Expert use of classes, modules, and/or components*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Appropriate use of mobile app architectural patterns	*No use of architectural patterns*	*Unclear use of architectural patterns*	*Appropriate use of architectural patterns*	*Expert use of architectural patterns*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Innovation and Creativity	*No innovation or creativity is demonstrated*	*Very little innovation or creativity is demonstrated*	*App is innovative or creative*	*App is innovative and creative*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
User Experience					
UX Design: User Journey, Design Rationale, Accessibility Features	*No UX design presented*	*Some elements of UX design are presented*	*UX design presented, with details missing*	*UX design presented, with details about the design rationale, user journey, and accessibility features highlighted*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
User interface is intuitive or clear instructions are provided	*No instructions provided and is not intuitive*	*Instructions provided or app is not intuitive*	*Appropriate & clear instructions are provided*	*App is intuitive and clear instructions are provided*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Icons/graphical elements are appropriate and consistent	*App does not have a custom icon or graphics*	*App has a basic custom icon and graphics*	*App has an icon that tells something about the app*	*App has an icon that tells something about the app and is integrated into app graphics*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
User input is validated	*User input isn't validated*	*User input is somewhat validated*	*User input is validated*	*Input validation applied on both syntactical and semantic levels*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Application Functionality					
Program addresses all parts of the prompt	*Application does not address the topic/problem*	*Application addresses the topic/problem at a minimal level*	*Application fully addresses the topic/problem*	*Application fully addresses the topic/problem, and the correlation is explained in the instructions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Integrated with social media	*Social media is not incorporated*	*One social media platform is incorporated*	*Two or more social media platforms are incorporated*	*App is integrated to work directly with at least one social media application*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Mobile Application Development

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Data Handling and Storage	*No consideration of data handling and storage practices*	*Minimal consideration of data handling and storage practices with basic implementation*	*Adequate data handling and storage practices implemented with attention to data integrity and security*	*Comprehensive and secure data handling and storage practices implemented, ensuring data integrity, accessibility, and protection*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Documentation and copyright compliance	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of three)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Network Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Network Design challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of networking concepts and infrastructure through an objective test and a role play scenario. Members apply their knowledge to design, implement, and troubleshoot network solutions that meet the needs of a business or organization.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

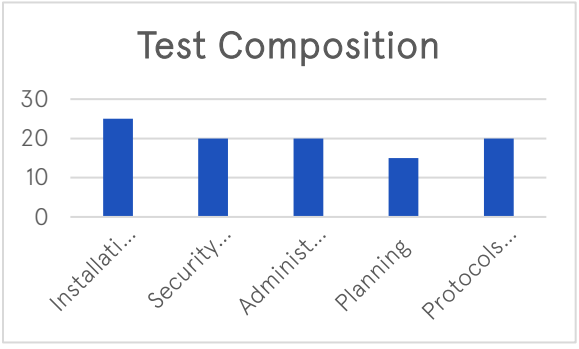
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Network Installation and Configuration
- Network Security and Recovery
- Network Administration
- Network Planning
- Network Protocols, Services, and Access

Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Network Design

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario • Flip chart paper/markers • Easel for placement of flipchart during presentation

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
    - One individual or team event, and
    - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

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Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a network design–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials

- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges

- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience

- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring

- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Network Installation and Configuration (25 test items)

1. Discuss the functions of routers and modems in home and office networks
2. Describe the features of a SOHO router
3. Discuss configuration of software and hardware firewalls (e.g., rules, ACLs)
4. Describe the range, speed, and requirements for fiber optic cable
5. Describe the characteristics of copper cable
6. Explain IEEE 802 wireless standards
7. Describe the purpose of subnetting, subnet masks, and loopback addresses
8. Describe wireless network configuration (e.g., modem, router, network password)
9. Discuss server installation and configuration in rack and blade infrastructures
10. Discuss the impact of power and temperature on physical network infrastructures (e.g., cooling, uninterruptible power supply)
11. Describe configuration options for printing over a network (e.g., printer share, printer connectivity, print servers)
12. Describe the functions of access points and gateways

Network Security and Recovery (20 test items)

1. Describe the purpose of disaster recovery plans
2. Select plans for disaster recovery and prevention
3. Describe network backup solutions (e.g., cloud storage, NAS, external hard drives)
4. Describe defensive measures against DoS, phishing, and internal threats (e.g., least privilege, third-party service, security policy)
5. Describe methods for mitigating network vulnerabilities (e.g., closing ports, updating OS, maintaining antivirus)
6. Discuss best practices for network security (e.g., least privilege, authentication, encryption)
7. Describe the benefits of Zero Trust principles
8. Explain methods of network access control
9. Describe security features of Windows and Linux-based operating systems (e.g., BitLocker, domains, SELinux)
10. Describe the use of Intrusion Detection/Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS)
11. Discuss wireless security standards (e.g., WPA, access control lists)

Network Administration (20 test items)

1. Discuss the need for network maintenance (e.g., audits, updates, backups, restores)
2. Describe user account and permission management
3. Explain the purpose and use of Simple Network Management Protocol (SNMP)
4. Discuss common network issues (e.g. slow performance, connection issues, IP conflicts)
5. Use common network command-line tools (e.g., ping, tracert, ipconfig)
6. Discuss the importance of updates and patch management
7. Discuss the role of documentation in network maintenance and troubleshooting
8. Describe tools for monitoring network traffic and performance
9. Describe the use and benefits of load balancing
10. Describe procedures for managing network assets (e.g., users, groups, and printers)

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Network Planning (15 test items)

1. Match business requirements to appropriate network design decisions (e.g., topology, physical size, users)
2. Discuss hardware and performance differences between network types (e.g., LAN, WAN)
3. Describe the physical layouts of network topologies (e.g., star, mesh, bus)
4. Discuss the use cases of network topologies (e.g., star, mesh, bus)
5. Select an appropriate network operating system (Windows Server, Linux-based, etc.)
6. Describe the benefits and risks of a peer-to-peer network
7. Discuss the benefits of cloud services for network infrastructure
8. Describe how business needs can restrict and drive network design decisions (e.g., cost, throughput, availability)
9. Explain how network topology decisions impact performance, cost, and availability

Network Protocols, Services, and Access (20 test items)

1. Describe different types of networks (e.g., LAN, WAN)
2. Describe basic network security practices (e.g., encryption, VPN, packet sniffing, authentication)
3. Describe common network attacks (e.g., phishing, spoofing, poisoning)
4. Describe different connectivity technologies (e.g., Ethernet, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth)
5. Discuss the functions of common network devices (e.g., modems, routers, switches)
6. Discuss types of network environments (e.g., peer-to-peer, client-server, thin client)
7. Explain relationships between major network components (e.g., servers, clients, switches)
8. Describe each layer of the Open System Interconnection (OSI) model
9. Explain basic networking protocols (e.g., TCP/IP, UDP, DHCP, SMP)
10. Discuss the characteristics of network topologies (e.g., star, bus, ring)
11. Describe tools and procedures for troubleshooting networks (e.g., ping, tracert, checking cable connections)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

Cisco. *Designing Cisco Enterprise Networks (ENSLD) v1.1*. https://learningcontent.cisco.com/documents/marketing/exam-topics/300-420-ENSLD-v1.1.pdf

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 1 Objectives*. https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1101-exam-objectives-(3-0)

CompTIA. *CompTIA Network+ Certification Exam Objectives*. https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-network-n10-009-exam-objectives-(4-0)

Cisco. *What is network design?* https://www.cisco.com/site/us/en/learn/topics/networking/what-is-network-design.html

IBM. *What is network infrastructure?* https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/network-infrastructure

Microsoft. *Fundamentals of computer networking.* https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/modules/network-fundamentals/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Network Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Network Design Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Network Installation and Configuration / Network Security and Recovery / Network Administration / Network Planning / Network Protocols, Services, and Access*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Delivery Skills					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (100 points)					

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Networking Infrastructures

Future Business Leaders of America

Networking Infrastructures challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of network administration and infrastructure through an objective test. This event covers topics such as network design, protocols, hardware, and security, highlighting the importance of reliable connectivity in today's digital workplace.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

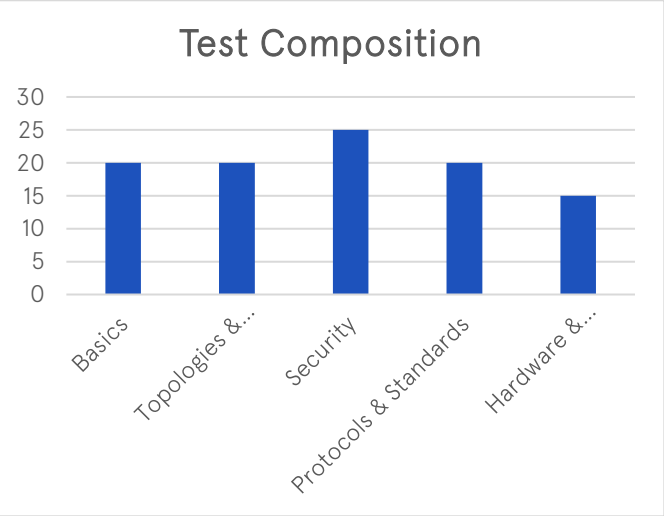
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Networking Basics
- Network Topologies and Architecture
- Network Security
- Network Protocols and Standards
- Network Hardware and Connectivity

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Networking Infrastructures

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

Networking Basics (20 test items)

1. Discuss characteristics and types of LANs (e.g., SOHO, enterprise, datacenter)
2. Discuss the functions of the physical and data link layers of the OSI model
3. Discuss the functions of the network and transport layers of the OSI model
4. Discuss the functions of the session, presentation, and application layers of the OSI model
5. Explain how data travels across networks (e.g., packets, routers, switches)
6. Describe how devices receive an internet connection (e.g., ISP, equipment, cabling)
7. Describe the purpose of IP addresses, MAC addresses, and subnetting
8. Discuss differences between IPv4 and IPv6
9. Identify IPv4 address classes

Network Topologies and Architecture (20 test items)

1. Give examples of peer-to-peer and client-server networks
2. Discuss the characteristics of different types of networks (e.g., LAN, MAN, WAN)
3. Recommend network topologies according to business requirements (e.g., bus, mesh, star)
4. Explain characteristics of network topologies (e.g., star, bus, ring, mesh)
5. Discuss wireless connectivity options for small and large-scale networks
6. Explain use cases for Infrastructure, Platform, and Software as a Service (IaaS, PaaS, and SaaS)
7. Discuss benefits, costs, and risks associated with cloud architectures
8. Explain factors that affect range, speed, and reliability of wireless connections
9. Describe characteristics of 5G networks

Network Security (25 test items)

1. Explain the differences between risks, vulnerabilities, exploits, and threats
2. Identify internal and external sources of risk and vulnerabilities (e.g., zero day, employees, outdated software)
3. Describe basic forms of network security (e.g., user management, permissions, encryption, authentication)
4. Discuss malware protection measures (e.g., antivirus, filtering, patch management)
5. Describe characteristics of DoS attacks and forms they can take (e.g., botnets, overload, DDoS)
6. Describe common network attacks (e.g., phishing, spoofing, poisoning)
7. Describe confidentiality, integrity, and availability
8. Describe vulnerability mitigations (e.g., closing ports, updating software, antivirus)
9. Explain the importance of hashing, digital signatures, and certificates in network security
10. Describe characteristics of authentication methods (e.g., MFA, SSO, remote authentication)

Network Protocols and Standards (20 test items)

1. Explain common transfer protocols (e.g., FTP, SFTP, SMTP)
2. Explain the relationship between DNS, DHCP, and IP addresses
3. Describe 802.11 wireless standards (e.g., range, speed, frequency)
4. Describe characteristics of 802.3 wired standards (e.g., range, speed, frequency)

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5. Characterize TCP and UDP
6. Describe dynamic routing protocols (e.g., BGP, EIGRP, OSPF)
7. Identify well-known ports reserved for specific protocols (e.g., port 22 reserved for SFTP and SSH)
8. Describe the use of network address translation (NAT) by networked devices
9. Describe wireless encryption standards (e.g., WPA2, WPA3)

Network Hardware and Connectivity (15 test items)

1. Discuss the functions of common network devices (e.g., modems, routers, switches)
2. Discuss the function and characteristics of network adapters (e.g., NIC, virtual adapters, PCIe adapters)
3. Describe Ethernet cable types (e.g., STP, UTP, coaxial)
4. Describe fiber optic cable types and connectors
5. Analyze the benefits of rack and blade server infrastructures
6. Describe the equipment needed to connect to the internet
7. Discuss the use of NAS and RAID hard drive configurations

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Organizational Leadership

Future Business Leaders of America

Organizational Leadership challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of leadership principles within a business context through an objective test. This event explores topics such as leadership styles, team management, motivation, and ethical decision-making, preparing members to lead effectively in organizational settings.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

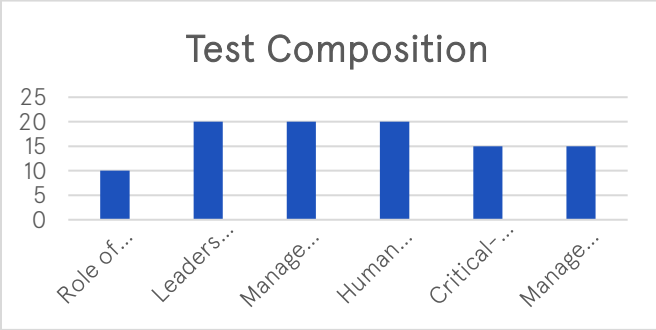
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Role of Management in Business
- Leadership
- Manage Business Relationships
- Human Resources Management
- Critical-Thinking Skills
- Manage Stressful Situations



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Organizational Leadership

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

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Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Organizational Leadership

Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Role of Management in Business (10 test items)

1. Explain the concept of management (SM:001, LAP-SM-001) (CS)
2. Explain factors that affect management (SM:100) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of managerial planning (SM:063) (SP)
4. Explain managerial considerations in organizing (SM:064, LAP-SM-064) (SP)

Leadership (20 test items)

1. Explain the concept of leadership (EI:009, LAP-EI-909) (CS)
2. Explain the nature of ethical leadership (EI:131, LAP-EI-131) (CS)
3. Demonstrate adaptability (EI:006, LAP-EI-006) (CS)
4. Lead change (EI:005, LAP-EI-005) (CS)
5. Use power appropriately (EI:135, LAP-EI-135) (SP)

Manage Business Relationships (20 test items)

1. Foster positive working relationships (EI:037, LAP-EI-037) (CS)
2. Consider conflicting viewpoints (EI:136, LAP-EI-136) (CS)
3. Assess long-term value and impact of actions on others (EI:137, LAP-EI-137) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of organizational culture (EI:064, LAP-EI-064) (SP)
5. Interpret and adapt to a business's culture (EI:112) (SP)

Human Resources Management (20 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
2. Select and hire new employees (HR:356) (SU)
3. Explain the nature of leadership in organizations (HR:493, LAP-HR-493) (SU)
4. Supervise staff (HR:393) (SU)
5. Assess employee performance (HR:368) (SU)
6. Harmonize tasks, projects, and employees in the context of business priorities (HR:389) (SU)

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Critical-Thinking Skills (15 test items)

1. Explain the need for innovation skills (PD:126, LAP-PD-126) (CS)
2. Make decisions (PD:017, LAP-PD-017) (CS)
3. Demonstrate problem-solving skills (PD:077, LAP-PD-077) (CS)
4. Demonstrate appropriate creativity (PD:012, LAP-PD-012) (SP)
5. Use time-management skills (PD:019, LAP-PD-019) (SP)

Manage Stressful Situations (15 test items)

1. Use appropriate assertiveness (EI:008, LAP-EI-008) (PQ)
2. Use conflict-resolution skills (EI:015, LAP-EI-915) (CS)
3. Explain the nature of office politics (EI:109) (CS)
4. Interpret and adapt to a business's culture (EI:112) (SP)
5. Explain the nature of stress management (EI:028, LAP-EI-028) (SP)
6. Manage crises in relationships (EI:110) (SU)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Parliamentary Procedure (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Parliamentary Procedure allows members to demonstrate their understanding of the principles and practices used to conduct orderly and efficient meetings. This event includes an objective test and a role play scenario, where members apply parliamentary law through simulated meeting activities.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 4 or 5 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 Minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation: 10** minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

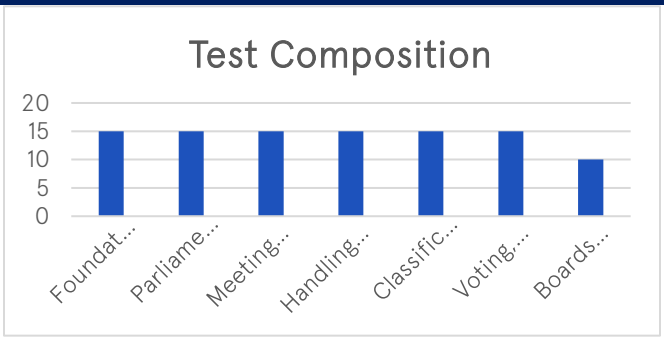
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Foundations of Parliamentary Procedure
- Parliamentary Terminology
- Meeting Structure and Order of Business
- Handling Motions and Rules of Debate
- Classification of Motions
- Voting, Elections, and Nominations
- Boards and Committees



The objective test and role play criteria for this event will be based on *Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised, 12th edition.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Parliamentary Procedure (High School)

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Reference materials • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Gavel and sounding block	• Pencils for prep and presentation room • Two notecards per competitor • Secret role play problem/scenario • Paper for secretary's notes • Table Tents for Presentation room (President, Secretary, Treasurer)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.

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- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and a role play of a chapter meeting.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

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Role Play Details: The Meeting

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 10 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a parliamentary procedure–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members.
- The role play scenario will simulate a regular chapter meeting and will be distributed to competitors at the start of their assigned preparation time.
- Competitors may use parliamentary procedure reference materials during the preparation period only. No scripts may be brought into or created in the preparation room.

Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials

- The following items may be brought into both the prep and presentation rooms:
  - One gavel/sounding block
  - A printed copy of the role play
  - A treasurer's report (created prior to competition)
  - Minutes from a previous meeting (created prior to competition)
  - **Note:** The secretary may take notes during the meeting but will not transcribe them into formal minutes.
- No additional technology, reference materials, visuals, or props beyond the two notecards may be used during the presentation.

Presentation Expectations

- The presentation must simulate a complete regular chapter meeting, beginning with a Call to Order and ending with Adjournment.
- Required business items from the role play must be addressed in the proper order of business. Additional meeting business should also be conducted.
- The presentation must demonstrate the use of all five classes of motions if listed in the role play: Main, Subsidiary, Privileged, Incidental, Motions that bring a question again before the assembly

Audience

- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring

- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.

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- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.
- The Parliamentary Procedure award is named after Dorothy L. Travis. Dorothy was one of the founders of North Dakota FBLA and was appointed as the first State Chairperson in 1967.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

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Foundations of Parliamentary Procedure (15 test items)

1. Explain the nature and purpose of parliamentary procedure
2. Identify the official parliamentary authority (Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised)
3. Discuss the fundamental principles of parliamentary law (e.g., rights of the majority and minority)
4. Describe the concept of "one thing at a time"
5. Identify the basic rights of an individual member
6. Describe the hierarchy of governing documents (e.g., Corporate Charter, Bylaws, Rules of Order)
7. Explain the legal implications of parliamentary law for various types of assemblies

Parliamentary Terminology (15 test items)

1. Define common parliamentary terms (e.g., floor, chair, quorum, pending)
2. Explain the concept of immediately pending motions
3. Define the different types of meetings (e.g., regular, special)
4. Identify the differences between a plurality and a majority vote
5. Define the roles of "pro tem" and "ex officio" positions
6. Differentiate between "previous notice" and "notice of a motion"
7. Describe "executive session" and the requirements for maintaining its confidentiality

Meeting Structure and Order of Business (15 test items)

1. Describe the components of a standard order of business
2. Explain the purpose and basic contents of meeting minutes
3. Describe the process for opening and closing a meeting
4. Explain the primary duties of the presiding officer
5. Describe the basic record-keeping role of the secretary
6. Explain the formal process for approving and correcting minutes
7. Discuss the handling and reception of officer reports

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Handling Motions and Rules of Debate (15 test items)

1. List the six steps in handling a main motion from introduction to announcement of the result
2. Explain the process for seeking recognition from the chair
3. Describe the requirement and process for seconding a motion
4. Discuss the basic rules and time limits for debate
5. Explain the process the chair uses for stating the question
6. Describe the standards of decorum required for members during debate
7. Describe the motions used to manage, limit, or close debate

Classification of Motions (15 test items)

1. Identify the four basic classes of motions
2. Describe the purpose of common Subsidiary motions (e.g., Postpone, Amend)
3. Describe the purpose of common Privileged motions (e.g., Adjourn, Recess)
4. Explain the purpose of basic Incidental motions (e.g., Point of Order)
5. Distinguish between debatable and non-debatable motions
6. Apply the order of precedence for all 13 ranking motions
7. Identify specific characteristics for each ranking motion (e.g., amendability, vote required)
8. Explain motions that bring a question again before the assembly (e.g., Reconsider, Rescind)

Voting, Elections, and Nominations (15 test items)

1. Identify common methods of voting (e.g., voice, rising, show of hands)
2. Explain the use and purpose of a ballot vote
3. Define the requirements for a two-thirds vote
4. Describe the process for basic nominations from the floor
5. Explain the chair's responsibility and rights in the voting process
6. Describe the process and requirements for a Division of the Assembly
7. Explain the formal procedures for conducting an election for officers

Boards and Committees (10 test items)

1. Distinguish between the roles of standing committees and special (ad hoc) committees
2. Explain the process of referring a main motion to a committee
3. Describe the procedures for presenting committee reports and recommendations
4. Explain the relationship between a board of directors and the general assembly
5. Discuss the specific duties of the vice president and treasurer

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References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Michigan State University. *Parliamentary procedure resource*. https://spartanexperiences.msu.edu/government/parliamentary-procedure-resource.html

MRSC. *Parliamentary procedure: A brief guide to Robert's Rules of Order*. https://mrsc.org/explore-topics/public-meetings/procedures/parliamentary-procedure

NACD. *Pocket guide to parliamentary procedure*. https://www.nacdnet.org/parliamentary-procedure/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Parliamentary Procedure (High School)

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

Parliamentary Procedure Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Completed	Completed	Completed & Correct	Points Earned
Motions Classification as Listed in Role Play				
Main Motion	*0 points*	*1-6 points*	*7-10 points*	
Subsidiary Motion	*0 points*	*1-6 points*	*7-10 points*	
Privileged Motion	*0 points*	*1-6 points*	*7-10 points*	
Incidental Motion	*0 points*	*1-6 points*	*7-10 points*	
Bring Again Motion	*0 points*	*1-6 points*	*7-10 points*	
Business of Meeting				
Call to Order	*0 points*	*1-3 points*	*4-5 points*	
Problem Addressed	*0 points*	*1-16 points*	*17-25 points*	
Proper Use of Parliamentary Terms	*0 points*	*1-6 points*	*7-10 points*	
Voices Projected and Expressions Clear	*0 points*	*1-3 points*	*4-5 points*	
Presiding Official Remained Impartial	*0 points*	*1-3 points*	*4-5 points*	
Members took initiative in meeting	*0 points*	*1-3 points*	*4-5 points*	
Meeting Adjournment	*0 points*	*1-3 points*	*4-5 points*	
Presentation Protocols				
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Only items listed in the guidelines were brought to prep & presentation room*		
	0 points	*1-10 points*		
			Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
			Presentation Total (120 points)	

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Personal Finance

Future Business Leaders of America

Personal Finance challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of essential financial skills through an objective test. This event covers topics such as budgeting, saving, credit, investing, and responsible financial decision-making, helping members build a foundation for lifelong financial wellness.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

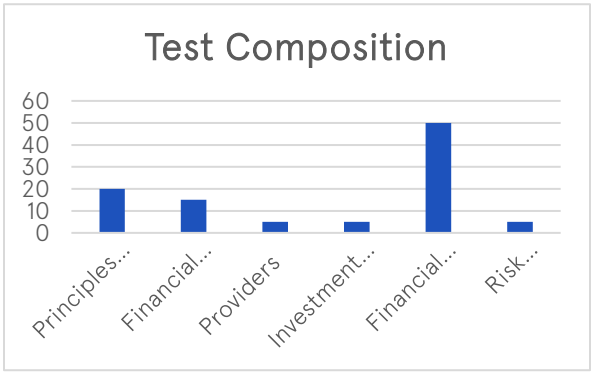
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Principles of Money
- Financial Needs and Goals
- Financial-Services Providers
- Investment Strategies
- Financial Literacy
- Risk Management

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Personal Finance

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Personal Finance

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation
MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Principles of Money (20 test items)
1. Explain forms of financial exchange (cash, credit, debit, electronic funds transfer, etc.) (FI:058) (PQ)
2. Identify types of currency (paper money, coins, banknotes, government bonds, treasury notes, etc.) (FI:059) (PQ)
3. Describe functions of money (medium of exchange, unit of measure, store of value) (FI:060) (PQ)
4. Describe sources of income and compensation (FI:061) (CS)
5. Explain the time value of money (FI:062) (CS)
6. Explain the purposes and importance of credit (FI:002, LAP-FI-002) (CS)
7. Explain legal responsibilities associated with consumer financial products and services (FI:063) (CS)

Financial Needs and Goals (15 test items)
1. Explain the need to save and invest (FI:270) (CS)
2. Set financial goals (FI:065) (CS)
3. Develop personal budget (FI:066) (CS)
4. Determine personal net worth (FI:562) (CS)
5. Describe the nature of budgets (FI:106, LAP-FI-106) (SP)

Financial-Services Providers (5 test items)
1. Describe types of financial-services providers (FI:075) (CS)
2. Discuss considerations in selecting a financial-services provider (FI:076) (CS)

Investment Strategies (5 test items)
1. Explain types of investments (FI:077, LAP-FI-077) (CS)
2. Explain factors to consider when selecting investments (FI:279) (SP)

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Financial Literacy (50 test items)

1. Explain the nature of tax liabilities (FI:067) (PQ)
2. Interpret a pay stub (FI:068) (PQ)
3. Write checks (FI:560) (PQ)
4. Maintain financial records (FI:069) (PQ)
5. Balance a bank account (FI:070) (PQ)
6. Explain the nature of charitable giving (FI:567) (PQ)
7. Manage online accounts (FI:830) (CS)
8. Calculate the cost of credit (FI:782) (CS)
9. Demonstrate the wise use of credit (FI:071) (CS)
10. Validate credit history (FI:072) (CS)
11. Make responsible financial decisions (FI:783) (CS)
12. Protect against identity theft (FI:073) (CS)
13. Pay bills (FI:565) (CS)
14. Apply for a consumer loan (FI:625) (SP)
15. Control debt (FI:568) (CS)
16. Prepare personal income tax forms (FI:074) (CS)
17. Discuss options for financing a college education (FI:831) (CS)
18. Discuss the nature of retirement planning (FI:569) (CS)
19. Explain the nature of estate planning (FI:572) (CS)

Risk Management (5 test items)

1. Describe the concept of insurance (FI:081) (CS)
2. Determine insurance needs (FI:571) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Investopedia. *Personal finance.* https://www.investopedia.com/personal-finance-4427760

Practical Money Skills. https://www.practicalmoneyskills.com/en/learn.html

The Balance. *Understanding investing risk.* https://www.thebalancemoney.com/understanding-risk-3141268

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Project Management (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Project Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of key project management concepts through an objective test. This event covers areas such as planning, scheduling, budgeting, risk management, and team coordination, reflecting the skills needed to successfully lead and execute projects in a business setting.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
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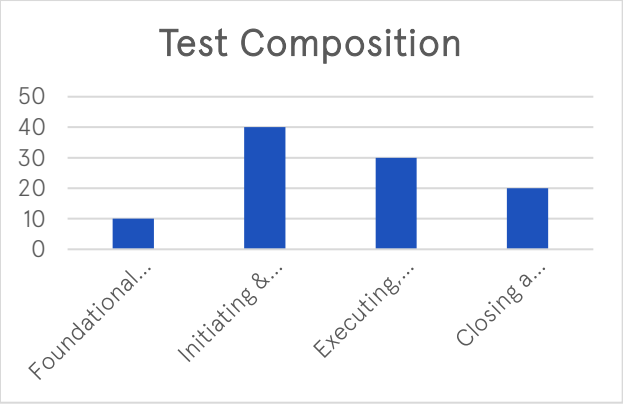
State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Foundational Knowledge
- Initiating and Planning a Project
- Executing, Monitoring, and Controlling a Project
- Closing a Project

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

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State

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Project Management (High School)

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Project Management (High School)

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Foundational Knowledge (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of project management (OP:158, LAP-OP-158) (SP)
2. Describe the role of ethics in project management (OP:675, LAP-OP-675) (SP)
3. Discuss the role and responsibilities of project managers (PD:181) (SP)

Initiating and Planning a Project (40 test items)

1. Initiate project (PJ:005) (SP)
2. Determine stakeholder expectations (EI:113) (MN)
3. Organize and prioritize work (OP:228) (CS)
4. Identify resources needed for project (OP:003, LAP-OP-003) (SP)
5. Prepare work breakdown structure (WBS) (PJ:006) (SP)
6. Create calendar/schedule (NF:164) (CS)
7. Identify quality-control measures (OP:163, LAP-OP-163) (SP)
8. Develop communications plan (CO:198) (SP)
9. Develop risk-management plan (RM:090) (MN)
10. Develop project plan (OP:001, LAP-OP-001) (SP)
11. Utilize project-management software (NF:130) (SP)

Executing, Monitoring, and Controlling a Project (30 test items)

1. Execute and control projects (PJ:009) (SP)
2. Monitor projects and take corrective actions (OP:520, LAP-OP-520) (CS)
3. Coordinate work with that of team members (OP:230) (CS)
4. Coordinate efforts of cross-functional teams to achieve project/company goals (HR:387) (SU)
5. Motivate team members (EI:059, LAP-EI-059) (SP)
6. Manage project team (PJ:007) (SP)
7. Manage project schedule (PJ:010) (SP)
8. Organize and track project resources (OP:357) (SP)
9. Apply project-management tools to monitor and communicate project progress (OP:002) (SP)

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Closing a Project (20 test items)

1. Evaluate project results (OP:159) (SP)
2. Recognize/Reward others for their efforts and contributions (EI:014, LAP-EI-141) (SP)
3. Determine whether goals/objectives were met (PJ:077) (MN)
4. Document lessons learned (PJ:079) (MN)
5. Close project (PJ:008) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Investopedia. *What is project management and what are the types?* https://www.investopedia.com/terms/p/project-management.asp

National University. *Why is project management important?* https://www.nu.edu/blog/why-is-project-management-important/

Project Management Institute. *Project management*. https://www.pmi.org/about/what-is-project-management

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Public Administration & Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Public Administration & Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of how government functions and its role in society through an objective test. This event explores topics such as public policy, organizational structure, budgeting, and the intersection of political and economic systems.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

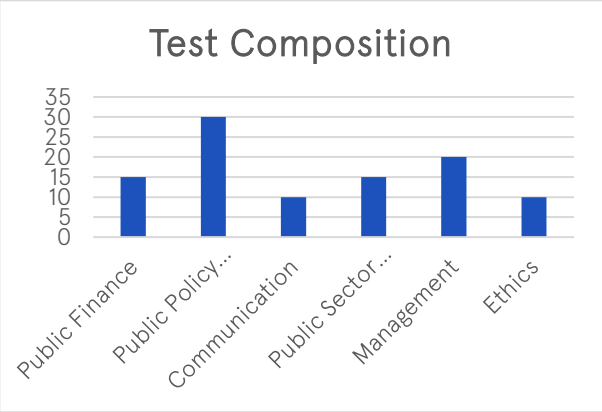
National Leadership Conference:	State/District:
Timing Structure: **Test Duration: 50 Minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Public Finance
- Public Policy and Governance
- Communication
- Public Sector Fundamentals
- Public Management
- Ethics

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines

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National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Public Administration & Management

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Public Finance (15 test items)

1. Explain the role of finance in the public sector
2. Describe the nature of budgets (FI:106, LAP-FI-106) (SP)
3. Explain the nature of operating budgets (FI:098) (SU)
4. Develop company's/department's budget (FI:099, LAP-FI-099) (MN)
5. Discuss the nature of public funding

Public Policy and Governance (30 test items)

1. Discuss the policy lifecycle
2. Explain principles of effective policy design
3. Analyze the effectiveness of public policies
4. Discuss factors that influence policymaking (e.g., civil engagement, advocacy, public discourse)
5. Discuss the role of policymaking in governance
6. Discuss the nature of law and sources of law in the United States (BL:067) (SP)
7. Describe the nature of legal procedure (BL:070) (SP)
8. Discuss the role of administrative law (BL:074) (SP)
9. Describe relationship among innovation, learning, and change (SM:094) (CS)

Communication (10 test items)

1. Explain the nature of effective written communications (CO:016) (CS)
2. Adapt written correspondence to targeted audiences (CO:203) (SP)
3. Write proposals (CO:062) (MN)
4. Discuss the importance of digital communication in the public sector (e.g., social media, the internet)

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Public Sector Fundamentals (15 test items)

1. Determine the relationship between government and business (EC:008, LAP-EC-016) (CS)
2. Distinguish public administration from private sector management
3. Discuss the role of the public sector in society
4. Describe services provided by the public sector
5. Distinguish among government entities, non-profits, and private businesses

Public Management (20 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of human resources management (HR:410, LAP-HR-410) (CS)
2. Discuss the nature of managerial planning (SM:063) (SP)
3. Explain managerial considerations in organizing (SM:064, LAP-SM-064) (SP)
4. Describe managerial considerations in staffing (SM:065, LAP-SM-065) (SP)
5. Discuss managerial considerations in directing (SM:066, LAP-SM-066) (SP)
6. Describe the nature of managerial control (control process, types of control, what is controlled) (SM:004, LAP-SM-400) (SP)

Ethics (10 test items)

1. Comply with the spirit and intent of laws and regulations (BL:163, LAP-BL-163) (CS)
2. Explain the importance of ethics in the public sector
3. Discuss the concept of public accountability
4. Discuss conflicts of interest in the public sector

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

ICMA. *Practices for Effective Local Government Leadership.* https://icma.org/

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Sigma. *The Principles of Public Administration.* https://www.sigmaweb.org/en/publications/the-principles-of-public-administration_7f5ec453-en.html

Texas A&M University. *Introduction to Public Administration and Leadership.* https://www.tamut.edu/faculty/syllabi/202280/80009.pdf

The Ohio State University. *Introduction to Public Affairs.* https://glenn.osu.edu/2110-sample-syllabus

The Ohio State University. *Public Management.* https://glenn.osu.edu/3500-sample-syllabus

University of Florida. *Introduction to Public Administration.* https://polisci.ufl.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/223/PAD-3003.pdf

West Virginia University. *Master of Public Administration Curriculum.* https://wvstateu.edu/college-of-business-and-social-sciences/departments/public-administration/mpa-curriculum/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Service Announcement

Public Service Announcement (PSA) gives members the opportunity to create a 60-second video that raises awareness about a specific issue. Members research the topic, define a clear objective, and develop a compelling message. The event includes a presentation component where the PSA is shown to judges and the creative and production process is explained.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Every Bite Counts: Reducing Food Waste

Create a public service announcement (PSA) that encourages individuals and families to reduce food waste through thoughtful planning, responsible consumption, and sustainable habits.

How can your message inspire others to reduce food waste and make a positive impact on their community and the environment?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Service Announcement

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Presentation should cover the following aspects of the PSA

- The PSA video is shown to the judges.
- Research, form an objective for the PSA, and create a no-longer-than 60-second video on the topic. Facts and data must be cited and secured from quality sources.
- The presentation should demonstrate an understanding of the topic with a learning objective for the intended audience; major findings from the topic research; the script writing process; use of different video techniques; a list of equipment and software used; and copyright or sources for the project and PSA.
- The production must be original content; competitors may not use previously published video clips in the videos submitted for competitions.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

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- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- The PSA video is shown to the judges.
- Research, form an objective for the PSA, and create a no-longer-than 60-second video on the topic. Facts and data must be cited and secured from quality sources.
- The presentation should demonstrate an understanding of the topic with a learning objective for the intended audience; major findings from the topic research; the script writing process; use of different video techniques; a list of equipment and software used; and copyright or sources for the project and PSA.
- The production must be original content; competitors may not use previously published video clips in the videos submitted for competitions.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.

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- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Service Announcement

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

Public Service Announcement Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Learning Objective *Demonstrates understanding of the topic and creates an objective for the intended audience*	*No understanding of event topic OR incorrect topic used, and no objective created*	*Unclear understanding of the topic with or without a learning objective*	*Clear understanding of the topic with a learning objective*	*Expert understanding of the topic with a learning objective for the intended audience*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Research *Explain the major findings from the topic research*	*No explanation of research or findings*	*Unclearly explains findings from topic research*	*Clearly explains findings from topic research*	*Clearly explains the finding from topic research with provided evidence for support*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Script *Describe the design development and script writing process*	*No description of design development and script writing*	*Unclearly describes the design development and the script writing process*	*Clearly describes the design development and script writing process*	*Clearly describes the design development and the script writing process with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Techniques *Explain video and audio techniques used to create the PSA*	*No explanation of use or implementation of audio or video*	*1-2 techniques used to create the PSA*	*3-4 techniques used to create the PSA and described*	*5 or more techniques used to create the PSA and described using expert terminology*	
	0 points	1-8 points	9-12 points	13-15 points	
Equipment & Software *Explain at least 3 types of equipment and/or software used to create PSA*	*No explanation of equipment and software*	*1 form of equipment or software utilized to create the PSA*	*2 forms of equipment or software utilized to create PSA*	*3 or more forms of equipment or software were used to create the PSA and described using expert terminology*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Copyright/Sources *Copyright and source information is noted and documented, and video content is original*	*Copyright and source information not addressed or addressed incorrectly AND video content is not original*	*Material violates copyright guidelines; sources are not addressed OR video content is not original*	*Copyright and source information is documented, and video content is original*	*Copyright compliance and source information is documented using visual representation, and video content is original*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
PSA Video Presentation	*PSA is not shown during the presentation*			*PSA is shown during the presentation*	
	0 points			5 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Service Announcement

Future Business Leaders of America

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	*Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines*	*Execution Aligned with Guidelines:* ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *PSA was no longer than 60 seconds* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Public Speaking (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Public Speaking allows members to develop and deliver a well-structured speech on a designated topic. This event helps members enhance their confidence, clarity, and persuasive communication skills through a live presentation before a panel of judges.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Speech

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Presentation: Maximum of 5 minutes**
  - *one-minute warning*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A): 2 minutes**

Important: Time allocations are exclusive. Time may not be shifted between segments.

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Develop and deliver a speech based on the following topic:

Discipline Over Talent: The Habits of Successful Leaders

Deliver a speech exploring the role discipline plays in achieving personal and professional success. Examine how discipline shapes leadership, influences decision-making, and contributes to achieving long-term goals.

Why does discipline often have a greater impact on long-term success than talent alone?

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Speaking (High School)

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• N/A

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 0 minutes
- **Presentation:** Maximum of 5 minutes (one-minute warning)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 2 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. Time may not be shifted between segments.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Reference materials such as visual aids, props, handouts or electronic devices.

Copyright Compliance

- All competitors must comply with state and federal copyright laws.
- Facts and data must be cited using credible sources.

Event Specific Information

- The speech must be developed around the topic.
- When delivering the speech, competitors may use notes prepared before the event.

Final Presentation Details

The presentation guidelines outlined above will apply to the final presentation.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

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Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Speaking (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Public Speaking Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Topic & Theme *Incorporates provided topic and executes a consistent theme*	*Provided topic is not mentioned in speech*	*Topic is not clearly incorporated into speech*	*Topic was clearly incorporated into speech*	*Topic was clearly incorporated and expanded thoroughly throughout the speech, using personal stories*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Introduction *Introduce the speech*	*Speech had no introduction*	*Introduction was not clearly presented*	*Introduction was clearly presented, and topic was defined*	*Introduction was clearly presented, and topic was defined with an effective transition into the speech body*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Supporting Information (Body) *Include accurate and appropriate supporting information*	*Speech did not have a topic*	*Multiple topics presented without clear connections*	*Central topics were identified, connected, and supported throughout the speech*	*Central topics were identified, connected, and supported throughout the speech with smooth transitions effectively utilized to support the central topic*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Conclusion *Provide effective conclusion connected to the topic & theme*	*Speech did not have a conclusion*	*Conclusion was not clearly presented*	*Effective conclusion was presented*	*Conclusion provides connection to entire presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Pace & Fluency *Deliver speech with appropriate pace & lack of filler words*	*Maintained an inconsistent pace that was either too fast or slow, paired with excessive use of filler words*	*Displayed a distracting and uneven pace, accompanied by noticeable use of filler words*	*Maintained an appropriate pace with minimal use of filler words*	*Maintained a well-varied pace and eliminated filler words, fully engaging the audience*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Engagement *Deliver speech with varied facial expressions, excellent eye contact with judges, good posture*	*Does not make eye contact or have varied facial expressions*	*Minimal varied facial expressions and/or eye contact*	*Appropriate facial expressions and eye contact*	*Appropriate eye contact, facial expressions, and didn't use notecards*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Vocal Clarity *Deliver speech with appropriate voice projection*	*Does not have voice projection*	*Minimal voice projection*	*Appropriate voice projection*	*Appropriate voice projection and diction*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Speech Delivery – Poise & Presence *Deliver speech with self-confidence, and poise*	*Did not demonstrate self-confidence, poise, or good posture*	*Demonstrated self-confidence, poise, or good posture*	*Demonstrated elevated self-confidence, poise, and good posture*	*Demonstrated elevated self-confidence, poise, posture, and assertiveness*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Public Speaking (High School)

Future Business Leaders of America

Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	*Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines*	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Avoided use of food, live animals, technology, visuals, props*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)			
Presentation Total (110 points)			

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Real Estate

Future Business Leaders of America

Real Estate challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of the real estate industry through an objective test. Members are assessed on key concepts such as property law, real estate finance, market analysis, sales strategies, and ethical practices. This event encourages exploration of the skills and knowledge needed to navigate the real estate sector successfully.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

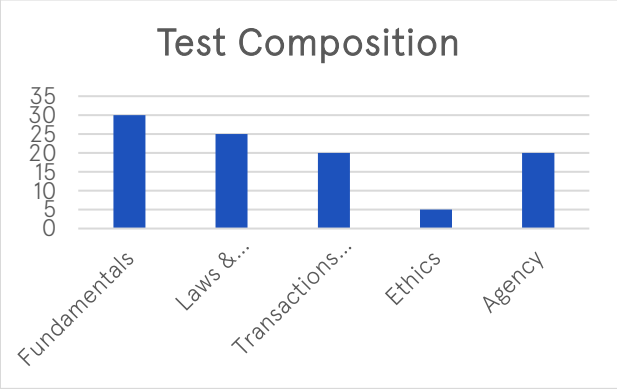
State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Real Estate Fundamentals
- Laws and Regulations
- Real Estate Transactions and Finance
- Ethics
- Agency

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Real Estate

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Real Estate Fundamentals (30 test items)

1. Distinguish between real and personal property
2. Distinguish among real estate agents, brokers, and realtors
3. Discuss the benefits of membership in a real estate organization such as the National Association of Realtors (NAR)
4. Describe careers in real estate (e.g., property managers, leasing agents, mortgage bankers)
5. Describe residential and commercial real estate niches (e.g., office space, single family home, industrial, land)
6. Define basic real estate terminology (e.g., appurtenances, liens, hereditaments)
7. Describe the nature of land use
8. Describe the real estate licensing process
9. Explain the real estate valuation process (FI:517) (SP)
10. Describe the role and responsibilities of real estate appraisers (PD:246) (SP)
11. Explain the role and responsibilities of real estate entrepreneurs (PD:248) (SP)

Laws and Regulations (25 test items)

1. Identify discriminatory housing practices
2. Discuss Fair Housing laws and protected classes
3. Discuss property disclosures required by law (e.g., asbestos, lead)
4. Identify federal regulations that protect prospective home buyers
5. Discuss the importance of state, county, and local real estate regulations
6. Discuss the nature of land use controls and zoning regulations
7. Discuss the nature of leasing and tenancy
8. Discuss the role of regulatory organizations in the real estate industry
9. Discuss fiduciary responsibilities in real estate

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Real Estate Transactions and Finance (20 test items)

1. Describe the real estate transaction process
2. Explain approaches to real estate lending (OP:281) (SP)
3. Discuss deeds and transfer of title
4. Discuss the involvement of financial institutions in the real estate industry (OP:186) (SP)
5. Discuss the nature of the secondary mortgage market (OP:363) (SP)
6. Explain the nature of real estate investments (PD:317) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of a real estate closing/settlement (SE:469) (SP)

Ethics (5 test items)

1. Discuss truth in advertising
2. Discuss ethical considerations in real estate

Agency (20 test items)

1. Describe types of agents (e.g., seller's, buyer's, dual, sub)
2. Explain the nature of agency relationships (BL:072) (SP)
3. Explain the role and responsibilities of real estate sales agents (PD:245) (SP)
4. Discuss the role of agents in real estate transactions
5. Differentiate between agency in commercial vs. residential transactions
6. Explain ways to advertise real estate listings for sale (SE:467) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

Capital Real Estate School. *Land use controls & regulations*. https://capitalrealestateschool.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/02/TOPIC-8-Land-Use-Controls-Regs_CRES-9-SEP-2020.pdf

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Investopedia. *Real estate: Definition, types, how to invest in it.* https://www.investopedia.com/terms/r/realestate.asp

Kaplan Real Estate Education. *Real estate license requirements (By state).* https://www.kapre.com/resources/real-estate/requirements-real-estate-license?srsltid=AfmBOorDW4HeLog5DoFuplH6jc3glCrv4efSXAbtHLONP93sPVirKVu5

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Realty Publications, Inc. *Real estate principles*. https://journal.firsttuesday.us/Realtipedia/Book_PRIN.pdf

Rocket Mortgage. *What is real estate? A definition and a guide.* https://www.rocketmortgage.com/learn/what-is-real-estate

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Retail Management (High School)

Retail Management challenges high school members to demonstrate their understanding of core retail operations and strategies through an objective test. Members are assessed on key knowledge areas such as inventory control, , sales techniques, merchandising, and product mix.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

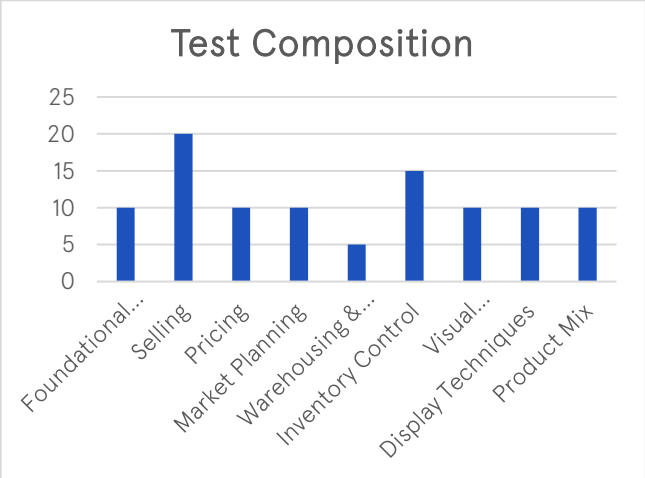
Event Information:	
National Leadership Conference: **Timing Structure:** **Test Duration: 50 Minutes** **Important Notes:** • **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only. • **Event Schedule Notes**: ○ Some events may begin before the Opening Session. ○ All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city. ○ Schedule changes are not permitted.	**State/District:** Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Foundational Retail Knowledge
- Selling
- Pricing
- Market Planning
- Warehousing and Transportation
- Inventory Control
- Visual Merchandising
- Display Techniques
- Product Mix

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Retail Management (High School)

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
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Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.
- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

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Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

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Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

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Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Foundational Retail Knowledge (10 test items)

1. Distinguish between retailing and marketing (MK:003) (CS)
2. Explain the nature and scope of distribution (OP:522) (CS)
3. Analyze the impact of technology on retailing (NF:041) (SP)
4. Obtain information from retail databases to aid in product planning and control (NF:104) (SP)

Selling (20 test items)

1. Demonstrate good/service (SE:374, LAP-SE-374) (SP)
2. Convert customer/client objections into selling points (SE:874, LAP-SE-874) (SP)
3. Close the sale (SE:895, LAP-SE-895) (SP)
4. Demonstrate suggestion selling (SE:875, LAP-SE-875) (SP)
5. Process retail sales documentation (SE:117) (SP)
6. Provide information about incoming merchandise to sales staff (SE:396) (SP)
7. Monitor on-floor selling activities (SE:389) (SP)

Pricing (10 test items)

1. Select approach for setting a base price (cost, demand, competition) (PI:018) (MN)
2. Determine cost of product (breakeven, ROI, markup) (PI:019) (MN)
3. Calculate break-even point (PI:006, LAP-PI-006) (MN)
4. Set prices (PI:007) (MN)

Market Planning (10 test items)

1. Profile target customer (MP:027) (MN)
2. Determine market needs (MP:025) (MN)
3. Determine customer demand for merchandise (MP:033) (MN)

Warehousing and Transportation (5 test items)

1. Explain shipping processes (OP:405) (CS)
2. Identify factors considered when selecting best shipping method (OP:406) (SP)
3. Plan storage space (OP:404) (MN)

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Inventory Control (15 test items)

1. Allocate merchandise to stores/regions (OP:411) (SP)
2. Track stock by location for department/class/vendor level (OP:412) (SP)
3. Explain types of unit inventory-control systems (OP:414) (SP)
4. Determine inventory shrinkage (OP:415) (SP)
5. Maintain inventory-control systems (OP:416) (SP)

Visual Merchandising (10 test items)

1. Place merchandise for impact (PR:342) (SP)
2. Determine on-floor assortments (PR:284) (SP)
3. Use cross-merchandising techniques (PR:358) (SP)
4. Read/Implement planograms (PR:349) (SP)

Display Techniques (10 test items)

1. Create promotional signs (PR:109) (SP)
2. Select and use display fixtures/forms (PR:031) (SP)
3. Create displays (PR:047) (SP)

Product Mix (10 test items)

1. Determine quality of merchandise to offer (PM:223) (SP)
2. Determine width and depth of assortment strategies (PM:225) (MN)
3. Select mix of brands (PM:256) (MN)
4. Plan merchandise assortment (e.g., styling, sizes, quantities, colors) (PM:254) (SP)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards.* https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

American Public University. *Why study retail management? The various reasons.* https://www.apu.apus.edu/area-of-study/business-and-management/resources/why-study-retail-management--the-various-reasons/

Brightpearl. *Retail management*. https://www.brightpearl.com/retail-management

Indeed. *What is retail management? (Definition and responsibilities).* https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/finding-a-job/what-is-retail-management

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Sales Presentation

Future Business Leaders of America

Sales Presentation allows members to showcase their ability to effectively sell a product or service of their choice. Members deliver an interactive presentation that highlights their sales techniques, product knowledge, and ability to engage and persuade potential customers.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Interactive Presentation

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 0 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Note: *This event is an interactive presentation with judges.*

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Sales Presentation

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

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Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Interactive Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 0 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Musical Instruments
- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in their sales presentation/pitch

- The team may sell whichever product or service they choose.
- The team shall provide the necessary materials and merchandise for the sales pitch.
- The sales presentation must be the result of the competitor's own efforts. Facts and working data may be secured from any source.
- This is an interactive event and judges may ask questions throughout the presentation.

Final Interactive Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 0 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

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Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Musical Instruments
- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in their sales presentation/pitch

- The team may sell whichever product or service they choose.
- The team shall provide the necessary materials and merchandise for the sales pitch.
- The sales presentation must be the result of the competitor's own efforts. Facts and working data may be secured from any source.
- This is an interactive event and judges may ask questions throughout the presentation.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

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Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Sales Presentation

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Sales Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Presents appropriate greeting	*No introduction was presented*	*The conversation began, but the customer (judge) had to start the presentation*	*The conversation was initiated by the competitor(s)*	*Competitor(s) show(s) creativity in their introduction and led to a seamless transition into needs determination*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Able to determine needs	*No questions were utilized to determine needs*	*Competitor(s) ask questions, but specific needs are not determined*	*Competitor(s) use questions to determine the needs of the customer (judge)*	*Competitor(s) use questions to determine the need of the customer (judge) and relates the needs to the product or service*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presenting the product or service	*No product/service was presented*	*Competitor(s) was unable to create interest in the product/service or the features*	*Competitor(s) was able to create interest in the product/service through knowledge of its features*	*Competitor(s) was able to convert unnecessary item(s) (wants) into needed item(s) (needs)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Able to overcome objections	*Objections were not addressed or overcome*	*One objection was overcome*	*2-3 objections were overcome*	*All objections were overcome, and sale resulted*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates suggestion selling	*No additional items were offered*	*Additional items were suggested, but did not relate to the product/service*	*Additional items were suggested that relate to the product/service*	*Additional items were suggested that relate to product/service and enhance the sale*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Able to close the sale	*Sale was not suggested*	*Competitor(s) asks for the sale but not all objections were addressed*	*Competitor(s) asks for the sale and there is little apprehension in agreeing*	*Competitor(s) didn't have to ask for the sale, the presentation confirmed the customer's (judge's) intent to buy*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to develop relationship	*No follow up was mentioned*	*Non-effective follow up was mentioned*	*Sale was finalized and interest in product/service was established*	*Relationship was established resulting in customer (judge) loyalty*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Sales Presentation

Presentation Protocols			
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of live animals* ✓ *Avoided use of musical instruments* ✓ *Avoided distributing and/or leaving food with judges*	
	0 points	1-10 points	
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
		Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Securities & Investments

Future Business Leaders of America

Securities & Investments challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of investment principles and financial markets through an objective test. This event covers topics such as stocks, bonds, mutual funds, portfolio management, and risk analysis, encouraging members to build foundational knowledge in personal and professional investing.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Objective Test
Event Elements	50-minute test, 100-multiple choice questions

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:
Timing Structure:
Test Duration: 50 Minutes

Important Notes:

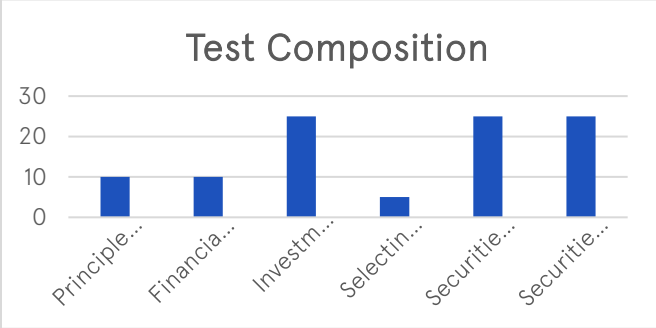
- **Internet Access:** Provided for testing time only.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- Principles of Money
- Financial Markets
- Investment Analysis
- Selecting Investments
- Securities & Investments Industry
- Securities Products



Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Securities & Investments

Future Business Leaders of America

National

Required Competition Items

Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides On-site
• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes
- **Format:** This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- **Materials:** Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.
- **Calculators:** Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

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- **Question Review:** Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Scoring

- Each correct answer is worth one point.
- No points are deducted for incorrect answers.
- Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to the testing site.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Principles of Money (10 test items)

1. Describe sources of income and compensation (FI:061) (CS)
2. Explain the time value of money (FI:062) (CS)
3. Explain the purposes and importance of credit (FI:002, LAP-FI-002) (CS)
4. Explain legal responsibilities associated with consumer financial products and services (FI:063) (CS)

Financial Markets (10 test items)

1. Describe the role of financial institutions (FI:336) (CS)
2. Explain types of financial markets (e.g., money market, capital market, insurance market, commodities markets) (FI:337) (SP)
3. Discuss the nature of convergence/consolidation in the finance industry (FI:573) (SP)
4. Describe the relationship between economic conditions and financial markets (FI:574) (SP)

Investment Analysis (25 test items)

1. Discuss types of investment objectives (FI:348) (SP)
2. Discuss the nature of investment risk (FI:349) (SP)
3. Describe the nature of diversification strategies (FI:350) (SP)
4. Explain factors to consider when selecting investments (FI:279) (SP)
5. Explain information that can be obtained from financial statements (FI:276) (SP)
6. Describe information that can be obtained from annual reports (FI:277) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of a mutual fund prospectus (FI:361) (SP)
8. Explain fundamental analysis used in making investment decisions (FI:280) (SP)
9. Describe the nature of technical analysis (FI:362) (SP)
10. Explain strategies for selecting investments (FI:283) (SP)
11. Describe portfolio management strategies (FI:664) (MN)

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Selecting Investments (5 test items)

1. Interpret financial ratios significant to investors (FI:281) (SP)
2. Assess securities' fundamentals (FI:282) (SP)
3. Evaluate portfolio performance (FI:672) (MN)

Securities & Investments Industry (25 test items)

1. Discuss considerations in selecting a securities sales agent (PD:234) (SP)
2. Describe types of securities and investment firms (PD:235) (SP)
3. Describe how securities are traded (PD:236) (SP)
4. Explain the principal factors that affect securities markets (PD:237) (SP)
5. Explain causes of stock price fluctuations (PD:238) (SP)
6. Discuss the relationship between bond prices and yields (PD:239) (SP)
7. Discuss the role of investment banking in the primary marketplace (PD:240) (SP)
8. Discuss the nature of margin accounts (PD:241) (SP)
9. Explain the nature of short sales (PD:242) (SP)
10. Discuss the nature of market timing (PD:243) (SP)

Securities Products (25 test items)

1. Describe the nature of mutual funds (PD:304) (SP)
2. Discuss the nature of retirement investment plans (PD:306) (SP)
3. Explain the nature of education savings plans (PD:307) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of variable annuities (PD:342) (SP)
5. Explain the nature of stocks (PD:309) (SP)
6. Explain the nature of dividends (PD:311) (SP)
7. Explain the nature of bonds (PD:313) (SP)
8. Discuss the nature of hedge funds (PD:314) (SP)
9. Describe the nature of commodities (PD:315) (SP)
10. Explain the nature of derivatives (PD:316) (SP)
11. Explain the nature of real estate investments (PD:317) (SP)
12. Explain the nature of venture capital (PD:318) (MN)

References

MBA Research and Curriculum Center. *National Business Administration Standards*. https://www.mbaresearch.org/local-educators/teaching-resources/standards/

Chen, J. *Top investment strategies: Key approaches to maximize returns*. https://www.investopedia.com/terms/i/investmentstrategy.asp

Chen, J. *Understanding investment securities: Types, uses, and benefits*. https://www.investopedia.com/terms/i/investment-securities.asp

Corporate Finance Institute. *Types of security*. https://corporatefinanceinstitute.com/resources/career-map/sell-side/capital-markets/types-of-security/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Social Media Strategies

Social Media Strategies allows members to develop and present a comprehensive marketing campaign using multiple social media platforms. Members demonstrate their ability to engage audiences, create cohesive content, and analyze platform performance through a strategic and creative presentation.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Adventure Awaits: Relaunching an Outdoor Adventure Rental Business

An outdoor adventure rental business has recently been renovated and is under new ownership. While demand for outdoor recreation continues to grow, the business has struggled to stand out in a competitive market and has a limited social media presence.

Company leaders want to increase awareness, attract new customers, and establish a recognizable brand before the grand reopening.
You have been hired as a social media consultant to develop a strategy that supports the business's goals and creates meaningful connections with current and prospective customers.

How can a strategic social media campaign transform a local business into a recognized destination for outdoor adventure experiences?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Social Media Strategies

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
	Items Competitor Must Provide	**Items FBLA Provides**
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
    - One individual or team event, and
    - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).

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- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.

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- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Develop a marketing strategy, utilizing social media, to effectively address an opportunity and a strategic approach to a target audience.
- Demonstrate knowledge of social media marketing beyond community management, including but not limited to developing unique content, effectively utilizing existing content, optimizing content for search, and distributing content across as many platforms as possible within a limited budget.
- Describe any applicable insight/research methodology as to why you have chosen specific platforms, messaging, content, engagement, and outreach strategies.
- Overall campaign – images, videos, copywriting, graphic design (if applicable) – is creative and appealing.
- Planned metrics to measure on the campaign.
- Final product indicates a clear thought process, a well-formulated campaign, and execution of a firm idea.
- Effectively communicate required information and drive the campaign toward a clear call-to-action.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance

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- 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
- 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
- More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Develop a marketing strategy, utilizing social media, to effectively address an opportunity and a strategic approach to a target audience.
- Demonstrate knowledge of social media marketing beyond community management, including but not limited to developing unique content, effectively utilizing existing content, optimizing content for search, and distributing content across as many platforms as possible within a limited budget.

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- Describe any applicable insight/research methodology as to why you have chosen specific platforms, messaging, content, engagement, and outreach strategies.
- Overall campaign – images, videos, copywriting, graphic design (if applicable) – is creative and appealing.
- Planned metrics to measure on the campaign.
- Final product indicates a clear thought process, a well-formulated campaign, and execution of a firm idea.
- Effectively communicate required information and drive the campaign toward a clear call-to-action.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Social Media Strategies

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Social Media Strategies Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Develops a social media campaign that effectively addresses the topic for the target audience	*Did not explain the campaign*	*Provided an unclear explanation of the social media campaign and topic for the target audience*	*Social media campaign effectively addresses the topic for the target audience*	*Social media campaign effectively addresses the topic for the target audience with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrate knowledge of social media strategies and metrics throughout	*No knowledge demonstrated*	*Unclearly demonstrated knowledge of social media or metrics*	*Demonstrates knowledge of social media and metrics*	*Demonstrates knowledge of social media strategies and metrics with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describes the research and methodology used to develop social media strategies	*Research and methodology not described*	*Unclearly describes the research and methodology used to create strategies*	*Clearly describes research and methodology used to create social media strategies*	*Clearly describes the research and methodology used to create social media strategies with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describes the design and development process used to create campaign content	*Design and development process not described*	*Unclearly describes the design and development process*	*Clearly describes design and development process*	*Clearly describes the design and development with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Describes social media strategies used to create a clear call-to-action	*Does not present social media strategies*	*Unclearly describes the social media strategies*	*Clearly describes social media strategies used to create a clear call-to-action*	*Clearly describes the social media strategies used to create a clear call-to-action with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presents a minimum of three social media posts across multiple platforms.	*Does not include three social media posts on multiple platforms*	*Included three social media posts but not on multiple platforms*	*Included three social media posts on multiple platforms*	*Included more than three social media posts on multiple platforms with supporting evidence*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Social Media Strategies

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (110 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Sports & Entertainment Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Sports & Entertainment Management challenges members to demonstrate their understanding of the business aspects of the sports and entertainment industries. Through an objective test and a role play scenario, members apply knowledge in areas such as marketing, event planning, sponsorship, and financial management within this dynamic field.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2 or 3 members
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Test Duration: 50 minutes

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

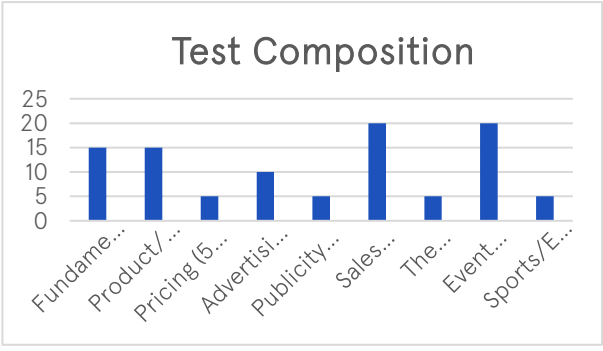
State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

*** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.

Knowledge Areas

- Fundamentals of Sports/Entertainment Management & Marketing
- Product/Service Management
- Pricing
- Advertising Basics
- Publicity and Public Relations
- Sales Promotion
- The Sports/Entertainment Management & Marketing Environment
- Event Planning
- Sports/Event Distribution



Test questions and role plays are based on the knowledge statements and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Sports & Entertainment Management

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.

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- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Team Tests

- If competing as a team, competitors must begin testing individually within a few minutes of one another. Each competitor's score will be averaged to determine the team's overall test score.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a sports and entertainment management–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy must be shared among team members and may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use
- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials
- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges
- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience
- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality
- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring
- The team-averaged objective test score determines the top 15 teams advancing to role play round.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points
- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices
- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition
- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)
- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

This study guide outlines the skills and knowledge assessed for this event. Objectives followed by a two-letter, three-digit code in parentheses are aligned to the National Business Administration Standards from MBA Research and Curriculum Center. Some objectives reference MBA Research's Learning Activity Packages (LAPs), which are instructional resources with readings, activities, and assessments available ***exclusively to teacher advisers****. For more information, visit MBAResearch.org/FBLA.*

Important Notice Regarding Test Preparation

MBA Research materials are ***not required*** *to study for or prepare for FBLA competitive event tests. MBA Research provides curriculum and instructional resources directly to teachers and does not administer or manage individual student testing or competition participation.*

Note for members and parents: *All questions related to tests, study materials, scores, or competition guidelines should be directed to the local FBLA adviser. Only teacher advisers should contact MBA Research directly.*

Fundamentals of Sports/Entertainment Management & Marketing (15 test items)

1. Discuss the nature of the sports/event industries (PD:115) (CS)
2. Describe the impact of sports/events on communities (PD:107) (CS)
3. Explain the nature of sports marketing (MK:012, LAP-MK-012) (CS)
4. Explain career opportunities in sports/event marketing (PD:051, LAP-PD-051) (CS)
5. Explain the concept of management (SM:001, LAP-SM-001) (CS)

Product/Service Management (15 test items)

1. Explain elements of the sport/event product (PM:079, LAP-PM-079) (CS)
2. Determine sports/event features and benefits (SE:188) (SP)
3. Describe factors that motivate people to participate in/attend sports/events (SE:209) (SP)
4. Explain the nature of sports/event brand/branding (PM:141) (SP)
5. Explain the nature of sponsorship in the sports/event industries (PR:175, LAP-PR-175) (SP)

Pricing (5 test items)

1. Identify factors affecting pricing of sport/event products (e.g., lead time, market demand, market segmentation, smoothing, responding to competitors) (PI:047, LAP-PI-047) (SP)
2. Describe pricing issues associated with sport/event products (e.g., cost, value, objectives) (PI:048) (SP)

Advertising Basics (10 test items)

1. Explain advertising media used in the sports/event industries (PR:177) (SP)
2. Explain the components of advertisements (PR:014) (SP)
3. Discuss types of direct mail tactics (PR:301) (SP)
4. Describe sports/event industries' utilization of digital media (PR:240) (SP)

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Publicity and Public Relations (5 test items)

1. Write a press release (PR:057) (SP)
2. Develop and generate sports/event newsletter (PR:182) (SP)
3. Explain media relations in the sports/event industries (PR:183) (SP)

Sales Promotion (20 test items)

1. Identify "out-of-the-box" sales promotion ideas for sports/events (PR:187, LAP-PR-187) (SP)
2. Implement ticket sales campaign (internet, contests/giveaways, pre-promotion of campaign, video scoreboard announcements, sports/sponsorship partnerships) (PR:188) (SP)
3. Design program for event (PR:142) (SP)
4. Create and issue script for game-day promotions (PR:191) (SP)
5. Identify elements that enhance venue attractiveness (e.g., facility: accessibility, trade area/drawing radius, parking; surrounding area: design/layout, amenities, personnel, sense of security) (PM:144) (SP)
6. Explain venue signage (PR:189) (SP)
7. Select event signage (PR:407) (SP)
8. Maximize/Capitalize on celebrity's appearance at event (PR:192) (SP)
9. Design logo for sport/event (PR:193) (SP)
10. Design tickets (PR:194) (SP)

The Sports/Entertainment Management & Marketing Environment (5 test items)

1. Explain the role of agents in sports (PM:143) (SP)
2. Describe legal issues affecting the marketing of sport/event products (BL:058, LAP-BL-058) (SP)
3. Describe the role of governing bodies in the sport industry (PD:279) (SP)

Event Planning (20 test items)

1. Determine merchandising opportunities for a sport/event (PM:086) (SP)
2. Determine goods and services required for an event (PM:147) (SP)
3. Establish barter agreements (vendors, media, etc.) (SE:327) (MN)
4. Explain the need for event insurance (FI:793) (SP)
5. Conduct a risk assessment of an event (SM:076) (SP)
6. Develop event contingency plan (e.g., personnel, weather, power outage, damage control) (RM:099) (MN)
7. Sell advertising space in printed and electronic materials (e.g., program, yearbook, media guide, fan guide, team photo cards, etc.) (SE:318) (SP)
8. Assess "product" readiness for sport/event (PM:146) (MN)
9. Measure economic impact of sport/event (NF:187) (MN)

Sports/Event Distribution (5 test items)

1. Explain distribution systems for the sport/event industries (OP:343) (SP)

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Sports & Entertainment Management

Future Business Leaders of America

Sports & Entertainment Management Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies alternatives and the pro(s) and con(s) of each	*No alternatives identified*	*Alternative(s) given but pro(s) and/or con(s) are not analyzed*	*At least two alternatives given, and pro(s) and con(s) are analyzed*	*Multiple alternatives given and multiple pros and cons analyzed for each*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrates knowledge and understanding of the event knowledge areas: *Fundamentals of Sports/Entertainment Management & Marketing/ Product/Service Management /Pricing/ Advertising Basics/ Publicity and Public Relations / Sales Promotion / The Sports/Entertainment Management & Marketing Environment/Event Planning /Sports/Event Distribution*	*No knowledge areas demonstrated*	*One or two knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Three knowledge areas are demonstrated*	*Four or more knowledge areas are demonstrated*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (100 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Supply Chain Management

Supply Chain Management challenges members to apply their understanding of how goods, information, and finances move through a supply chain. Members deliver a presentation that demonstrates their knowledge of logistics, procurement, inventory control, and distribution strategies used to support business operations.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

The Last Mile Challenge

A national online retailer has experienced rapid growth, resulting in increased customer demand and higher expectations for rapid delivery. While sales continue to increase, delivery costs have risen significantly, order fulfillment times have become inconsistent, and customer satisfaction scores have declined. Company leaders must determine how to improve performance without sacrificing profitability.

You have been hired as a supply chain consultant to analyze the organization's challenges and develop a strategy that supports continued growth and long-term success.

How can effective supply chain strategies help organizations balance customer expectations, operational efficiency, and profitability?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Supply Chain Management

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Supply Chain Management at a previous National Leadership Conference *are* eligible to compete in this event.**
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
    - One individual or team event, and
    - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).

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- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

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- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Management & Operations Planning
  - Analyze the organization's current supply chain and identify factors contributing to inconsistent fulfillment and last-mile delivery performance.
  - Recommend strategies to improve logistics, fulfillment processes, distribution, technology, partnerships, or delivery operations.
  - Explain how the recommendations can support continued growth and scalability.
- Financial & Profitability Planning
  - Analyze the financial impact of current delivery and fulfillment challenges.
  - Consider the costs and potential savings associated with proposed improvements.
  - Explain how recommendations can improve operational performance while protecting profitability and identify significant financial risks or tradeoffs.
- Customer & Demand Planning
  - Analyze how customer expectations, demand patterns, inventory availability, and fulfillment capacity affect delivery performance.
  - Recommend strategies for balancing delivery speed and reliability with inventory and operational constraints.
  - Explain how the recommendations can improve customer satisfaction while maintaining efficient operations.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- Management & Operations Planning
  - Analyze the organization's current supply chain and identify factors contributing to inconsistent fulfillment and last-mile delivery performance.
  - Recommend strategies to improve logistics, fulfillment processes, distribution, technology, partnerships, or delivery operations.
  - Explain how the recommendations can support continued growth and scalability.
- Financial & Profitability Planning
  - Analyze the financial impact of current delivery and fulfillment challenges.
  - Consider the costs and potential savings associated with proposed improvements.
  - Explain how recommendations can improve operational performance while protecting profitability and identify significant financial risks or tradeoffs.
- Customer & Demand Planning
  - Analyze how customer expectations, demand patterns, inventory availability, and fulfillment capacity affect delivery performance.
  - Recommend strategies for balancing delivery speed and reliability with inventory and operational constraints.
  - Explain how the recommendations can improve customer satisfaction while maintaining efficient operations

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Supply Chain Management

FBLA
Future Business Leaders of America

Supply Chain Management Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Summarizes Supply Chain Management: *Explain the overall business or supply chain scenario (industry, product, or service) and the role of supply chain strategy in context.*	*No explanation of the business or supply chain topic is provided; lacks any reference to supply chain strategy.*	*Provides a vague or incomplete explanation of the business or supply chain topic with limited or unclear reference to supply chain strategy or its role.*	*Clearly explains the business or supply chain topic (industry, product, or service) and identifies the role of supply chain strategy in a relevant context.*	*Thoroughly explains the business or supply chain scenario with strong clarity and detail. Effectively connects the role of supply chain strategy to the topic with insight and relevance, showing understanding of strategic impact.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Management & Operations Planning *Analyze the organization's supply chain and develop strategies to improve order fulfillment, last-mile delivery, and operational efficiency.*	*Does not identify the organization's supply chain or last-mile delivery challenges and does not propose strategies for improvement.*	*Identifies some operational or delivery challenges but provides limited or unclear strategies. Discussion of fulfillment processes, logistics, distribution, technology, or implementation is vague or incomplete.*	*Clearly analyzes key supply chain and last-mile delivery challenges. Proposes reasonable strategies to improve order fulfillment, delivery consistency, logistics, and operational efficiency. Addresses how recommendations could be implemented.*	*Provides a thorough analysis of the organization's supply chain and last-mile challenges. Develops detailed, realistic, and well-supported strategies that improve fulfillment speed, delivery consistency, operational efficiency, and scalability while considering implementation requirements and potential tradeoffs.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Financial & Profitability Planning *Analyze the financial impact of proposed supply chain strategies, including delivery costs, operational investments, cost-saving opportunities, and profitability tradeoffs.*	*Does not address delivery costs, financial considerations, profitability, or the financial impact of proposed strategies.*	*Identifies some costs or financial concerns but provides limited analysis. Proposed strategies have little connection to cost reduction, investment requirements, or profitability.*	*Analyzes major financial considerations such as delivery costs, fulfillment expenses, technology or infrastructure investments, and potential cost savings. Explains how recommendations can improve performance while maintaining profitability.*	*Provides detailed and well-supported financial analysis of proposed strategies. Clearly evaluates costs, potential savings, investments, risks, and tradeoffs while demonstrating how recommendations balance improved service with long-term profitability.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Customer & Demand Planning *Explain how customer expectations, demand patterns, inventory availability, and fulfillment capacity should influence supply chain decisions and service levels.*	*Does not address customer expectations, demand patterns, inventory availability, fulfillment capacity, or service levels.*	*Provides limited discussion of customer expectations or demand. Mentions inventory, delivery speed, or fulfillment capacity without clearly connecting them to supply chain decisions.*	*Explains how customer expectations and demand patterns affect inventory, fulfillment, and delivery decisions. Recommends reasonable strategies for improving service levels and customer satisfaction while managing available capacity.*	*Thoroughly analyzes customer expectations, demand patterns, inventory availability, and fulfillment capacity. Provides strategic recommendations that balance delivery speed, reliability, inventory management, customer satisfaction, and operational constraints.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Supply Chain Management

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (120 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Technology Support & Services

Technology Support & Services challenges members to demonstrate their knowledge of help desk operations and IT support through an objective test and a role play scenario. Members apply problem-solving, technical, and customer service skills to address real-world technology support issues in a business setting.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Individual
Event Category	Role Play
Event Elements	Objective Test and Interactive Role Play

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

Testing: 50-minute testing period

TOP 15 (combined and average team scores) advance to the finals

Final Round Role Play:

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *a one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided during testing period
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

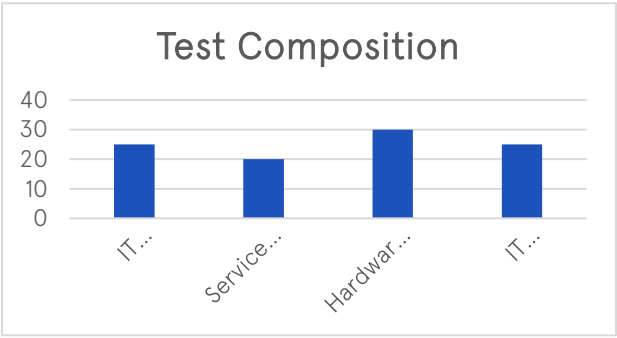
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

Knowledge Areas

- IT Fundamentals
- Service Desk Operations
- Hardware and Software Troubleshooting
- IT Management and Administration

Test questions are based on the knowledge areas and objectives outlined for this event. Detailed objectives can be found in the study guide included in these guidelines.



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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Technology Support & Services

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Objective Test	• Sharpened pencil • Fully powered device for online testing • Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• One piece of scratch paper per competitor • Internet access • Test login information (link & password provided at test check-in)
Role Play	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code	• Two notecards per competitor • Pencil • Secret role play problem/scenario

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure. **Competitors who placed in the top ten in Help Desk at a previous National Leadership Conference are not eligible to compete in this event.**
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).

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- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.
- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: an objective test and an interactive role play.

Objective Test

Each competitor will complete a 100-question multiple-choice objective test.

Test Duration

- **Test Duration:** 50 minutes

Format

- This event consists of an online objective test that is proctored and completed on-site at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).

Materials

- Reference or study materials are not permitted at the testing site.

Electronic Devices

- All electronic devices, including cell phones, smart watches, and similar technology, must be powered off prior to the start of the competition.

Calculators

- Personal calculators are not allowed; an online calculator will be available within the testing platform.

Question Review

- Competitors may flag questions within the testing platform for review by the Competitive Events Committee prior to the finalization of results at the NLC.

Interactive Role Play Details

The objective test score determines the top 15 competitors advancing to role play round.

Timing Structure

- **Preparation Time:** 20 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** None

Role Play Prompt

- Competitors will be provided with a single copy of a technology support–related scenario or problem at the beginning of their assigned preparation time. This copy may only be accessed within the designated preparation area.

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Notecard Use

- Each competitor will receive two notecards for use during preparation and the presentation. Information may be written on both sides. Notecards will be collected after the role play.

Materials

- No technology, reference materials, visuals, or props may be used.

Interaction with Judges

- Judges may ask questions during the presentation as part of the interactive role play format.

Audience

- Role play presentations are closed to all conference attendees.

Confidentiality

- To maintain fairness, competitors must not discuss or share the role play prompt until the event concludes.

Scoring

- The objective test score determines the top 15 competitors advancing to role play round. Tiebreakers are determined as follows: (1) The number of correct responses to 10 pre-selected tiebreaker questions will be compared. (2) If a tie remains, the number of correct responses to 20 pre-selected questions will be reviewed. (3) If a tie still remains, the competitor who completed the test in the shortest amount of time will be ranked higher.
- The role play round scores only will be used to determine winners.
- Objective test scores will be used to break a tie in the role play round.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Electronic Devices

- Unless approved as part of a documented accommodation, all cell phones, smartwatches, electronic devices, and headphones must be turned off and stored away before the competition begins. Visible devices during the event will be considered a violation of the FBLA Honor Code.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

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Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Sample Preparation Resources

- Official sample test items and role plays can be found in CONNECT. These sample items showcase the types of questions that may be asked on the test and familiarize competitors with the multiple-choice item options.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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Study Guide: Knowledge Areas and Objectives

IT Fundamentals (25 test items)

1. Describe the responsibilities of each layer of the OSI model
2. Discuss features of Windows for personal and enterprise environments
3. Discuss features of MacOS for mobile and PC systems
4. Apply command-line networking and troubleshooting tools for Windows and Linux (e.g., ipconfig, fsck, ping, tracert)
5. Describe computer components (e.g., CPU, motherboard, GPU)
6. Interpret software requirements (e.g., 32-bit vs. 64-bit, memory, storage)
7. Describe best practices for digital security and privacy (e.g., VPN, password managers, firewalls)
8. Describe common security vulnerabilities and threats (e.g., out-of-date systems, SQL injection, DDoS)
9. Explain how information is exchanged between a computer and a network (e.g., packets, requests, servers)
10. Describe the functions of DNS and DHCP
11. Describe the functions of IP addresses in networked environments
12. Describe the key hardware components of a network (e.g., clients and servers, switches, routers, modems)

Service Desk Operations (20 test items)

1. Explain the importance of service and help desk teams in an organization
2. Discuss when tickets should be escalated
3. Discuss the role of IT Service Management (ITSM) in business
4. Discuss the functions of service desk software (e.g., JIRA, Zoho)
5. Describe service desk support tiers and their responsibilities
6. Discuss methodology for solving tech problems (e.g., identifying problem, testing theories, developing plans of action)
7. Describe the role of ticketing systems in IT support
8. Describe best practices for identifying and removing malware from systems

Hardware and Software Troubleshooting (30 test items)

1. Apply the best practice methodology to investigate tech problems
2. Distinguish between hardware and software problems
3. Describe solutions to common printer issues (e.g., connectivity, refillables)
4. Discuss common issues with mobile devices (e.g., battery life, overheating, connectivity)
5. Describe symptoms of problems with RAM, CPU, and storage
6. Describe tools used to fix and troubleshoot devices (e.g., multimeter, freeze spray, compressed air)
7. Distinguish between devices that need fixing, upgrading, or replacing
8. Troubleshoot common Windows OS problems (e.g., BSOD, crashing, slow performance)
9. Describe best practices for removing malware from a system
10. Describe indicators of malware on a device
11. Describe common solutions to hardware problems (e.g., restarting, unplugging, resting)
12. Describe common cable and connector types (e.g., USB, lightning, HDMI)
13. Describe types and parts of a liquid crystal display
14. Describe the boot process and options for its configuration

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IT Management and Administration (25 test items)

1. Describe the role of change management in business and IT management
2. Describe elements of change request documents (e.g., time of change, rollout/backout plan, anticipated impact)
3. Discuss the use of remote access methods for IT administration (e.g., troubleshooting, testing, installing, updating)
4. Describe remote and virtual access software and protocols (e.g., SSH, RMM, RDP, VPN)
5. Describe file transfer services and protocols (e.g. FTP, Google Drive, OneDrive)
6. Discuss printer configuration settings (e.g., tray settings, duplex, orientation)
7. Describe types of printers (e.g., thermal, 3D, inkjet, laser)
8. Describe the use of load balancers in cloud environments and physical servers
9. Discuss key features of Active Directory
10. Describe the characteristics of different cloud services (e.g., SaaS, PaaS, IaaS)
11. Discuss spam mitigation and management techniques (e.g., DKIM, SPF, DMARC)

References for Knowledge Areas & Objectives

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 1 Objectives*. https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1101-exam-objectives-(3-0)

CompTIA. *CompTIA A+ Certification Exam Core 2 Objectives*. https://partners.comptia.org/docs/default-source/resources/comptia-a-220-1102-exam-objectives-(3-0)

Coursera. *Technical support fundamentals*. https://www.coursera.org/learn/technical-support-fundamentals

Google. *Google IT Support Professional Certificate*. https://www.coursera.org/professional-certificates/google-it-support#outcomes

IBM. *What is ITSM (IT service management)?* https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/it-service-management

Unity Communications. *What is IT support? Our guide to key tools and service desks.* https://unity-connect.com/our-resources/blog/what-is-it-support/

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Technology Support & Services

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Technology Support & Services Role Play Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Demonstrates understanding of the role play and defines problem(s) to be solved	*No description or role play synopsis provided; no problems defined*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis OR defines the problem(s)*	*Describes and provides role play synopsis AND defines the problem(s)*	*Demonstrates expertise of role play synopsis AND definition of the problem(s)*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Communicates position on role play scenario	*No position communicated*	*Communicates position not related to problem*	*Communicates position on problem*	*Communicates in a professional manner position on problem in scenario*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Identifies logical solution and aspects of implementation	*No solution identified*	*Solution provided, but implementation plan not developed*	*Logical solution and implementation plan provided and developed*	*Feasible solution and implementation plan developed, and necessary resources identified*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Displays empathy/diplomacy when responding to role play scenario	*No empathy or diplomacy displayed*	*Empathy or diplomacy displayed in response to role play scenario*	*Empathy and diplomacy displayed in response to role play scenario*	*Display of empathy and diplomacy skills add to resolution of role play scenario*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Shows knowledge of terminology and components related to the role play	*No understanding of the role play demonstrated*	*Terminology is presented but not expanded on*	*Clear understanding of terminology and implementation into presentation*	*Terminology is communicated clear enough for client (judge) to proceed on their own*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates conflict resolution and closure to the role play	*No closure was provided*	*Situation was closed OR conflict was resolved*	*Conflict was resolved, the situation has closure*	*Conflict was resolved, the situation has closure, and client (judge) is satisfied*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor did not appear prepared*	*Competitor was prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Unable to answer questions*	*Does not completely answer questions*	*Completely answers questions*	*Interacted with the judges in the process of completely answering questions*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
				Presentation Total (100 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Visual Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Visual Design allows members to showcase their creativity and technical skills by developing original visual content. Members present their designs to a panel of judges, demonstrating their use of design principles, visual communication techniques, and the creative process behind their work.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Not provided
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Creating a Public Library and Technology Center Experience

A public library and technology center is being developed to serve the needs of a growing community while creating an engaging, welcoming, and accessible visitor experience. The facility will offer traditional library services alongside technology resources, collaborative workspaces, digital learning opportunities, and community programs.

Develop a visual design concept that helps visitors navigate the space, access information, and connect with available resources and services.

How can thoughtful visual design transform a public library and technology center into a space that is clear, welcoming, functional, and inspiring for its community?

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Visual Design

District/Region/Section

Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National

Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Apply Design Principles:** Use balance, contrast, alignment, and other design principles to create visually strong and purposeful layouts.
- **Demonstrate Technical Skills:** Use digital design tools effectively, showing knowledge of proper formatting, file setup, and software features.
- **Communicate Visually:** Design visuals that clearly communicate a message, meet audience needs, and support the purpose of the project.
- **Explain the Creative Process:** Describe how ideas were developed, refined, and brought to life, including how problems were solved along the way.
- **Present Work Professionally:** Organize and present design work clearly, using correct terminology and justifying design decisions with reasoning.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

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Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Not Provided
- Presentations must be delivered using one or two personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If using two devices, one must face the judges and the other must face the presenters.
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
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- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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- **Present Work Professionally:** Organize and present design work clearly, using correct terminology and justifying design decisions with reasoning.

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Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

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- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Visual Design

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Visual Design Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Description of the event topic and materials	*Materials not described and/or one or more elements are missing or incomplete*	*Event topic and at least one of the materials described*	*Event topic and all materials described*	*All materials and event topic described, and the competitors connect the different pieces together*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Apply Design Principles: *Use balance, contrast, alignment, and other design principles to create visually strong and purposeful layouts.*	*No evidence of design principles is present; layout appears random or disorganized. No design terms are used*	*Some design principles are used, but inconsistently or without clear purpose. Layout may lack visual clarity or impact. Limited use of design terminology*	*Demonstrates a clear understanding of core design principles. Layout is visually strong, well-organized, and supports the message or purpose. Appropriate design terms are used, and design choices are explained with logical reasoning.*	*Applies multiple design principles with skill and creativity. Layout is polished, purposeful, and visually compelling, enhancing the overall impact and effectiveness of the design. Design decisions are clearly justified using accurate terminology and thoughtful explanations that show a deep understanding of the work.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Demonstrate Technical Skills: *Use digital design tools effectively, showing knowledge of proper formatting, file setup, and software features.*	*No evidence of technical skill; tools are misused or formatting is missing or incorrect.*	*Basic understanding of tools is shown, but formatting, file setup, or use of features is incomplete or inconsistent.*	*Design tools are used correctly with proper formatting, file setup, and appropriate use of core features. Work shows technical competence.*	*Tools and features are used skillfully and efficiently. Formatting, file setup, and execution are precise and professional, demonstrating a strong command of the design software.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Communicate Visually: *Design visuals that clearly communicate a message, meet audience needs, and support the purpose of the project.*	*Visuals do not convey a clear message and lack connection to the audience or project purpose.*	*Visuals attempt to communicate a message but are unclear, inconsistent, or not well-suited to the audience or purpose.*	*Visuals clearly communicate the intended message, are appropriate for the target audience, and support the overall purpose of the project.*	*Visuals are engaging, well-crafted, and deliver a strong, focused message. Design choices are highly effective in reaching the audience and reinforcing the project's purpose.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Explain the Creative Process: *Describe how ideas were developed, refined, and brought to life, including how problems were solved along the way.*	*No explanation of the creative process is provided.*	*Provides a limited or unclear explanation of the process. Few details are given about idea development or problem-solving.*	*Clearly describes how ideas were developed and refined. Includes relevant steps and explains how challenges were addressed.*	*Provides a detailed and thoughtful explanation of the full creative process. Describes brainstorming, revisions, and specific problem-solving strategies that shaped the final design.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Consistency in graphic design to theme	*Consistency in graphic design to theme not addressed*	*Explains how graphic design is consistent with theme*	*Demonstrates with visual aids the consistency between graphic design and theme*	*Emphasize interpretation of the topic and design as it relates to graphic design and theme including use of visual aids*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Visual Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of two, with only one facing judges at a time)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
		Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)			
				Presentation Total (140 points)	

Name(s):			
School:		Section:	
Judge Signature:		Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Website Coding & Development

Website Coding & Development challenges members to design and build a website based on a specific topic, with a primary focus on backend coding and functionality. Members present their completed site to a panel of judges, showcasing their technical skills, problem-solving, and understanding of web development principles.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview

Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Digital Resource Management Website

Organizations often need efficient ways to manage shared resources, information, requests, or services. Develop a fully functional website that addresses a real-world organizational need through thoughtful design, clear navigation, and effective use of technology.

Competitors should determine the purpose, audience, structure, and key features of the website based on the problem they choose to solve. Focus on clean design, functionality, accessibility, responsive layouts, user experience, and well-organized code. The website must be coded from scratch using programming languages and technologies of the competitor's choice.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Website Coding & Development

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

- **Membership Deadline**: FBLA national membership dues must be paid to the specific division by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on March 1 of the current school year.
- **Repeat Competitors**: Members may only compete in an event at the NLC more than once if they have not previously placed in the top 10 of that event at the NLC. If a member places in the top 10 of an event at the NLC, they are no longer eligible to compete in that event at future NLCs, unless the event has been modified beyond a name change. Chapter events are exempt from this procedure.
- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
- **Competitor Responsibility**: Only registered competitors are permitted to plan, research, prepare, and set up their presentations. Advisers and others may not assist.

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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- Projectors and projector screens are not permitted, and competitors may not bring their own.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

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Restricted Items

- Animals, except for authorized service animals.
- Food, which may be used for display only and may not be consumed by judges.
- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Code Structure:** Use clean, well-organized code with consistent spacing and formatting for readability and maintainability.
- **Website Usability & Accessibility:** Design a website that is easy to navigate and intuitive for all users. Include accessibility features to support inclusive design.
- **Design Choices:** Use fonts, colors, and layout choices that support readability and enhance the user experience. Design should be consistent across all pages.
- **Graphics Integration:** Include graphics that are purposeful, well-placed, and enhance the overall look, feel, and clarity of the site.
- **Website Content:** Present clear, well-written content that allows any user to understand the topic. Ensure all text is free from grammar and spelling errors. Support information with credible, professional sources.
- **Technical Skill & Functionality:** Show advanced coding ability with functional, interactive elements that run without errors. The site should be responsive and fully functional across devices (i.e. desktop, tablet, mobile).
- **Consistency & Interactivity:** Make sure all pages follow a consistent structure and style. Interactive features should work smoothly and enhance the user experience.
- **Source Code & Documentation Requirements:** Competitors must be prepared to show judges relevant materials that support their project. This may include original source code, documentation of any copyrighted material, and a list of sources used. The use of website templates is not permitted.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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Advancement to Finals

- The top-scoring competitors or teams from each preliminary section will advance to the final round in equal numbers.
- The number of competitors or teams advancing to the final round depends on the number of preliminary sections:
  - 2 sections: Top 6 from each section advance
  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - 5 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
  - More than 5 sections: Top 2 from each section advance

Audience & Viewing Rules

- Final presentations may be open to conference attendees, depending on space availability.
- Finalists may not view other presentations in their own event.

Technology Guidelines

- Internet Access: Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
- If the final round takes place in a conference room, the following equipment will be provided: a projector, projector screen, power access, and a table.
- Competitors using laptops or devices without an HDMI port must bring their own compatible adapters.
- It is the responsibility of final-round competitors to decide whether or not to use the provided technology.
- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
- Items may be placed on the provided table or on the judges table, if space allows.
- No items may be left with the judges following the presentation.

Restricted Items

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- **Consistency & Interactivity:** Make sure all pages follow a consistent structure and style. Interactive features should work smoothly and enhance the user experience.
- **Source Code & Documentation Requirements:** Competitors must be prepared to show judges relevant materials that support their project. This may include original source code, documentation of any copyrighted material, and a list of sources used. The use of website templates is not permitted.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Website Coding & Development

FBLA Future Business Leaders of America

Website Coding & Development Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Website Coding					
Style	*Code spacing is not available. Style sheets and scripts are not used.*	*Script & style sheets are used but not separated. Code includes some comments.*	*Appropriately uses files and separates all languages.*	*Code spacing is well thought out.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Website Usability					
Website Usability, Accessibility, and Navigation	*Website is difficult to use or navigate. No evidence of accessibility features*	*Navigation is present but may be confusing or inconsistent. Accessibility is minimal or not fully considered*	*Website is user-friendly, with clear navigation and basic accessibility features (e.g., alt text, readable fonts). Structure supports a positive user experience*	*Website is highly intuitive and easy to navigate. Accessibility is thoughtfully integrated (e.g., keyboard navigation, color contrast, ARIA labels), showing strong attention to inclusive design and user experience best practices*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Color/contrast, background, and font are appropriate for the topic	*No design principles applied*	*Color/contrast, font, or design choice is distracting*	*Color/contrast, font, and design choice are appropriate for the concept/topic*	*Color/contrast, font, and design choice enhance the experience for the user*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Graphics appropriate for topic	*No graphic design principles applied*	*Graphics are distracting*	*Graphics are appropriate for the concept/topic*	*Graphics enhance the experience for the user*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Website Content					
Fully addresses the topic	*Topic is not followed*	*Topic is not fully addressed*	*Topic is fully addressed*	*Users with no knowledge of the topic can identify based on site*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Site contains multiple elements providing evidence of coding skills	*No evidence of website coding skill demonstrated*	*Website is coded using limited features*	*Website contains use of multiple coding skills*	*Website contains advanced coding skills*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Grammar, spelling, and punctuation	*Website contains grammar or spelling errors*	*Website contains 3 or less spelling or grammar errors*	*Website contains one grammar and no spelling errors*	*Website is free of grammar and spelling errors*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Project Evaluation					
Website is compatible with multiple platforms	*Website is not compatible with any platforms*	*Website is only compatible with one platform*	*Website opens appropriately on at least 2 platforms*	*Website is fully functional on multiple devices, including mobile phones, tablets, and computers*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Website interactivity functions and is error free	*Website interactivity contains errors that prevent the execution*	*Website interactivity contains errors that did not prevent execution*	*Website interactivity is error free*	*Website interactivity is error free and enhances the experience for the user*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Website Coding & Development

Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Website elements are consistent across all pages	*Only one page is presented*	*Pages are not consistent*	*Pages are consistent*	*Pages are consistent and elements enhance the experience for the user*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Source Code & Documentation Requirements	*No source code or documentation is provided. Project appears to use a template or lacks original work.*	*Source code is shown but may be incomplete or disorganized. Documentation is missing or unclear. Potential template use is evident.*	*Source code is original, complete, and available upon request. Documentation includes proper citations and source attribution. No templates used.*	*Source code is well-organized, clearly written, and fully original. All sources and materials are properly documented with professional presentation. Demonstrates strong ownership and understanding of the development process.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of three)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals* ✓ *Templates are not used*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
				Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)	
				Presentation Total (220 points)	

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Website Design

Website Design allows members to create a visually engaging and user-friendly website based on a specific topic. Members present their site to a panel of judges, emphasizing front-end design elements such as layout, navigation, aesthetics, and user experience.

Educational Alignments

Event Overview	
Division	High School
Event Type	Team of 1, 2, or 3 members
Event Category	Presentation
Event Elements	Presentation with a Topic

Event Information:

National Leadership Conference:

Timing Structure:

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
  - *No interaction allowed with judges during this time.*
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes
  - *A one-minute warning will be provided*
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes

Important: *Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.*

Important Notes:

- **Internet Access:** Provided
  - Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.
- **Event Schedule Notes**:
  - Some events may begin before the Opening Session.
  - All schedules are posted in local time for the NLC host city.
  - Schedule changes are not permitted.

State/District:

Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

***** Event specifics are continued below. Review the document in its entirety.**

2026-2027 Topic

Community Resource Website

Communities often have a wide range of organizations, programs, services, events, and resources that support residents and local needs. A well-organized website can present this information clearly, making it easier for users to explore available resources, understand community offerings, and access relevant information in one central location.

Your team has been hired to design a modern, user-friendly website that organizes community information and resources in a clear, accessible, and visually engaging way.

Focus on visual design, usability, accessibility, responsive layouts, and effective organization of information. Your design should create an engaging user experience that allows visitors to explore community resources and locate information that is relevant to their needs.

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines
Website Design

Future Business Leaders of America

District/Region/Section
Check with your District/Region/Section leadership for District/Region/Section-specific competition information and deadlines.

State
Check with your State Leader for state-specific competition information and deadlines.

National
Required Competition Items

	Items Competitor Must Provide	Items FBLA Provides
Preliminary Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items	• Table • Internet Access
Final Presentation	• Conference-provided nametag • Photo identification • Attire that meets the FBLA Dress Code • Technology and presentation items, including any adapter or cord needed beyond an HDMI connection	• Table • Power • Projector with HDMI cord • Projector screen • Internet Access

Eligibility Requirements

To participate in FBLA competitive events at the National Leadership Conference (NLC), the following criteria must be met:

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- **Conference Registration**: Members must be officially registered for the NLC and must pay the national conference registration fee to participate.
- **Official Hotel Requirement**: To be eligible to compete, competitors must stay within the official FBLA housing block.
- **State Entry Limits**: Each state may submit up to four entries per event.
- **Event Participation Limits**: Each member may participate in:
  - One individual or team event, and
  - One chapter event (e.g., *Community Service Project* or *Local Chapter Annual Business Report*).
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- **Participation Requirement**: To be eligible for an award, each competitor must complete all components of the event at the National Leadership Conference.
- **Team Composition**: All members of a team must be from the same local chapter.
- **Identification at Check-in**: Competitors must present valid photo identification (physical or digital) that matches the name on their conference name badge. Acceptable forms include a driver's license, passport, state-issued ID, or school ID.
- **Late Arrivals**: Competitors will be allowed to compete until such time that the results are finalized, or participation would impact the fairness and integrity of the event, as determined by Competitive Events staff. If judges have left the competitive event area, it is no longer possible to compete. Five penalty points will be assessed for late arrivals in any competitive event.

Event Administration

This event consists of two phases: a preliminary presentation and a final presentation.

Preliminary Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up:** 3 minutes
- **Presentation:** 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A):** 3 minutes
- **Important:** Time allocations are exclusive. The presentation must begin immediately after the 3-minute set-up time concludes. Time may not be shifted between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

Venue & Format

- Presentations occur in-person at the National Leadership Conference (NLC).
- Competitors/teams are randomly assigned to presentation sections.
- Presentations will take place in a large, open area with a designated space of approximately 10' x 10', which includes a table and chairs for the judges.
- The preliminary round is closed to conference attendees and audience.

Technology Guidelines

- **Internet Access:** Provided (*Please be aware that internet access at conference venues may be unreliable. Always prepare a backup plan in case the connection is lost or does not work with your device.)*
- Presentations must be delivered using no more than three personal devices (laptop, tablet, mobile phone, or monitor approximately laptop-sized).
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- Wireless slide advancers (e.g., presentation clickers or mice) are allowed.
- External speakers are not allowed; audio must come directly from the presenting device(s).
- Electricity will not be available.

Non-Technology Items

- Visual aids, samples, notes, and other physical materials related to the project may be used.
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Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Planning & Development:** Clearly explain the planning, design, and implementation process. Include reasons for design decisions supported by evidence and rationale.
- **Content & Relevance:** Ensure the website directly addresses the assigned topic, includes all required elements, and thoughtfully goes beyond expectations.
- **Design & User Experience:** Create a visually polished, cohesive, and user-friendly website. Use colors, fonts, graphics, and layout that enhance both usability and accessibility.
- **Functionality & Compatibility:** Make sure the website loads and functions correctly on at least three platforms (e.g., desktop, tablet, mobile).
- **Interactivity:** Include interactive elements that function smoothly and enhance the user experience without errors.
- **Consistency Across Pages:** Design should be consistent across all pages, with repeated elements and layout choices that improve navigation and clarity.
- **Metrics & Industry Language:** Include measurable success indicators and explain them using accurate web design and development terminology.

Final Presentation Details

Timing Structure

- **Equipment Set-Up**: 3 minutes
- **Presentation**: 7 minutes (a one-minute warning will be provided)
- **Question & Answer (Q&A)**: 3 minutes
- **Note**: Each time segment is exclusive. Once the 3-minute set-up period ends, the 7-minute presentation time begins automatically. Competitors may not shift time between segments. Competitors will not interact with judges during the set-up period.

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  - 3 sections: Top 4 from each section advance
  - 4 sections: Top 3 from each section advance
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- Links and QR codes, which may be shown but may not be scanned or clicked by judges at any time.

Research

- Information must be supported by credible, well-documented sources.
- Any use of copyrighted material, images, logos, or trademarks must be properly documented.

Team Expectations

- In team presentations, all members must actively participate in the delivery of the presentation.

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Event Specific Information: Competitors should incorporate the following aspects in response to the topic

- **Planning & Development:** Clearly explain the planning, design, and implementation process. Include reasons for design decisions supported by evidence and rationale.
- **Content & Relevance:** Ensure the website directly addresses the assigned topic, includes all required elements, and thoughtfully goes beyond expectations.
- **Design & User Experience:** Create a visually polished, cohesive, and user-friendly website. Use colors, fonts, graphics, and layout that enhance both usability and accessibility.
- **Functionality & Compatibility:** Make sure the website loads and functions correctly on at least three platforms (e.g., desktop, tablet, mobile).
- **Interactivity:** Include interactive elements that function smoothly and enhance the user experience without errors.
- **Consistency Across Pages:** Design should be consistent across all pages, with repeated elements and layout choices that improve navigation and clarity.
- **Metrics & Industry Language:** Include measurable success indicators and explain them using accurate web design and development terminology.

Scoring

- Preliminary round scores are used to determine which competitors or teams advance to the final round from each section.
- Final round scores determine the final rankings and top award winners.
- Judges are responsible for breaking all ties in both preliminary and final rounds.
- All judging decisions are final. Results announced at the National Leadership Conference are considered official and will not be changed after the conclusion of the National Leadership Conference.

Penalty Points

- Competitors may be disqualified if they violate the Code of Conduct or the Honor Code.
- Five points are deducted if competitors do not follow the Dress Code or are late to their assigned presentation time.

Recognition

- A maximum of 10 entries (individuals or teams) may be recognized per event.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)

- FBLA complies with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by providing reasonable accommodations for competitors. Accommodation requests must be submitted through the conference registration system by the official registration deadline. All requests will be reviewed, and additional documentation may be required to determine eligibility and appropriate support.

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Recording of Presentations

- Unauthorized audio or video recording is strictly prohibited in all competitive events.
- FBLA reserves the right to record presentations for educational, training, or archival purposes. Competitors should be aware that their presentations may be recorded by FBLA-authorized personnel.

Important FBLA Documents

- *Competitors should be familiar with the Competitive Events Operations Manual, Honor Code, Code of Conduct, and Dress Code.*

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Website Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Website Design Presentation Rating Sheet

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Planning, Development, and Implementation: Describe planning, development, and implementation of project	*No planning, development, and implementation process described*	*Unclearly explains or is missing either the planning, development, or implementation process*	*Clearly explains the planning, development, and implementation process*	*Clearly explains the planning, development, and implementation process including rationale with evidence*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Website Features: Demonstrate the required elements of the project as stated in guidelines	*Website is not on topic or does not include required elements*	*Website is on topic, includes some of the required elements*	*Website presented is on topic, including all the required elements*	*Website presented is on topic, includes required elements and more*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Website UX Design: Includes appropriate color/contrast, backgrounds, fonts, and graphics, accessibility that enhance the UX design	*Design elements are missing, inconsistent, or distracting. No consideration for user experience or accessibility is evident*	*Some design elements are used appropriately, but there are issues with readability, consistency, or accessibility. UX may feel unpolished or hard to follow.*	*Website uses suitable colors, fonts, backgrounds, and graphics that work well together. Accessibility features are present and support a positive user experience.*	*Website design is polished, visually cohesive, and user-friendly. Design elements are thoughtfully selected to enhance usability and accessibility, resulting in a highly effective and inclusive user experience.*	
	0 points	1-9 points	10-16 points	17-20 points	
Website Content: Grammar, spelling, and punctuation	*Website contains 4+ grammar or spelling errors*	*Website contains 3 or less spelling or grammar errors*	*Website contains one grammar and no spelling errors*	*Website is free of grammar and spelling errors*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Website Content: Substantiates and cites sources used while conducting research	*Sources are not cited*	*Sources/References are seldom cited to support statements*	*Professionally legitimate sources & resources that support statements are generally present*	*Compelling evidence from professionally legitimate sources & resources is given to support statements*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Website Evaluation: Website is compatible with multiple platforms	*Website is not compatible with any platforms*	*Website is only compatible with one platform*	*Website opens appropriately on at least 2 platforms*	*Website opens appropriately on more than 2 platforms*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Website Evaluation: Website interactivity functions and is error free	*Website interactivity contains errors that prevent the execution*	*Website interactivity contains errors that did not prevent execution*	*Website interactivity is error free*	*Website interactivity is error free and enhances the experience for the user*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Website Evaluation: Website elements are consistent across all pages	*Only one page is presented*	*Pages are not consistent*	*Pages are consistent*	*Pages are consistent and elements enhance the experience for the user*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	
Website Evaluation: Description of metrics planned to use to measure the success of the website	*Planned measure of metrics not described*	*Planned measure of metrics unclearly addressed*	*Planned measure of website metrics clearly addressed*	*Planned measure of website advanced metrics addressed and enhanced by use of industry terminology*	
	0 points	1-2 points	3-4 points	5 points	

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2026-2027 Competitive Events Guidelines

Website Design

Future Business Leaders of America

Expectation Item	Not Demonstrated	Below Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations	Points Earned
Presentation Delivery					
Statements are well-organized and clearly stated	*Competitor(s) did not appear prepared*	*Competitor(s) were prepared, but flow was not logical*	*Presentation flowed in logical sequence*	*Presentation flowed in a logical sequence; statements were well organized*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Consistently displays confidence, poised body language, engaging eye contact, and effective voice projection.	*Did not demonstrate any of the listed skills*	*Demonstrated 1-2 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated 3 of the listed skills (confidence, body language, eye contact, or voice projection)*	*Demonstrated all skills, enhancing the overall presentation*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Demonstrates the ability to effectively answer questions	*Does not respond to questions or responses are completely off-topic.*	*Provides incomplete or unclear answers that show limited understanding.*	*Responds accurately and clearly to most questions, showing adequate understanding.*	*Responds confidently with clear, accurate, and thoughtful answers that enhance the overall presentation.*	
	0 points	1-6 points	7-8 points	9-10 points	
Presentation Protocols					
Adherence to Competitive Events Guidelines	***Competitor(s) Did Not Follow Guidelines***	***Execution Aligned with Guidelines:*** ✓ *Used only allowable technology devices (sizing specs followed; maximum of three)* ✓ *Presentation aligned with the assigned topic* ✓ *Maintained professional boundaries during set-up time (no interaction with judges)* ✓ *Did not leave materials behind after the presentation* ✓ *Links or QR codes were displayed appropriately (not clicked or scanned by judges)* ✓ *Audio was presented without external speakers (preliminary round)* ✓ *Avoided use of food or live animals*			
	0 points	1-10 points			
Staff Only: Penalty Points (5 points for dress code penalty and/or 5 points for late arrival penalty)					
Presentation Total (120 points)					

Name(s):		
School:	Section:	
Judge Signature:	Date:	

Comments:

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